

Happening today

● **FINANCE MINISTER NIRMALA** Sitharaman will embark on a visit to Canada and the US to hold talks on economic cooperation and investment opportunities.

Business as Usual

By EP UNNNY



THE CITY **PAGE 3**
PROTEST AT IIT DELHI OVER STUDENT'S DEATH ON CAMPUS

PM MODI DEVOTING PERSONAL ATTENTION TO DEVELOPING RUSSIAN-INDIAN RELATIONS, SAYS PUTIN

Jaishankar meets Putin, focus on trade, energy, fertilisers, high-tech

Modi and Putin to meet twice in next few weeks for SCO, BRICS

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 24

AHEAD OF two scheduled meetings between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin in the next three weeks, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar called on the latter in Moscow on Monday. Putin told Jaishankar that among the areas of bilateral cooperation with India, Russia is giving priority to energy, fertilisers, nuclear energy and high technology sectors.



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with Russian President Vladimir Putin in Moscow on Monday. AP

Modi and Putin are expected to meet at the SCO (Shanghai Cooperation Organisation) summit in Kyrgyzstan on August 31-September 1, and

again at the BRICS summit in New Delhi on September 12-13. Underlining the increase in bilateral trade between the two

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Govt on Gor’s remarks: Trump unpredictable, so took cautious approach

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

CITING US President Donald Trump’s “unpredictable behaviour” when meeting foreign leaders, government sources on Monday said India, therefore, adopted a “cautious approach” when Prime Minister Narendra Modi met him in France in June this year.

The clarification came in response to US Ambassador Sergio Gor’s public remarks that the Indian side had asked the

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TRUMP MOVES TO HIKE H-1B VISA FEE TO OVER \$100,000

NEW U.S. SANCTIONS ‘AIM TO BLOCK IRAN REVENUE SOURCES’

US administration to “not do a full press conference, no questions” after the meeting

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United Peela Interface in bread



OBC creamy layer candidates in ’25 civil services exam: Govt seeks SC directions

Shyamal Yadav
New Delhi, August 24

THE CENTRE on Monday sought “clarifications and appropriate directions” from the Supreme Court on the applicability of its March 11 judgment ordering the consideration of claims by nearly 100 OBC candidates who were selected in Civil Services Examinations (CSE) since 2016 but rejected by the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) on the basis of creamy layer criteria.

The Centre’s clarification plea comes just ahead of the start of the Foundation Course for the CSE-2025 batch, tentatively scheduled to begin at the Lal Bahadur Shastri National Academy of Administration in Mussoorie this week.

The appeal, the Centre emphasised, was concerned solely with CSE-2025, whose selection process “stood substantially concluded prior to the pronouncement of the judgment and is presently at the terminal stage of service allocation”.

In its appeal, the DoPT, however, does not mention the applicability of the Supreme Court judgment from next batches.

E. EXPLAINED

Govt says will have cascading effect

The Centre has argued that SC’s March 11 judgment came five days after the final result of CSE-2025 was declared. Delay in finalisation of the category-wise merit and allocation list would have a cascading effect — from training to seniority and pay fixation of the incoming batch.

The Centre said that the March 11 judgment “altering settled position (on creamy layer) was rendered five days after the final result of CSE-2025 already stood declared”. Any delay in finalisation of the category-wise merit and allocation list would have a cascading effect on the training schedule, batch strength, logistics arrangements, the training calendar fixed by the respective academies, cadre allocation for IAS and IPS officers, and the seniority and pay fixation of the

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FORM WITH WORSHIPPERS’ AADHAAR OR PAN Tough conversion law kicks in this week, Mumbai pastors ask churchgoers to sign form they are praying of their ‘free will’

‘Self-declaration’ more as assurance, say pastors in Vasai-Virar, Mira-Bhayandar, Thane, Mumbai, Palghar after incidents of disrupted Sunday prayers and FIRs

Purnima Sah
Mumbai, Mira-Bhayandar, Vasai-Virar, Palghar, Thane, August 24

THE MAHARASHTRA anti-conversion law that toughens legal provisions against forced conversion comes into effect August 28. Its shadow has already fallen on Christian congregations across the Mumbai Metropolitan Region. At prayer halls in Vasai-Virar, Mira-Bhayandar and beyond, local pastors are asking worshippers to do something they never had to before — fill a form.

This “self-declaration” states that they are attending the prayer meeting of their own “choice” and face “no pressure, inducement, temptation, lure, or threat of any kind”. It further says their decision to attend church “is completely personal, voluntary, and independent.” The form asks for a passport-size photograph and an Aadhaar or PAN number.

Until this year, anyone could walk in.

Over the past month, *The Indian Express* found these forms being circulated — in English, Marathi and Hindi — to congregations in Mumbai, Mira-Bhayandar, Vasai-Virar, Palghar and Thane. This follows a run of Sunday disruptions at prayer meetings over the past five months: there



Worshippers sign the form at New Hope Church in Virar. PURNIMA SAH



● THE ‘DECLARATION’

- They attend church voluntarily.
- They participate in prayers of their own free will.
- Their participation is part of their religious freedom and a right guaranteed under Constitution of India.
- In case anyone makes a false allegation against them or the church, the voluntary application/self-declaration may be produced as legal evidence.

have been nine FIRs linked to five such disruptions between April and July.

Pattern of prayer, protest

Typically, a prayer meeting is held on a Sunday, often in a

rented hall, school, banquet hall or home. People identifying themselves as Bajrang Dal or VHP workers object, often alleging that Hindus are being converted. Police are called, both sides are taken to the station,

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Gurgaon, Monday

School buses stranded on a waterlogged road at Subhash Chowk in Gurgaon after heavy rainfall lashed the NCR on Monday, causing massive traffic jams and leading to cancellation of several flights. PTI

GURGAON received 52 mm rainfall from 8.30 am to 8.30 pm, affecting movement on the Delhi-Gurgaon Expressway and other roads

THE DISTRICT administration advised corporate offices to work from home on Tuesday and told schools to hold classes online

IN DELHI, several areas, including Connaught Place, were inundated. Janakpuri recorded the highest rainfall at 72.5 mm

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J&K reopens probe into 1998 massacre of 23 Kashmiri Pandits

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, August 24

JAMMU AND Kashmir’s State Investigation Agency (SIA) has reopened the Wandhama massacre case, 28 years after militants gunned down 23 Kashmiri Pandits in Ganderbal district in the Valley.

Sources in the SIA said the case was reopened as part of the agency’s efforts to reinvestigate the killings of Kashmiri Pandits and gather fresh evidence to identify those responsible.

“SIA Kashmir has already launched a focused investigation into these decades-old cases as a mission of utmost importance. All-out efforts are underway to unravel the underlying conspiracies, unearth and establish credible evidence, and identify the perpetrators strictly on the basis of evidence and witness testimony,” said a senior SIA official. “The objective is clear: to bring these cases to their logical conclusion on merits, ensuring

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Lessons from Jantar Mantar: Delhi Police chief orders intel revamp

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, August 24

DELHI POLICE Commissioner Anurag Kumar has asked the intelligence wing of the force to expand its information-gathering efforts, and to collect at least 10 specific pieces of intelligence ahead of every planned protest.

Sources said the directive was issued earlier this month after the protests at Jantar Mantar and Connaught Place in July saw a much bigger turnout than anticipated, “exposing gaps” in intelligence-collection.

Police were caught flatfooted

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● 10 SPECIFIC PIECES OF INTELLIGENCE

The intelligence wing has been directed to collect and analyse:

- Profile of participants
- State-wise participation
- Modes of mobilisation
- Names of leaders and key functionaries
- Agenda or demands of the protesters
- Places of stay and movement
- Local contacts and linkages



At least 50,000 protesters hit the streets in Delhi on July 20

- Organisational affiliations
- Sources of funding
- Logistical arrangements

● **HEALTH COMMISSIONER TO LEAD PROBE; PRELIMINARY INFORMATION POINTS TO EXPLOSION IN VENTILATOR, SAYS OFFICIAL**

‘Hadn’t even seen son’s face’: Three newborns killed in fire at Amravati hospital

Ankita Deshkar
Amravati, August 24

ASHE sat outside the mortuary on Monday, Swapnil Borge was shell-shocked. His son was born only a day before, and though he’d not even seen his face yet, Borge had gone around distributing sweets to anyone he came across — staff of the government hospital, fellow patients and passers-by.

“I hadn’t even seen his face yet,” he said. “I don’t know how to tell my wife about this.”

Borge’s son was one of three newborns who died in a fire at the Neonatal Intensive Care Unit (NICU) of the govern-

ment-run Amravati District Women’s Hospital. Officials said the fire, which broke out in the early hours of Monday, could have been caused by a fault in a ventilator in the NICU.

“The incident took place around 4 am at the NICU of the hospital,” Amravati Collector Ashish Yerekar told *The Indian Express*. “There were 39 babies, of whom we were able to rescue 36, while three died. When the fire broke out, there were nine babies — one on a ventilator and eight on warmers. The baby on the ventilator and two babies who were next to him died in the incident.”

Thirty-two of the rescued

babies have been referred to other hospitals, while four babies have been kept with their mothers. Dr Vinod Pawar, District Surgeon, Amravati, said: “According to the preliminary information, it appears that there was an explosion in the ventilator.”

Police have registered three cases of accidental deaths.

Minister for Public Health and Family Welfare Prakash Abitkar, who visited the hospital and met the affected families, told the media that a committee headed by Health Commissioner Sanjay Katkar would look into the incident and submit a report in seven days.

Chief Minister Devendra



Grieving family members of the victims, in Amravati, Monday. PTI

Fadnavis expressed his condolences and promised action. He announced an ex gratia of Rs 5

lakh to the families of the deceased. “Orders have been issued to the health administra-

tion to conduct a high-level inquiry into this incident. The strictest possible action will be taken against those responsible for this incident. Both the Health Minister and the Secretary have been instructed to visit Amravati today itself,” he said on X.

At the hospital, staff and witnesses recounted the chaos. “We had no idea what was happening. There was a lot of smoke, so we immediately started rescuing the babies and used fire extinguishers. We could barely see anything. The entire ward was engulfed in flames immediately after the explosion,” one staffer said.

Mura Bhai, whose grandson was in the NICU, was among

those who helped rescue the babies. “We were sleeping on the veranda in the hospital when we received the call. It was completely dark inside the ward, and we rushed there with the torches in our mobile phones to help the nurses. Some babies were already trapped and could not be saved.”

Officials said the Maharashtra government had provided the ventilators. “A similar minor blast occurred in one of the ventilators at the same hospital in 2022, although there were no casualties then. The ventilators were subsequently replaced. One of those replaced ventilators caught fire,” one official said.

Sources at the hospital said

the building’s fire audit had lapsed on August 21 and that the hospital had alerted the PWD. They also mentioned that the fire alarm at the ward, too, did not function.

Families, meanwhile, are still struggling to come to terms. Gayatri Chopade’s family has moved her to her hometown of Anjangaon and ensured there is no television to relay news of the fire that killed her baby.

“Her baby had swallowed stool in the womb and was shifted from Warud to Amravati. The baby had almost recovered, and Gayatri was discharged from the Warud hospital this week. We learnt about the baby’s

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Students ‘lured with biscuits’ to take part in protest: FIRs filed in Kannauj, Deoria

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 24

AS STUDENT protests roil schools and colleges across Uttar Pradesh, authorities in two districts have cracked down with FIRs — in Kannauj, police alleged students were lured with biscuits to join a protest, while in Deoria, an activist was booked after filming and posting a video of a ‘dilapidated’ school campus.

The action comes amid Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath’s directive on Saturday to file FIRs and take strict action against those spreading false information and “misleading” videos about schools and colleges. At an event in Lucknow on Sunday, he said that some people were posting videos of dilapidated school buildings on social media to “tarnish” the government’s image.

Basic education officers in several districts had also directed schools to restrict the entry of outsiders, including YouTube users and social media users, without prior permission from the authorities concerned.

According to police, on August 20, students and their parents staged a protest against the headmaster of a composite school in Gugarapur, stopping and surrounding his vehicle and raising slogans. Parents alleged the headmaster discriminated against the students, misbehaved and assaulted them. Students also boycotted classes.

However, officials said that during an inquiry, headmaster Rakeshendra Saxena alleged that the students were made to participate in the protest as part of a conspiracy against him. He claimed some people had distributed biscuits and offered other incentives to lure them.

After a video of the incident went viral, an inquiry was conducted by an officer. Students allegedly told the officer that unidentified persons had lured them with biscuits and persuaded them to join the protest.

Kannauj Block Education Officer Vishwanath Pathak – the complainant in the case – alleged in his complaint that some political persons were using the incident to tarnish the image of the education department and the state government.

The case was filed against unidentified persons on August 20 at Gurusahaiganj police station for abetment, presence of an abettor when an offence is committed, abetment of an offence by the public or more than 10 persons, and unlawful assembly.

Station House Officer, Gurusahaiganj police station, Ajay Awasthi said the case was lodged for misguiding students. No arrest has been made so far.

In Deoria, activist and local resident Rajat Singh was booked on August 22 for allegedly entering a primary school without permission and posting a video of its “dilapidated” condition.

The education department, said the campus had an unused building that was auctioned and demolished as per rules. Some debris remained in a corner. The department said it was removed after Singh’s video.

Singh was booked under charges of statements conducive to public mischief and criminal trespass and house-trespass at Gauri Bazar police station. It was lodged by Block Education Officer Vinay Sheel Mishra.

Amravati hospital fire

death around 7.30 am,” said her husband, Prafull Chopade.

The family of Kiran Bethekar, whose baby daughter died in the fire, is similarly distraught. “We didn’t see the baby for an entire week,” said her mother, Vasanti Kale. “We brought the baby to the hospital from Achalpur last Monday at 10 pm.”

Heena Kausar Taslim Khan’s family hasn’t told her about the fire. Heena had twin daughters on August 22, one of whom died during surgery. The surviving baby was rescued from the fire and has been moved to a private hospital. “Doctors have advised us against telling her about both her daughters,” her mother Sultana Bi Sheikh Kalandar said.

District Surgeon Dr Pawar said he received information of the incident in the morning and immediately informed the fire department. “By then, the staff at the hospital had rescued six babies. Fire extinguishers were used, and the fire brigade also sprayed water, but the smoke did not subside,” he said. However relatives alleged that the fire brigade arrived after the fire was put out.

Outside the mortuary, some passers-by consoled Swapnil Borge, but he just nodded. When he looked up, he said: “I saw the NICU catching fire in front of me. I heard a woman scream while I was searching for my baby. I learnt at 7 am that my child is no more. I had thought so much about him. I would buy him a gold ornament, give him a good name. But they ate my son alive.”

Intelligence revamp

on July 20, when at least 50,000 young people hit the streets in the heart of Delhi and tried to march on Parliament to press their demand for education reform. Violent clashes followed, and the massive use of tear gas and lathi against the protesters was widely criticised.

A senior officer said the Special Branch of the Delhi Police, which deals with intelligence, usually gathers basic details such as the venue of the protest and the expected turnout. The Commissioner has asked the Special Branch for a more “comprehensive and actionable assessment” of the groups organising the protests going forward, sources said.

Specifically, the intelligence wing has been directed to collect and analyse the following 10 details: the profile of participants; state-wise participation; modes of mobilisation; names of leaders and key functionaries; agenda or demands of the protesters; places of stay and movement; local contacts and linkages; organisational affiliations; sources of funding; logistical arrangements.

Police sources said the directions are aimed at improving the preparedness of police ahead of protests and public gatherings, particularly those involving participants from outside Delhi or multiple organisations.

“The emphasis is on collecting information that can help the force assess the law-and-order implications of such gatherings in advance,” a source said.

A senior officer said field units must provide verified, specific, and usable inputs rather than broad estimates. “The pur-

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Jaishankar meets Putin in Russia

sides, Putin credited Modi for giving “personal attention” to the relationship. “Your visit today underscores the level of relations that has long been established between Russia and India, over decades. We continue to work together in virtually all areas. This includes governmental ties, inter-parliamentary ties, and economic cooperation,” Putin told Jaishankar.

“I am pleased to note that our trade turnover has increased this year. While it declined slightly last year, it’s growing this year, and this is partly, and perhaps primarily, thanks to Prime Minister (Narendra Modi), who is devoting his personal attention to developing Russian-Indian relations,” he said.

Intensifying trade and economic relations has been identified as a priority area by both the leaders, who had set a bilateral trade target of US\$ 100 billion by 2030. Bilateral trade between the two sides touched a record high of US\$ 68.7 billion in FY 2024-25; it was US\$ 59.863 billion in FY 2025-26.

“At the beginning of our

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029V.an2VYRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

Govt on Gor remarks

between the two leaders. Trump, however, disregarded this request and took questions from the media.

Facing criticism from the Opposition, government sources said: “Discussions regarding arrangements for public appearances of leaders are normal practice ahead of any VVIP visit. In this regard, the Indian side communicated its standard practice for such visits... Delegations when meeting the US President are wary about his unpredictable behaviour, as may be seen from his interactions with the President of South Africa, Ukraine etc. Thus, the cautious approach by India.”

At a televised meeting in February last year, Trump and Vice President J D Vance had engaged in a heated argument with Ukraine President Volodymyr Zelenskyy. In May last year, Trump also sought to corner South African President Cyril Ramaphosa on the alleged discrimination against White farmers.

Modi has rarely addressed press conferences with foreign leaders — Trump and former British Prime Minister David Cameron are among the few exceptions. The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) has rebranded the joint media interactions as “media appearances” and “media statements”.

This has not gone down well in the western media; in May this year, a Norwegian journalist questioned MEA officials on this during Modi’s visit to Oslo for the India-Nordic summit.

Speaking at the Economic Times World Leaders Forum on Saturday, US Ambassador Gor said, “The fact that our President and Prime Minister Modi have such a deep and personal friendship makes it a lot easier for me frankly. It is one of those things that you may have seen,

Tough conversion law kicks in this week, Mumbai pastors ask churchgoers to sign form

and in some cases an FIR follows.

Seven of the nine FIRs are against those who organised the prayers and worshippers, two are against Bajrang Dal members.

An illustrative case is from April 12 in Vasai East, where a Sunday prayer meeting at Dhiraj Shopping Centre, attended by an estimated 100 to 150 people, was disrupted when a group of men, among them Bajrang Dal members, entered the hall. What followed over the next 24 hours was five FIRs at Achole police station, four against the person who conducts the meetings and one against his accusers.

It is against this backdrop that the forms have taken hold, described by organisers less as paperwork than as insurance.

At New Hope Church in Virar, which has recently built an iron grille gate that stays locked during prayers, Pastor Steven Rozario, 49, handed out the forms during a Sunday service this month and explained why. Around 30 people were present.

“This is a self-declaration form. I want all of you to fill it out, attach a passport-size photograph, and bring it with you next Sunday when we meet for prayer. Considering the continuous disruptions and attacks during prayer meetings, we are keeping these forms with us so that if someone questions us in the future and claims that we were forced or compelled you to attend the prayer meeting, we can show this as proof,” he told the congregation.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Rozario said pastors had held several meetings after the recent incidents. “In most cases, police do not even register FIRs against those who cause the violence. This is why we all came up with these forms, hoping they will help us if such a situation arises in our church. The new law has given a free pass to those who

lated to nuclear energy, cooperation in high-tech sectors, and other areas — they are all on the agenda, and... progressing quite steadily,” Putin said.

Jaishankar conveyed Modi’s wishes to Putin, and said he had sent a “personal communication”. “We had a meeting of the Inter-Governmental Commission. I think overall we have a good report to give to you. I think our economic cooperation, trade, energy, fertilisers, nuclear, and other dimensions as well — I’d be pleased to speak about them in detail. Overall, I think our economic cooperation has grown very significantly,” he said.

“Prime Minister Modi looks forward to meeting you at the SCO Summit, then welcoming you to India for the BRICS Summit, and, in due course, as per your mutual convenience, having the annual summit, so we have a very strong picture of co-operation to present,” Jaishankar said, addressing Putin.

India is set to host the BRICS leaders’ summit in New Delhi on September 12-13; Putin and Chinese President Xi Jinping are among those expected to attend.

Jaishankar is on a two-day visit to Russia (August 23-24). Earlier in the day, he co-chaired the 27th session of the India-Russia Inter-Governmental Commission on Trade, Economic, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation (IRIGC-TEC) with Manturov.

While the Indian side included India’s Ambassador to Russia Vinay Kumar and Joint Secretary, Eurasia Division, Mayank Singh, the Russian side was represented by Manturov, Minister of Foreign Affairs Sergey Lavrov, Deputy Chief of Staff of the Presidential Executive Office Maksim Oreshkin, and Aide to the President of Russia Yury Ushakov.

The India-Russia Inter-Governmental Commission (IRIGC) has two divisions: the Trade, Economic, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation (IRIGC-TEC), co-chaired by Jaishankar and Manturov; and the Military and Military-Technical Cooperation (IRIGC-M&MTC), headed by the defence ministers of the two countries.

I travelled with President Trump to G7 two months ago in Evian and they brought in the cameras.”

He was referring to the meeting between Modi and Trump on June 17, on the sidelines of the G7 leaders summit — their first since Op Sindoor last year. The meeting was highly anticipated as there was frostiness in the ties after Trump’s claims that he had brokered the ceasefire between India and Pakistan.

“I will share it as an anecdote... we were behind the scenes, behind the stage, and at one point it was just the President and I. And he asked me what are the Indians going to raise. We went over some topics. And he said, did they have any asks. And MEA had one ask. And let’s bring in the media, let’s not do a full press conference, no questions. And so I told the President, Indians prefer no questions. So he said no problem. The meeting starts, the press comes in. There are 50 cameras. President sitting here,

Prime Minister sitting there. They both speak for a few minutes. As soon as they get done, the first thing the President does is, looks at the cameras and says any questions? And that opened everything up. And he did a 45-minute press conference, and everything was on the table,” Gor said at the event.

Raising Gor’s remarks, Congress leader Pawan Khara said in a post on X: “This @MEAIndia response to @USAmbIndia comment is revealing because: it suggests that it may be Modi’s normal practice to plead with foreign governments not to make him face the media; he pleads, but they don’t listen; then they publicly mock him by revealing that they ignored him; and yet, he won’t fight back — because he is compromised.”

“This is not just about Narendra Modi. It is the office of India’s Prime Minister that is being diminished and disrespected. And Modi deserves every bit of condemnation for bringing us to this point,” Khara said.

OBC creamy layer candidates

incoming batch vis-à-vis subsequent recruitment cycles, it warned.

The government stated that “a mechanical or unqualified application of the ratio of the said judgement, with retrospective effect, to the already-concluded selection process of CSE-2025, would result in a peculiar and acute anomaly amounting to discrimination inter se candidates of the very examination cycle sought to be benefited”.

The government move comes ahead of crucial Assembly elections, with anti-reservation protests underway at some places.

The matter traces its origins to a DoPT letter of October 14, 2004, clarifying an Official Memorandum (OM) of September 1993 on the creamy layer criterion for OBCs. The 1993 OM had excluded income from salary and agricultural sources from the income/wealth test used to determine creamy layer status. However, the 2004 clarification said the salary income of employees in public sector undertakings (PSUs) and the private sector would be a criterion.

As per the petitioners, this was “hostile discrimination” between the wards of government servants and those of PSUs or private sector employees.

The 2004 clarification was not implemented effectively until 2014, while the UPA government was in power and was making efforts to consolidate OBC support. It began to be applied rigorously from the CSE-2015 (corresponding to the 2016 batch).

Since then, around 100 candidates who possessed caste certificates issued by competent authorities and cleared the CSE have found their OBC claims rejected by the DoPT on the creamy layer ground. Most of them are parties in different petitions before the Supreme Court and various High Courts.

Interestingly, some of these candidates successfully claimed OBC status in other examinations conducted by the Union Public Service Commission or state bodies, but were rejected in Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzgl

that truth prevails and those responsible are brought to justice.”

The massacre dates back to 1998. On the night of January 25-26 in 1998, a militant group wearing army fatigues appeared in Wandhama village in central Kashmir’s Ganderbal district.

They engaged in conversation with Kashmiri Pandits and asked them to assemble at one place, before opening fire and killing 23 people, including four children and nine women.

The victims belonged to four families who had stayed back and not migrated from Kashmir when militancy erupted in the Valley in early 1990. They also included five guests who had come from Jammu to visit their relatives in Wandhama.

The police blamed Pakistan-based Lashkar-e-Toiba (LeT) for the massacre. The killings triggered protests by Kashmiri Pandits across Jammu and Delhi. On January 26, 1998, protestors in Delhi marched towards the National Human Rights Commission and clashed with police, leading to injury to nine protestors.

The then Prime Minister, Inder Kumar Gujral, flew to Kashmir and then to Wandhama to join the mourners, accompanied by then Principal Secretary N N Vohra, J&K Chief Minister Farooq Abdullah and Governor K V Krishna Rao.

The police investigation in the case didn’t make any significant progress and it was closed.

The reopening of the Wandhama massacre is the latest case reopened by the investigating agency. Sources say that it has also reopened the case related to the murder of Tika Lal Taploo.

Taploo was killed on September 13, 1989, and is considered the first targeted killing in the Valley. The 59-year-old Taploo, an advocate by profession, was the BJP’s Vice President for Jammu and Kashmir and also a member of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS).

Over the last three years, the investigating agency has reopened several cases related to the killings of the Kashmiri Pandits. In 2023, the agency reopened the case of Neelkanth Ganjoo. A retired judge, Ganjoo was killed on November 4, 1989, in Srinagar. He is believed to have been targeted as he had sentenced Jammu and Kashmir Liberation Front founder Maqbool Bhat to death in 1968. Bhat was finally hanged in 1988 and buried inside Tihar Jail.

In August, 2025, the SIA reopened the case of Sarla Bhat, a Kashmiri Pandit nurse working at the Sher-e-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences (SKIMS) in Srinagar. She was abducted by terrorists from her hostel on April 18, 1990, and her body was found the next day with multiple bullet wounds.

While there has not been much progress in Ganjoo’s case, the SIA has filed a chargesheet in the killing of Bhat and charged five JKLF operatives, including its chief Yasin Malik.

In 2017, the Supreme Court had dismissed a petition by Roots in Kashmir, a Kashmiri Hindu organisation, to re-open and investigate the killing of Kashmiri Pandits in the Valley. A bench comprising the then Chief Justice J S Khehar and Justice D Y Chandrachud had said that with nearly three decades having passed since the Pandit exodus from the Valley, evidence “is unlikely to be available”.

The petition had sought “transfer of all the FIRs/cases pertaining to murders of Kashmiri Pandits” by militants since the inception of insurgency out of J&K, and their handling by “some other independent investigating agency like the CBI or NIA”.

A curative petition filed by Roots of Kashmir was also dismissed by the apex court in 2022.

Seven months after the petition was dismissed, the SIA opened the first case, of Ganjoo.

epaper.indianexpress.com New Delhi

Another rainy day, same old story



Schools, shops hit, Capital sees massive waterlogging & snarls

Sophiya Mathew & Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, August 24

SCHOOLGIRLS WADING through waist-deep murky water, holding onto each other for balance, and pushing a stalled white school van at an inundated neighborhood road — this is how the morning started in Southeast Delhi's Sangam Vihar on Monday for some students.

Just down the road, at the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) primary school in Deoli, which caters to nearly 800 children across two shifts, chaotic scenes unfolded as the morning bell rang. While teachers and staff reported for duty, classes had to be abruptly called off after heavy downpour submerged the school ground under deep, muddy water that did not recede even by late evening.

Across Delhi-NCR, heavy rain triggered widespread disruption, waterlogging and traffic jams, causing inconvenience to residents and commuters. At Safdarjung base station in the Capital, 34.6 mm of rain was reported between 8:30 am and 8:30 pm. According to IMD officials, Janakpuri and Ayanagar recorded the highest rainfall at 70 mm and 66 mm, respectively.

Road caves in, parts of city flooded

Speaking to *The Indian Express* on the flooding of the ground, a senior official at the Deoli school on condition of anonymity said, "During the monsoon, this happens at least twice or thrice a month." He attributed this to a maintenance-related issue of the school's rain water harvesting system.

The surrounding belt of Durga Vihar, Deoli, and Sangam Vihar also saw pervasive flooding, engulfing narrow alleyways. At Main Market Durga Vihar and A-block basement commercial shops remained shut with water accumulating at doorsteps, while on Ashoka Avenue and Raju Park in C Block, residents struggled to drive through the narrow streets.

"I have lived here for 50 years, and the neglect remains the same," said Shanti (70), a resident of Raju Park.

"Earlier this month, residents had to pool their own money to lay a drainage pipe because repeated appeals to departments yielded no progress. Just recently, a small child fell into an open drain and was about to drown before a passerby pulled him out."

In C Block Deoli Pahadi Road, a section of the road caved in amid the downpour, prompting Delhi Jal Board (DJB) to

rush for emergency repairs. In Deoli village, resident Jagdish Anand alleged that house walls have developed cracks due to delayed sewer excavations.

The recurrent flooding in Sangam Vihar and adjoining settlements stems from several reasons. DJB in multiple submissions previously informed the National Green Tribunal (NGT) that sewer laying across parts of Sangam Vihar face severe delays.

Key bottlenecks include forest-land restrictions requiring clearances from the Ridge Management Board, pending road-cutting permissions, and local encroachments. While peripheral trunk sewers exist along main arterial routes, internal feeder connectivity lags, with deadlines in several pockets pushed to 2027. The resulting mix of sewage and stormwater regularly chokes natural outflow. As per officials, ongoing Phase-IV Delhi Metro construction work near Sainik Farms has also temporarily disrupted local drainage, with construction barricades trapping runoff and triggering severe waterlogging and vehicular logjams at the Deoli Mor intersection.

Deja vu at Sadar Bazar

In Central Delhi's wholesale hub of Sadar Bazar, scenes were

eerily reminiscent of last month's inundation. Along the Qutub Road-Teliwara Akhara stretch, porters submerged waist-deep hauled heavy commercial goods on their heads and backs to dry ground, while shopkeepers frantically bailed water out of flooded basements.

MCD officials noted that Sadar Bazar relies on an aging combined drainage system with limited capacity.

Responding to the citywide waterlogging, Public Works Department (PWD) officials said intensive pre-monsoon preparedness and field monitoring have helped reduce critical waterlogging spots across Delhi from 194 to 65, and recurrent locations from 53 down to 20.

To clear the accumulated water, Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) deployed one dewatering pump, PWD positioned two to three pumps near Azadpur Market Chowk, and the MCD pressed a tractor-mounted pump alongside a diesel unit provided to the RWA. Iron safety covers were placed over three open manholes at Teliwara to prevent accidents, with joint field inspections scheduled with PWD consultants to integrate the stretch into Phase I of the comprehensive drainage master plan.



School children wade through a flooded street in Sangam Vihar in New Delhi; (above) fleet of school buses stuck at a waterlogged stretch near Gurgaon's Subhash Chowk on Monday.

TASHI TOBGYAL, ABHIMANYU HAZARIKA

• Skywatch



Forecast: August 25, 2026

Generally cloudy sky. Very light to light rain.

MAX: 34-36

1.9°C above normal

MIN: 25-27

1.4°C above normal

• **Sunrise:** 5:56 AM (August 26)

• **Sunset:** 6:51 PM (August 25)

• **Moonrise:** 5:16 PM (August 25)

• **Moonset:** 3:56 AM (August 26)

• AQI Tracker



Anand Vihar

Poor
AQI: 254



Rohini

Moderate
AQI: 118



Pusa

Moderate
AQI: 123



Najafgarh

Satisfactory
AQI: 77

● Good (0-50)

● Satisfactory (51-100)

● Moderate (101-200)

● Poor (201-300)

● Very Poor (301-400)

● Severe (401-500)

● Severe (401-500)

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Two days on, boy who fell into drain remains untraced; MCD engineer suspended

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, August 24

A JUNIOR engineer with the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) was suspended Monday for "dereliction of duty" two days after a 15-year-old fell into an open drain in South East Delhi's Jasola on Saturday, as the boy could not be traced even on the second day of the search operation.

The boy, Mithun Kumar, had fallen into the drain on Saturday morning while chasing a kite.

Search operations were conducted through Sunday and Monday.

Mithun is a Class 8 student. His father, Awadhesh, is a migrant from Badaun in Uttar Pradesh and works as a labourer in Delhi. On Sunday, a heart-breaking video clip surfaced as Awadhesh, in a desperate bid to save his son, entered the drain.

He said on Monday that the family had lost hope of their son being found alive. "We know we won't find our child safe and sound. We are just hoping to get his body so our hearts can find some peace," the father said.

His wife, Anitha, was inconsolable.

"It has been two days, and I haven't seen his face. He was a very good boy. He used to even correct his teachers if they got their questions wrong," the grieving mother said.

The MCD issued the order suspending one of its junior engineers on Monday evening. The Chief Minister's Office stated that this action was taken based on CM Rekha Gupta's instructions.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta expresses strong displeasure and deep sorrow over this incident. She directed the Chief Secretary to provide information about the drain in question within an hour and suspend the guilty officer," read a statement by the CMO.

The rescue operation, which entered its second day Monday, was carried out by the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), Delhi Fire Services (DFS) and the Delhi Disaster Management Authority (DDMA).

Two earthmovers and a mini-lorry were stationed along the drain, while Awadhesh

At least 12 school buses go under in Gurgaon, children stranded for hours

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, August 24

AT LEAST 12 school buses stuck on a stretch near Subhash Chowk for more than two hours, forcing parents and children to wade through knee-deep water; traffic jams and waterlogging across key parts of the city and safety hazards due to what residents attributed to loose electric wires on poles and in meters — these were the scenes that Gurgaon witnessed as 52 mm of rain between 8 am and 5 pm halted business as usual.

The gridlocks caused by the downpour prompted the district administration to issue a work-from-home advisory for private offices on Tuesday. Schools have been advised to hold online classes.

Meetu Gupta, a resident of Uniworld Gardens Society in Sector 47, said she waded through a water-logged area for around 20 minutes to reach Rail Vihar where her daughter, a Class 12 student, was stranded in a school bus for nearly one-and-a-half hours. Her daughter, a student of Heritage Xperiential Learning School in Sector 62, was among a large number of schoolchildren stranded as a dozen school buses were unable to navigate the inundated corridor. The other buses stuck included those of Suncity School; Delhi Public School Sushant Lok; Shikshantar School; and GD Goenka Public School.

Gupta stepped out of the society with another parent and brought back eight students with them when they realised that the buses were stuck.

"One of the buses had broken down, which is why others were not able to move. Students were stranded without food. My daughter was exhausted and had body pain," Gupta said, adding, "I and another parent took 7-8 children, who are my daughter's friends and were willing to come to our society. Many other students were stuck till nearly 6 pm. It was so concerning, given

the ongoing Metro construction work. What was sad was there seemed to be no police deployment, despite the Sadar station close by."

Upscale areas flooded

Several upscale areas were inundated, including Golf Course Road, Artemis Road, and the internal roads of Sector 52, 45 and 55, the roads around Galleria and Super Mart, apart from the usual hotspot of Sheetla Mata Road.

Municipal Corporation of Gurugram Commissioner Pradeep Dahiya said a 300-to-400-metre cross-section drain near Medanta is yet to be constructed by the Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA), leaving the stretch vulnerable. "However, given the heavy 75mm rain received in a couple of hours, the water did subside speedily. A place remains a pain point if water doesn't drain," he said, pointing to Narsinghpur as being a previous waterlogging hotspot that was clear this time.

Dahiya, along with MCG and GMDA officials visited Subhash Chowk at 10 pm, and gave instructions to the officers to work towards solutions for waterlogging in the area.

When contacted, GMDA officials said their on-ground teams cleared accumulated water from all main road stretches and undertook drainage inlet cleaning to prevent further water accumulation. "Traffic movement soon returned to normal..." a GMDA spokesperson claimed.

However, snarls were observed throughout the day across the Delhi-Gurgaon Expressway and Sohna Road.

Meanwhile, in DLF Phases 1 and 2, tree feelings were reported. "Many electricity meters on poles Outside House at Arjun Marg (Phase 1) are open. During the rainy season, if due to small spark or loose connections, they catch fire, it can cause a big mishap", Deepak Bajaj, a resident of Arjun Marg said.

Pragynesh

New Delhi, August 24

ON THE afternoon of April 17, a retired Armyman was settling in for a siesta at his home in Southwest Delhi's Munirka when the landline in the hall rang. "You have not paid your electricity bill. Call this number or the connection will be cut," the caller said. He gave the 78-year-old man a number before hanging up. The man thought it was odd since he had already paid his bill. He and his wife lived alone.

Their two daughters were married and settled in Dubai. Unsure whom to check with, he thought of his children but decided it would be pointless to make an international call over something so trivial.

So, he called the number. It was the beginning of a 48-hour digital arrest in which the couple would be harried, cornered, isolated and finally coerced into handing over their entire savings Rs 15.5 lakh to men posing as CBI officers using an old trick — the Jet Airways founder Naresh Goyal case.

The call from Mumbai

Police said when the retired Armyman called the number, a voice told him that his name had surfaced in a money laundering case involving Goyal.

"We have found that you gave your account details to Goyal, and all his money was sent to foreign accounts through your account," he was told, according to police officers. The retired Armyman said he

• HIGH-VALUE SCAMS OF 2026

JAN: The biggest cybercrime of 2026 in Delhi, till May 2026, involved a Rs 14-crore digital arrest of an octogenarian couple — Om Taneja, 81, and Indira, 77 — living in Greater Kailash.

JAN: A 70-year-old woman was duped of over Rs 7 crore in Delhi's Greater Kailash after a week-long "digital arrest" by

scammers posing as ED officials.

APRIL: 76-year-old woman from Alaknanda in South Delhi was contacted by scammers claiming to be from Mumbai Police and the ED. They told her that her accounts had been used to fund the terrorist who carried out the Pahalgam attacks last year. She lost over Rs 43 lakh.



had no idea anything like this had happened. He then received a video call from a 'CBI official in Mumbai'.

"A man appeared on screen, claiming to be DCP Anil Kumar from the CBI. He had a fake CBI office set up behind him, complete with a large emblem on the wall, and was wearing a uniform. He and another man, who he called SI Vijay, told the victim that he had been charged under the Foreign Exchange Management Act and Money Laundering Act," said a police officer.

Police said that when the victim pleaded innocence, the men sent him photographs of places around his house — including the entrance to his society and a glass office building metres from his home.

"They told him that a team was in Delhi to arrest him unless he cooperated, and that was why they were sending these pictures. But the two men had downloaded the photographs from Google," said an investigating officer. The couple were now

under digital arrest. Police said they were sent a fake notice from the Enforcement Directorate and asked to share their KYC details and medical records to 'DCP Anil' while remaining on video call.

On April 18, police said, the scammers claimed to have good news. "We have moved court for your anticipatory bail. But now your money needs to be verified. We will give you an RBI account number. You transfer whatever you have in it. The RBI will return it post verification," the men told the victim, as per police. The victim transferred Rs 15.5 lakh, and was sent a 'bail order' from the Bombay High Court. The call was then cut. "When his money didn't come back after two days of him constantly calling the scammers, he came to the police," said the officer. A case was registered.

Targeting the elderly

Officers said the spike in crimes against the elderly began in the new decade as families

became more nuclear.

As per an officer, almost every month in 2026, they have been seeing at least two to three major cyber frauds targeting elderly people. "The problem is even more severe in upscale localities. Scammers and robbers know that many of the people here are affluent, and their children are either in high-stakes jobs that keep them busy or they are in foreign countries," said the officer.

The latest National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) data backs the trend of crimes against senior citizens, with Delhi reporting more such cases than any other metro city in India. As per the data, crimes against senior citizens in Delhi dipped marginally, from 1,361 cases in 2023 to 1,267 in 2024. The city, however, continued to top the list among metropolitan cities. The 1,267 cases accounted for just over 30% of the 4,107 crimes against senior citizens reported in metropolitan cities. And the retired Armyman's case is among the high-profile digital arrest cases registered in Delhi this year. (See box)

Following the money

During their probe, police traced the Rs 15.50 lakh transferred by the victim to a current account in Ludhiana belonging to a man named Sarbjit, 38.

Police picked up Sarbjit for questioning. He allegedly told investigators that he had handed over the account to cyber fraudsters through an intermediary. That intermediary,

police said, was Suraj (30).

Suraj allegedly told investigators that he had been introduced to another man, Naresh alias Lucky, through Telegram and had ultimately passed the account and its banking kit to him. The trail then led investigators to Jaipur. Police said Sarbjit, Suraj and a third man, a bank official named Sandeep, travelled to Jaipur to hand over the account kit to Naresh.

Sandeep (32) allegedly used his banking-sector contacts and knowledge to facilitate the procurement of current accounts. Police suspect these accounts were then passed through several intermediaries before reaching cyber-fraud operators based abroad.

All three were arrested, and a police team subsequently nabbed Naresh from Rajasthan. During questioning, police said he allegedly admitted that he procured current accounts from Suraj through Telegram and supplied them to cyber-fraud operators based in Cambodia and the UAE.

This, police said, revealed the wider structure of the network — people willing to provide bank accounts for commissions, intermediaries who collect and transfer the accounts, and overseas operators who used them to receive proceeds of cyber fraud. Police, however, are yet to recover the money. Police said the current account was allegedly linked to 17 complaints involving fraudulent transactions running into crores.



Search operations underway in Jasola; Missing 15-year-old boy Mithun Kumar. EXPRESS

paced up and down, frantically making calls to relatives. Mud, plastic waste and debris choked the gaping drain.

The search operation was paused in the afternoon when heavy rainfall lashed the city. The wait further agitated the distraught family.

"They say they have stopped midway due to the rain. They gave the same excuse yesterday and the day before. Had they put more effort, we would have found our child's body by now," said Awadhesh.

DCP (South East) Vinit Kumar said that rescue operation is "ongoing without any delay" and will continue until the child is found.

A police officer present at the site, meanwhile, said: "We are now laying soil to create a path for the excavators to remove the waste from the drains. We have searched all other possible areas."

Three arrested for gangrape of 17-year-old girl in MP's Pachmarhi

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, August 24

A 17-YEAR-OLD GIRL was allegedly gangraped by three men after she was taken, along with a male acquaintance, to a secluded forest area in Pachmarhi — a famous tourist spot in Madhya Pradesh — last week. Police have arrested all three accused within six hours of the survivor reporting the incident, officials said on Monday.

According to police, the girl was returning home with an acquaintance when a friend of the latter arrived with two other men. The three allegedly took the girl and her acquaintance to a secluded spot where they allegedly intimidated them and sexually assaulted the teenager. The accused allegedly later dropped them back and threatened them against revealing the incident before anyone.

The incident came to light after the girl approached Pachmarhi police and reported the alleged assault. Following her complaint, multiple police teams were deployed and all three accused were arrested within six hours, police said.

"The three accused have confessed to the crime and are now being produced before the court," said Narmadapuram Additional Superintendent of Police Abhishek Rajan.

Naga-Kuki crossfire: CRPF SI shot at in Manipur

Express News Service
Imphal, August 24

A SUB-INSPECTOR of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) sustained a bullet injury to his left foot as fresh violence broke out along the border of Senapati, a Naga-dominated district, and adjoining areas of Kuki-Zo-dominated Kangpokpi district on Monday.

Pradeep Singh of the 36th Battalion was deployed at an outpost in Matanmai Naga village, Senapati, near the border with Taphou Kuki in Kangpokpi district. According to preliminary reports, he was hit in crossfire between the Naga and Kuki village sides. He is undergoing treatment at District Hospital, Senapati.

The violence began at around 2.40 am at Taphou Kuki, where a house was allegedly set on fire by unidentified persons. Fire and emergency services personnel reached around 3.30 am. Further incidents were reported around 4 am in Mareimei area on the Senapati side. A house belonging to Nagas was reportedly set ablaze and another demolished by unidentified persons.

The situation escalated at around 9 am when firing broke out. Security forces have since been deployed in Taphou and adjoining areas. The violence has disrupted traffic along NH-2, the Imphal-Dimapur highway connecting Manipur and Nagaland. Transport services on NH-2 had resumed only last Friday after three years following the ethnic violence that erupted in May 2023.

• KUNNUMMAL'S APPOINTMENT, WHICH HAS BEEN CHALLENGED BY BOTH CONGRESS AND CPI(M), HAS BEEN VIEWED AS THE GOVERNOR'S STEP TOWARDS 'SAFFRONISING' HIGHER EDUCATION IN THE STATE

Who is Mohanan Kunnummal, Kerala V-C at centre of repeated controversies

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, August 24

"ARE YOU cockroaches or lions?" Kerala University of Health Sciences (KUHS) Vice-Chancellor Dr Mohanan Kunnummal repeatedly asked students during a recent award ceremony in Thiruvananthapuram.

When a video of students sitting unresponsive went viral, it added a new episode to the growing controversies around Kunnummal, who has found himself at the centre of recurring tensions between the Governor's office and Kerala government, of the Left and now the Congress, over the last few years. A medical professional

Tejpal should have surrendered before filing appeal, Goa tells SC

Tejpal, convicted of raping journalist in 2013, said there was no need for him to surrender as HC had given him 4 weeks

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

THE GOA government on Monday told the Supreme Court (SC) that former editor-in-chief of Tehelka magazine, Tarun Tejpal — found guilty of raping a female journalist in 2013 and sentenced to 10 years rigorous imprisonment — should have surrendered before filing an appeal challenging the conviction.

Solicitor General (SG) Tusshar Mehta, appearing for the state, took the stand before a single-judge bench of Justice Alok Aradhe, which took up Tejpal's application seeking exemption.

Appearing for the convict, senior advocate Kapil Sibal urged that the appeal be listed for hearing on August 31. The Bombay High Court (HC) while sentencing him on Au-

gust 6 had given Tejpal four weeks to surrender.

Opposing this, Mehta pointed out the appeal will not stand unless he surrenders. He contended that Order XX Rule 3 of the Supreme Court Rules, 2013, is mandatory in nature, in view of which, until and unless the appellant surrenders, the appeal cannot be listed before the court.

Citing a two-judge bench judgment of the SC, which held the provision to be mandatory, the SG said that until and unless suitable orders are passed on the application seeking exemption from surrender, cannot be accepted, Mehta argued.



Following Tejpal's acquittal in 2021, the Goa govt appealed to the HC, which reversed the trial court's conclusions

Countering this, Sibal said there was no need to surrender as the HC had given Tejpal a window of four weeks.

"The rule does not apply because this is a case where stay has been granted by the High Court, so there is no question of applying this rule. Suppose the Court says no stay, I will have to go to jail.

What's the pleasure in saying I must surrender and then appeal, when the High Court itself granted a stay and the order stands?" the senior counsel contended.

The court, after hearing both sides, said Sibal "has not addressed" it "on the merits of the application seeking exemption from surrender. With a view to afford him an opportunity to address the Court on the aforesaid interlocutory application, list the same for consideration on 25.08.2026".

The case dates back to November 2013, when Tejpal allegedly assaulted the survivor on two separate occasions inside the lift of a hotel in Goa while the two were alone during a literary festival.

He was acquitted of all charges by an Additional Sessions court in Mapusa in May 2021. Then, the court had said the woman's messages to the accused established that she was "neither traumatised nor terrified" and that this "completely belies" the prosecution's case.

The Goa government appealed to the High Court, which reversed the trial court's conclusions and convicted him. The latter said "the trial court proceeded on a notion that a victim of sexual assault must behave in a stereotypical manner".

The HC further noted that the appreciation of evidence by the trial court was "not only unreasonable, but perverse", and criticised it for permitting an "invasive, humiliating cross-examination into the victim's past sexual history, moral views, and personal WhatsApp messages, directly violating statutory embargoes... that prohibit questioning a victim's character or past relationships".

Challenging this, Tejpal, said in his appeal before the SC that the HC judgement is "erroneous, misconceived, contrary to facts and the record, and is directly contrary to settled law".

Recently, the Goa government moved the SC for an enhancement of Tejpal's punishment by seeking life term.

• BRIEFLY



Wreckage of a tractor-trolley that fell off a bridge in Dhar district of Madhya Pradesh on Monday. PTI

MADHYA PRADESH

Kanwariya dies, 21 injured as tractor-trolley falls off bridge

A 42-YEAR-OLD Kanwariya died and 21 others were injured, two of them in critical state, after a tractor-trolley carrying them fell off a bridge in Madhya Pradesh's Dhar district on Monday, police said. Kukshi Sub-Divisional Officer of Police Sunil Gupta said the deceased, Rajendra Patidar succumbed to injuries at a hospital in Barwani. Initial investigations suggest the tractors steering failed, causing the vehicle to fall off the bridge, he added. More than 30 devotees were travelling in the tractor-trolley when the accident occurred. PTI

Tree branch falls on 3 in Kolkata hospital, 1 dead

A WOMAN died and two persons were injured after a tree branch fell on them inside the state-run SSKM Hospital premises on Monday, a police officer said. The deceased, Rahida Bibi, had come from Nalhati in Birbhum to look after a relative admitted to the hospital. It happened outside the urology department amid intermittent rain and strong winds in Kolkata and several parts of south Bengal under the influence of a low-pressure area. Two persons were injured in the incident and are undergoing treatment, he said. The Kolkata Police officer said no complaint has so far been filed. PTI

Saveetha top Indian varsity in Shanghai list

SAVEETHA UNIVERSITY has emerged as the number one institute in India and secured a prestigious position in the 501-600 global ranking band in the Shanghai Academic Ranking of World Universities (ARWU) 2026. The Shanghai ARWU ranks universities based on academic and research performance indicators, including alumni and staff winning Nobel prizes, field medals, researchers, papers published in Nature and Science journals, papers indexed in major citation indices, and the per capita academic performance of the institution. Over 2,500 universities were assessed worldwide. ENS

Two days after ship sank off Odisha coast, no trace of 22 crew members yet

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, August 24

IT'S A RACE against time in the Bay of Bengal, where over 150 personnel of the Indian Coast Guard and a surveillance aircraft of the Indian Navy are mounting a massive search and rescue operation for 22 crew members of a merchant vessel, which sank off the Odisha coast late on Saturday.

Coast Guard sources said that with no breakthrough so far in the search for the crew members of MV Ocean Winner, they have expanded their area of operation.

"As the operation progresses, it's a standard practice to expand the search area based on the inputs from the previous area of search. So far, there has been no update on the whereabouts of the 22 missing crew members," Coast Guard spokesperson Commandant Amit Uniyal told *The Indian Express*.

Two crew members, identified as Chinese nationals, were rescued on Saturday itself. In

the joint search operation, the Indian Coast Guard has deployed three ships with around 150 personnel while the Eastern Naval Command has deployed an aircraft — P8I — on surveillance sortie.

Coast Guard sources said rough sea conditions in the middle of the Bay of Bengal are hampering the search and rescue by limiting visibility. Also, the mishap occurred where the sea is known to be deep, making the search and rescue operation more challenging.

MV OCEAN WINNER sank around 230 nautical miles (425 km) from the Paradip coast of Odisha. It was carrying more than 72,000 tonnes of iron ore from Odisha to China with a stop at Singapore. It left Paradip Port early on Friday morning.

On the two rescued seafarers, an official source said, "The crew members — both Chinese nationals — are most likely to be brought to Paradip Port in a day or two. The next move will be decided after consultation at the top level."

CM Majhi pledges justice for slain VHP leader Laxmananda Saraswati



Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi, former Union minister Dharmendra Pradhan and others during the birth centenary celebrations of Laxmananda Saraswati in Angul district. EXPRESS

spending around 10 years in jail.

Kandhamal killings

On August 23, 2008, 20-25 masked people gunned down the Saraswati, 84, and his four aides at his ashram at Kandhamal's Jalespeta. The ashram inmates were celebrating Janmashtami. The VHP leader, who had led a campaign against cow slaughter and conversion of tribals into Christianity, had received threats and even faced an attack before his murder. Saraswati, who had come to the tribal-dominated Kandhamal in the late 1960s, had set up ashrams and kanyashrams (residential girls' schools) in Jalespeta to educate tribal girls.

His killing triggered large-scale communal violence that claimed at least 39 lives and displaced over 25,000 people. Many churches, prayer halls and houses were torched or damaged. The riots strained the ties between the then ruling partners BJD, led by CM Naveen

Patnaik, and BJP, who had been in an alliance since 2000, leading to Patnaik snapping ties with BJP a month before the 2009 Assembly and Lok Sabha polls.

In September 2008, the Patnaik government constituted a judicial inquiry commission, led by former Orissa High Court judge Justice S C Mohapatra, to probe into Saraswati's killing and subsequent riots. After Mohapatra's demise, this inquiry was handed over to another retired judge Justice A S Naidu. Even though the Naidu commission submitted its report in December 2015, it was not made public by the Patnaik government that remained in power till June 2024.

The BJP that demanded a CBI probe into Saraswati's killing while in Opposition stormed to power in Odisha in 2024. After two years at the helm, the BJP government on June 10, 2026, filed an FIR alleging that the two judicial commission reports — including one on the

2008 Saraswati killing and riots and another one on the 2016 fire incident at SUM medical college and hospital — were not available in the CMO and remained untraceable despite searches.

The Majhi government alleged that while several reports and files forwarded by the Home Department to the CMO were returned on June 4, 2024, when the Assembly poll indicating a BJP win became clear, these two reports remained missing. The FIR claimed that the "disappearance" of the reports created a reasonable suspicion that they may have been "intentionally removed, retained, concealed, destroyed or otherwise unlawfully dealt with". The BJP accused the previous BJD government of "intentionally" causing the reports' disappearance while the police also issued summons to at least four retired bureaucrats including VK Pandian, a close Patnaik aide.

Hindutva push

At the Saraswati event on Friday, CM Majhi accused the Patnaik government of "deliberate conspiracy" to shield perpetrators behind disappearance of files. Majhi also raked up the "failure, negligence and appeasement politics" of the BJD dispensation in this regard. "I want to give a firm assurance to the 4.5 crore people of Odisha that the truth behind the incident would certainly be brought to light," he said. The function was also attended by former Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan and a slew of BJP and VHP leaders.

As part of its Hindutva push, the BJP government has named a medical college at Phulbani after Saraswati. A grant of Rs 13 crore has been sanctioned from the CM's special assistance

(CMSA) for redevelopment of ashram, kanyashram and other development works in Kandhamal. The government has also announced its proposal to transform the slain VHP leader's village as a "heritage village".

The BJD hit back at Majhi, accusing him of making "baseless allegations" on the Saraswati murder case. BJD spokesperson Lelin Mohanty said, "The nation knows which party does appeasement politics. State BJP chief Manmohan Samal and ex-governor Biswabhusan Harichandan were a part of the then Patnaik ministry (in 2008). Is the CM pointing towards them as well." The BJD also took a swipe at the Majhi government for "searching for an important Commission report after two years of assuming office". "Has it been deliberately misplaced by the CMO to protect someone from their own organisation," Mohanty asked.

Hailing from Mandasa mandal of Andhra Pradesh's Srikakulam, Azad was involved in Maoist activities since 1990 and worked in Uddanam area of Srikakulam in different roles. He was also an accused in the 2008 Nayagarh police armoury attack — in which at least 14 people, including 13 policemen, were killed; and in 2006 R Udayagiri jail attack. However, he has been acquitted in all these cases.

Azad had surrendered before the Andhra Pradesh police in May 2011. After being handed over to the Odisha police in June 2011, he had been lodged at Jharpada jail in Bhubaneswar for 15 years until his acquittal in the Saraswati murder case. Earlier, the Supreme Court had asked Odisha and Andhra Pradesh governments to set up special courts for speedy disposal of cases against Azad.



Kunnummal is the V-C of Kerala University of Health Sciences and Kerala University

and the state government.

The first battle ground was the University of Kerala in 2022, when Khan formed a search committee for a new V-C as the

specialising in radio-diagnosis for the last three decades, Kunnummal, who is also the V-C of the University of Kerala, on August 22 alleged that "foreign forces" were trying to convert young people to cockroaches.

This cockroach controversy came close on the heels of Kunnummal's remark on *Vande Mataram* at an RSS Sankalp youth summit on Independence Day. Reacting to the Congress-led government's decision to skip the recital of *Vande Mataram* at Kerala's official Independence Day events, Kunnummal said, "When we pray, we say *Vande Mataram*. It is our mother and those who oppose *Vande Mataram* do not know who their mother is."

Over the years, both the

CPI(M) and Congress have challenged Kunnummal's appointments — first as the V-C of KUHS in 2019 and then the additional charge as the V-C of the University of Kerala in 2023 — as part of the Governor's "safronisation of higher education" in Kerala.

In October 2019, then Governor Arif Mohammed Khan picked Kunnummal as the V-C of KUHS, allegedly overlooking the recommendations of a search committee formed by the then Left government. After then Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan assumed office for the Left government's second consecutive term in 2021, the higher education sector had been marked by repeated tussles between the Governor

Kerala Governor in January 2025, Kunnummal had drawn the ire of the Left government over a portrait of Bharat Mata with a saffron flag at a function attended by Aralekar.

On June 25, 2025, socio-cultural outfit Sree Padmanabha Seva Samithi marked 50 years since the Emergency with an event at the University of Kerala attended by Aralekar. University registrar Anil Kumar, who had ordered the cancellation of the programme over a Bharat Mata portrait displayed at a university hall, was suspended by Kunnummal. The incident had sparked protests with the Left alleging that Kunnummal was "proving his loyalty to the RSS".

Things have not changed

much since the Congress-led UDF came to power in May this year. In June, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat addressed a lecture series in Thiruvananthapuram titled "100 Years of Sangh Journey: New Horizons". The event was attended not only by Kunnummal, but also by two other vice-chancellors — MG University V-C in-charge Dr D Mavoothu and Malayalam University V-C in-charge Dr CR Prasad. Chief Minister V D Satheesan said the attendance of the three V-Cs at Bhagwat's event was a "serious lapse" and was not in tune with the state's educational tradition and the dignity of the V-C's post. However, months later, Kunnummal was in attendance at another RSS event on Independence Day.

NIA searches five locations in cyber terror case

New Delhi: The NIA on Monday conducted searches at five locations across five states in connection with the ongoing investigation into a cyber terrorism case registered in Gujarat.

The raids were carried out in Junnar in Pune, Maharashtra; Nadiad in Kheda, Gujarat; Ramagundam in Karimnagar, Telangana; Gopalganj in Bihar; and Delhi. They were in connection with a case registered on June 25, 2025, a NIA spokesperson said.

The accused had attempted a Distributed Denial of Service attack against 54 websites of Government of India entities during the time of Operation Sindoor last year. A DDoS attack is a malicious attempt to disrupt normal traffic to a server, service or network by flooding it with massive illegitimate Internet traffic from compromised sources. **ENS**

Joint elections plan flawed, against basic structure of Constitution: Chidambaram

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

FORMER UNION Minister and senior Congress leader P Chidambaram on Monday told a parliamentary panel that the proposal to hold simultaneous elections in their current form was flawed and undermined the basic structure of the Constitution, particularly the core principles of parliamentary democracy, it is learnt.

He is learnt to have made the submission during a meeting of the joint committee of Parliament on the Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, 2024, and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024, which aim to ensure simultaneous elections to the Lok Sabha and

state Assemblies. The agenda for Monday's meeting included interactions with Chidambaram, Padma Awardees from Delhi, representatives of Nation First Policy Research Centre and representatives of Vidhi Centre for Legal Policy.

Chidambaram, who is also a member of the Rajya Sabha, is learnt to have argued that since any legislature is elected for a five-year term, curtailing its tenure directly violates the basic structure of the Constitution. He also told the panel that his conscience does not allow him to support the Bills and stressed that the government does not have the numbers (two-thirds majority) to pass the legislation, it is learnt. Some members of the committee



P Chidambaram, former Union minister and Congress leader

from the Opposition parties are learnt to have opposed the proposal, claiming it would give too much power to the Election Commission of India.

The joint committee has

BJP MP P P Chaudhary as its chairman, while its members include BJP's Anil Baluni, Sanjay Jaiswal, Congress's Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Manish Tewari, SP's Dharmendra Yadav and TMC's Sagarika Ghose.

On Monday, the committee also had a dialogue with a group of Padma awardees, some of whom supported the proposal while some opposed it.

Speaking in support, one of the awardees is learnt to have said that frequent enforcement of the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) halts developmental projects and emphasised that synchronised elections would ensure uninterrupted regional development.

Speaking to reporters, committee chairperson Chaudhary

said Monday's meeting spanned over seven hours.

"First, we had a discussion of about one and a half to two hours with former Union minister and Rajya Sabha member P Chidambaram. All the members sought clarifications from him, and it was a very healthy and academic discussion. The entire committee, across party lines and rising above ideological differences, is working in the national interest to ensure that the best possible framework for One Nation, One Election is created," said the BJP MP.

The Bills on simultaneous polls were introduced in the Lok Sabha in December 2024, after which they were referred to the joint committee of Parliament for examination.

‘Fish feast’ in Ayodhya sets off political fireworks

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, August 24

A 'FISH bhoj (feast)' organised in Ayodhya by the Nishad community on Sunday has sparked a political row, with Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath accusing state Congress chief Ajay Rai of partaking of the feast and the opposition leader challenging him to show evidence.

The controversy erupted after a purported video of the feast after an event held by Ram Nishad, who joined the Congress last month after leaving the BJP, went viral on social media. The BJP hit out at Rai, saying it was the Hindu holy month of Shravan when many Hindus avoid meat. Rai challenged Adityanath to provide evidence for his allegation or apologise. Ram Nishad, meanwhile, said they have committed "no crime" by eating fish.

Addressing a public meeting in Rae Bareilly on Monday, Adityanath alleged, "We are all devotees of Bajrang Bali. But you must have seen the conduct of the devotees of Babri yesterday. They went to Hanuman Garhi temple and later were seen enjoying a fish feast at one of their offices. This is what they call 'Ram on the lips and a dagger tucked under the arm'." He went on to say that "even a chameleon would be embarrassed by this kind of behaviour". "It would wonder what kind of human species this is — chanting 'Ram-Ram' inside the temple and feasting on fish the moment they step out."

UP Deputy CM Brajesh Patthak told the media, "Ayodhya Dham is our sacred abode, the abode of Lord Ram, and hosting such a feast there, especially during Shravan, reflects the culture of the Congress party."

Congress leaders denied the claim. They said the event was held in Gosaiganj, around 30-

Feast's video triggers BJP-Cong row, with UP CM accusing Opp of insulting Ayodhya and Cong denying that its leaders attended the event

40 km from Ayodhya, and that its leaders did not participate in the subsequent fish feast.

Rai accused the BJP of trying to divert attention from allegations surrounding the alleged theft of donations in Ayodhya. "Does the CM have any photos? If he can produce any pictures, I will be ready to resign immediately... Nishad Samaj invited me to a programme in Ayodhya yesterday. If they were getting fish prepared there, it would be their concern. I attended the programme and returned."

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Nishad said Congress leaders, including Rai and AICC in-charge of UP, Rajendra Pal Gautam, had been invited to the programme to mark his joining of the party. The leaders arrived around 1-2 pm and were served vegetarian food. They left around 3 pm. He said the viral video showed a separate feast organised by members of the Nishad community after the political programme. "We are fishermen. We have committed no crime by eating fish," he said.

Explaining the importance of fish to the Nishad community, he said, "Fish is important to us from birth until death. How can we manage if we do not touch fish for a month? If you want to talk about something, talk about uplifting the community."

"*Nishadon ne machhli banake khaliya to kausa apradh kar liya?*" (What crime have we committed by preparing and eating fish?) he asked.

Suvendu: 10% of CAA applicants got citizenship so far

Express News Service
Kolkata, August 24

CHIEF MINISTER Suvendu Adhikari on Monday said that out of the 2.3 lakh people who applied for citizenship under the amended citizenship law (CAA) in the state, 23,000 (or 10 percent) have been issued citizenship certificates so far, and asserted that hearing of applications will be completed soon.

"This was our promise. We are implementing it. As a result, Hindu refugees who have applied for citizenship will be issued certificates quickly," the CM told mediapersons at Nabanna, the state secretariat.

Notably, only a few days ago, the Centre had issued guidelines assigning the responsibility of issuing citizenship certificates to the district magistrates. Adhikari said, "Through the district magistrates, we will act quickly. Of the 2.30 lakh people, 23,000 have received certificates. And those who have not yet applied will still be able to do so. We will also be able to complete the hearings swiftly and issue certificates to Hindu refugees who came from Bangladesh due to religious persecution."

"Our Hindu refugees, the Matua community, who have long been waiting in hope and brought us to power, will receive the certificates from me. The Government of India has entrusted this responsibility to me," he said, while also denying allegations of discrimination in transferring money to women beneficiaries of the Annapurna

cash-transfer scheme. "Those who are eligible will receive the money (under the Annapurna scheme). Out of nearly 1.45 crore beneficiaries, 19.2 lakh are Muslim families. We do not discriminate. The government has records of what appeasement was practised during the previous (TMC) administration. One lakh eligible women beneficiaries in the Hills of Darjeeling have received financial assistance," Adhikari said amid reports of protests by women in several parts of the state over non-payment of the scheme money.

Reacting to the last week-end's clashes on Jadavpur University campus that took place between ABVP, the RSS's students' wing, and CPI(M)'s SFI, the CM said, "Normal classes have been held at Jadavpur University. There is no problem there. This will not be tolerated here. One must engage in nationalist activities. Things like 'Red Salute' to (Maoist leader) Kishenji will not be allowed." He said that he will personally visit the JU campus next Friday and sing 'Vande Mataram' there.

Adhikari once again targeted the Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress. "A lot remains to be done. The corrupt aunt-nephew duo was at the peak of corruption. The harshest punishment will be given to thieves. The work of confiscating the property acquired through theft, auctioning it, and returning it to the government treasury is still pending," Adhikari said. "Can everything be done in 110 days? It has only been three months."

JU still tense, CM says probe 'anti-national' graffiti on campus

Tanusree Bose & Atri Mitra
Kolkata, August 24

AMID THE simmering tension at Kolkata's Jadavpur University (JU) following last week's clash between ABVP and SFI supporters, West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Monday expressed "concerns" over "anti-national wall graffiti and drawings" on the campus, and directed the state university authorities to probe and carry out on-ground physical verification of students.

The CM's directive came soon after a meeting called by the university's vice-chancellor Chiranjib Bhattacharjee of all the stakeholders ended in a stalemate on Monday night.

In a post on X, Adhikari

wrote, "The CMO has received concerning videos and photographic representations through the CM's Grievance Cell from conscientious Students of Jadavpur University, reporting instances of objectionable, sociopathic, violent and Anti-National wall graffiti & drawings inside the Arts Division Boys Hostel premises."

"...Under no circumstances will campus premises be permitted to be used as platforms for spreading deranged propaganda and Anti-India sentiment," CM Adhikari wrote and asked the university and Principal Secretary of the Higher Education Department to initiate an "immediate inquiry".



Special Bond

Chief Justice of India Justice Surya Kant interacts with a school student ahead of Raksha Bandhan at the Judge's Lounge, Supreme Court, in New Delhi on Monday. **PTI**

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, August 24

IN THE wake of the ruling BJP's setback in Uttar Pradesh in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, several party leaders had flagged "disappointment among BJP workers because of neglect" by the state administration among the factors for its poor performance, while some others had blamed the central leadership's "dominance" in candidate selection for it.

In the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, the BJP's UP tally fell from 62 of 80 seats to 33, while its vote share declined from 49.98% to 41.37%.

BJP national president Nitin Nabin recently constituted a new team of central party office-bearers, giving increased representation to UP leaders in it, including those who have lost previous polls. This is being seen in UP BJP circles as part of the party high command's efforts to improve coordination and synergy between the central and state units in order to smoothen the party's roadmap for the state Assembly polls slated for early 2027. Nabin's new team has eight BJP faces from UP — one more than the previous team — with two representatives each in the groups of vice-presidents, general secretaries and secretaries besides presidents of two morchas — OBC and minorities.

"Four of these eight leaders faced defeat in the 2024 Lok Sabha and 2022 UP Assembly polls. Their elevation cannot be called a challenge for the popularity of CM Yogi Adityanath who has been running the UP government with special focus on law and order for two consecutive terms since 2017. Instead, those leaders will be able to give more time for organisational works in the state. The ultimate goal of both Yogi ji and BJP leadership is winning 2027 Assembly polls and creating a favourable atmosphere for the 2029 Lok Sabha polls," said a BJP leader close to Adityanath.

He said that Rekha Verma, who retained the national vice-president's position, had lost the Lok Sabha poll from Dhaurahra, while new general secretary Smriti Irani had lost her Amethi parliamentary seat in 2024. He also pointed out that another general secretary Harish Dwivedi lost in Basti in the 2024 Lok Sabha election, while new OBC morcha president Amarpal Maurya faced defeat in Unchahar in the 2022 Assembly polls.

Another senior UP BJP leader said barring the second-term national vice-president Tariq Mansoor, other seven office-bearers from the state are aged under 55 years, adding this was as per the party's plan of promoting younger leaders to en-



BJP chief Nitin Nabin's new team of Central party office-bearers has eight BJP faces from CM Yogi Adityanath-led UP government. EXPRESS

able it to connect with the youth and Gen Z more effectively.

On BJP's decision to bring Smriti Irani back into its national leadership, a party leader said, "She is popular among women and youths, she is a good speaker and she has experience of defeating Rahul Gandhi in his bastion Amethi in the past. She can be a good leader to challenge Rahul and another top Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, who are likely to lead the UP campaign for the party."

On Harish Dwivedi's appointment as a new national general secretary, a BJP leader said, "Dwivedi is a Brahmin and an active leader with ABVP background. His appointment holds importance amid reports that there was simmering anger among sections of upper castes

over the new UGC regulations stayed by the Supreme Court. It is known within the party that Dwivedi's relations with CM Adityanath had never been very friendly, but as a young Brahmin face and with his experience of being Assam BJP in-charge and as the in-charge of the upcoming Rajasthan local body elections — he will be helpful for the party in UP polls." Dwivedi was a two-term MP from Basti adjoining Adityanath's home turf Gorakhpur, before losing from his seat in the 2024 election.

Both Rekha Verma, an OBC leader, and Tariq Mansoor, a Pasmanda Muslim, who have retained their vice-president posts, are known for their "non-interference" in the affairs of the UP BJP or the state government, party insiders said.

Why Bihar wants the Farakka treaty scrapped — and why it puts Govt in a bind

Santosh Singh
Patna, August 24

A FRESH diplomatic and political confrontation is brewing in Bihar over the 1996 India-Bangladesh Ganges Water Sharing Treaty, or known colloquially as the Farakka treaty. As the treaty's lapse approaches, Bihar's ruling National Democratic Alliance is pushing against its renewal — a development that could put the BJP-led Centre in a bind.

In the latest push against the pact, Bihar Deputy Chief Minister Vijay Kumar Choudhary, who handles the state's water resources portfolio and who had accompanied CM Samrat Choudhary during a recent meeting with External Affairs

Minister S. Jaishankar in Delhi, told reporters that the state had "expressed our concerns regarding the Farakka treaty and how it has proved detrimental to Bihar's interest". "The Union minister assured us of taking care of our concerns," he said.

This comes after JD(U) national working president and Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Kumar Jha also urged the Centre not to renew the pact. "The Farakka treaty has done enormous harm to Bihar. It is also surprising that the treaty was never reviewed in the last 30 years," Jha told *The Indian Express*. "Bihar suffers floods, heavy siltation and also paucity of water because of it. Now that we are in the phase of industrialisation, we need rational use of water.

During summers, when we need water for ourselves, we have to concede water to Bangladesh as per the treaty."

The Farakka Water Treaty (officially called the Ganges Water Sharing Treaty) is a bilateral deal signed on December 12, 1996, between India and Bangladesh that regulates the sharing of the Ganga waters at the Farakka Barrage in West Bengal, India, primarily during the dry season from January 1 to May 31. The treaty expires in December.

The barrage was built in 1975 to divert water from the Ganga into the Hooghly River to flush out silt and to keep Kolkata Port navigable. However, this reduced downstream river flow into Bangladesh, causing severe water shortages, increased soil



The treaty has done enormous harm to Bihar: JD(U) working president and RS MP Sanjay Kumar Jha, who has urged the Centre not to renew the pact

salinity, and ecological stress in southern Bangladesh. The 1996 treaty established a 30-year bind-

ing framework (1996–2026) to replace earlier short-term stopgap arrangements and ensure predictable water distribution.

Unlike the earlier 1977 temporary deal, the 1996 treaty lacks a "minimum flow guarantee clause". If total flow falls drastically below 50,000 cusecs, the treaty only calls for immediate emergency consultations between both governments. Siltation, reduced groundwater discharge, upstream water withdrawal, and erratic rainfall patterns have altered the river's actual availability in Bihar compared to 1996 baseline levels.

For two decades, the Bihar government has been flagging concerns over the barrage with the Centre — first under Nitish Kumar and now under

Samrat Choudhary. The government argues that the structure has created a severe "flood-and-parch" dynamic upstream, and that the heavy silt trapped behind the barrage has drastically elevated the Ganges riverbed, destroying its natural water storage capacity and driving severe seasonal floods into surrounding districts like Bhagalpur and Munger during monsoons.

Pushing against renewal, Jha argued that Bihar's projected water needs up to 2050 be prioritised and that any future diplomatic arrangement must include a comprehensive National Silt Management Policy and direct representation for the state.

The mounting domestic pressure from NDA coalition partner JD(U) comes at a deli-

cate moment for Delhi's foreign policy. For his part, Jaishankar has stressed that neighbourhood relations must be navigated through "mutual interest" and "common ground".

At a recent media conclave, Jaishankar, while responding to questions on complex bilateral issues — from Bangladesh's demands for stronger downstream guarantee clauses to wider diplomatic discussions — noted that for any international relationship to function smoothly, both sides must establish a shared landing point.

But even as the state's NDA alliance mounts pressure on the Centre, Bihar's Principal Opposition, the Rashtriya Janata Dal, has been highlighting a 2011 parliamentary speech by

party chief Lalu Prasad in which he demanded the dismantling of the barrage.

"We are only reproducing what is already in the public domain. Now all eyes are on the NDA government at the Centre, which faces a tight balancing act between regional flood management at home and strategic neighbourhood diplomacy abroad," an RJD leader told *The Indian Express*.

JD(U) chief spokesperson Neeraj Kumar dismissed this as "immaterial". "Why had Lalu Prasad not opposed the treaty in 1996 when the RJD was backing the H D Deve Gowda government with 22 MPs? But what the RJD says and does now is not important — we want the dismantling of the Farakka Barrage."

It is wrong to cancel Telangana CM's US visit

INSTEAD OF heading to Boston as planned on Sunday, Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy abruptly flew back to India from London — he was denied permission by the Ministry of External Affairs for the US tour, which led to the cancellation of the second leg of his foreign trip. Undoubtedly, denying permission lay in the MEA's remit. Before it accords political clearance, the visits of chief ministers and other dignitaries are assessed by the ministry for criteria such as the "purpose" and "level" of scheduled meetings. And yet, it is unseemly that the MEA should weaponise the rulebook's small print to cut short CM Reddy's trip. Apparently, the CM's itinerary included possible meetings with New York City mayor Zohran Mamdani and US Vice President JD Vance — while the NYC mayor is seen at some levels below the Telangana CM, a meeting with the US Vice President did not fit the trip's stated purpose, which was to attract investment into Telangana, including educational partnerships. This is a narrow-minded approach that does not behove the external affairs ministry of a country like India, which prides itself on its growing confidence on the world stage, and on building global knowledge hubs like Hyderabad. Moreover, by curtailing an Opposition chief minister's foreign trip, the government looks small and heavy-handed, sending a dispiriting signal to the world — and within the country.

The denial of permission to CM Reddy can be seen as part of a dismal pattern of antagonism, and the near breakdown of dialogue, between government and Opposition at home. This is so even as Reddy, the second CM of a newly carved out state, who began his career in the ABVP, has been seen to tweak the script — in the past, he has struck a note of pragmatism and cordiality vis-a-vis the government of Narendra Modi. In the aftermath, the political to-and-fro has seen the recycling of tired and opaque spectres and prejudices — the BJP in Telangana has insinuated that the MEA decision was meant to cut short engagement with "anti-India" and/or "anti-BJP" elements, that are out to destabilise "national security".

After Operation Sindoor in May 2025, the Modi government dispatched seven multi-party delegations, which included prominent leaders of the Opposition, to foreign capitals. They were tasked with making India's case to the world while projecting national unity. The subject, then, was terror, but the message was more generally heartening: That whatever be the political differences within, India's ruling establishment trusted and included the Opposition in its dealings with the world. CM Reddy's abbreviated trip now points to an unfortunate and unflattering backsliding.

In saying no to Trump, Carney does right thing

BY INSTRUCTING his negotiators to walk away from trade talks with the US — reportedly over Washington's last-minute demands — Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has drawn a red line against President Donald Trump's weaponisation of tariffs. Canada's economy is deeply integrated with that of its superpower neighbour, and Carney's "dollar-for-dollar" retaliation against Trump's 50 per cent tariffs on around \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods will inevitably hurt businesses and workers on both sides of the border. Among other "unacceptable" demands, said PM Carney, Washington seeks to restrict Canada's ability to pursue trade deals with other countries, which would amount to an erosion of Canadian sovereignty. Elected to power not too long ago on a promise to stand up to Trump's threats, Carney has done the right thing by rejecting an unequal trade relationship. In doing so, he is also acting on his assessment at Davos seven months ago: The "rules-based order", he had said, "is fading".

The Trump tariffs touch products from Canadian wine and dairy to furniture, clothing, cement and hockey equipment. Should Carney proceed with Canada's retaliation from September 8 onwards, there will be risks, both political and economic, for his country. But the popularity of the "Buy Canadian" campaign — an expression of economic nationalism triggered by Trump's threats, including making Canada the 51st state of the US — has already shown that many Canadians support their government's challenge to the US president. Carney will now have to convince them that the costs of confrontation are worth paying.

For the Canadian PM, the showdown with Trump is the clearest test yet of his thesis that middle powers must stand up to great powers and unite. Indeed, he has been busy securing deals in Asia and Europe, a paradigm shift away from Canada's economic dependence on the US so far. It is too early to say whether these new partnerships have the substance to mitigate the pain that a breakdown in US-Canada relations will cause. But Carney is doing something rather rare in the Trump era: A middle power is saying no to a superpower.

The humanoid's winning the race. Or is it?

WHO WOULD win in a fight, Mike Tyson or a silver-back gorilla? It's a question many have asked, including Tyson himself. Back in the 1980s, the boxing legend was strolling through a zoo with his wife when he came across the ape enclosure, where one big silverback was bullying all the others. Tyson tried to bribe the attendant with \$10,000, the story goes, to open the cage so he could fight the animal, but the employee declined. That was undoubtedly for the best — even the greatest human fighter wouldn't last long against a larger, stronger and more vicious animal.

If human athletes shouldn't be judged on their ability to out-fight a gorilla, they shouldn't be expected to outrace a machine, either. Given that, what's the need for a brouhaha over two Chinese humanoid robots beating Usain Bolt's 100m world record at the World Humanoid Robot Games in Beijing this past weekend? Smartphone maker Honor's robot, Lightning, came second with a time of 9.47s, whereas the winner, Tiangong Ultra, developed by the Beijing Humanoid Robot Innovation Centre, clocked 9.39s, compared to Bolt's 9.58s. Someone on a motorbike, another machine, could have done the same.

That aside, the robot games offered their share of finish-line drama — Tiangong careening into the sidelines, Lightning having to be carried away on the stretcher — and there's no reason these events can't be considered entertaining "sports" in their own right. Will they eclipse human athletic competition one day? Neither horses nor cars have stopped people running. The only thing to remember is this: Like should be compared with like.

Gor in Srinagar: A one-man mission to strengthen a sputtering relationship

SERGIO GOR'S comment about Jammu and Kashmir being an important part of India has generated banner headlines, and understandably so.

Taken literally, his words go against decades of US policy on Kashmir. They are even more noteworthy than President Donald Trump's offer, made soon after Operation Sindoor last year, to work with India and Pakistan to help find a "solution" for Kashmir. That's because Trump's comments actually reflected a past US policy — one espoused in the initial years after 1947, when several administrations sought to help solve the Kashmir issue. The US posture has since evolved from working on it actively to taking a more hands-off role and welcoming any Indian and Pakistani efforts to resolve it themselves.

Additionally, this isn't just any US ambassador to India who made this comment. Gor is an ambassador who also serves as special envoy to South Asia, which gives him ample policy authority over both India and Pakistan. Even more important is that Gor is widely believed to be a close confidant of Trump's.

But as significant as Gor's statement was, it's important not to overstate the implications. This is likely more about Gor's desire to bolster US-India relations than it is about anything having to do with Kashmir.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0f>

Recall that since Gor arrived in New Delhi in January, he has been on a one-man mission to strengthen a sputtering relationship. He has pursued high-level engagements in New Delhi and across Indian states. He has announced conciliatory measures, like inviting India to join the Pax Silica silicon supply-chain initiative after India initially didn't receive an invitation. His messaging about India and US-India ties has been unrelentingly positive, in contrast to the sharp criticism directed at India by the White House in the months before Gor took up his ambassadorial post.

Against this backdrop, we can see what was likely at play in Srinagar.

Gor was keen to keep up his positive messaging and broader charm offensive with New Delhi. By saying Kashmir is an "important part of India", he was giving it a handsome compliment and perhaps providing a US rationale for pursuing commercial cooperation with Kashmir — a goal identified by Gor in an X post shortly after his Kashmir visit. Additionally, more broadly, given his proximity to Trump, Gor may have been looking to say something that would go down well with the Indian business community, to help advance an evergreen objective of his boss — attract more foreign investment to the US.

Unsurprisingly, there's been



MICHAEL KUGELMAN

It's also essential not to overstate the implications of Gor's comments for the US-India-Pakistan triangle

no formal US statement announcing a new policy on Kashmir. To be sure, Washington also hasn't walked back Gor's comments or clarified that US policy on Kashmir remains the same. But this can perhaps be attributed to a view within US government circles that there's no reason whatsoever to interpret Gor's comments as a policy shift. After all, as several Indian analysts have noted, Gor used the word "important", as opposed to "integral". The latter term is the one often invoked by New Delhi when articulating its position on Kashmir. Additionally, the term "important" is not as closely associated with contexts linked to territoriality.

It's also essential not to overstate the implications of Gor's comments for the US-India-Pakistan triangle. True, Pakistan's foreign ministry summoned the US charge d'affaires, Nathalie Baker, soon after Gor's comments. But that move shouldn't be read as a threat to a resurgent US-Pakistan partnership. It's very unusual for a US official to say anything about Kashmir that goes against Pakistan's position. And this is Kashmir — what multiple Pakistani leaders have described as the country's "jugular vein".

In this sense, Islamabad had no choice but to rapidly summon Baker. But Pakistani officials have been quiet ever since. And that's no surprise; they have no

interest in rocking the boat with a US administration on which they badly want to remain on good terms, given its stated interest in capitalising on commercial opportunities in Pakistan — and in partnering in a range of spaces, from counterterrorism to peace mediation in the Middle East.

Meanwhile, Gor's comments may deliver a boost to US-India ties, but not much more than that.

The Indian government has said little about them publicly, and much of the messaging from Indian voices — from officials in Kashmir to prominent independent analysts — has essentially revolved around the view that what the US thinks about Kashmir ultimately doesn't matter, given that it's India's issue. This ho-hum reaction may also be a reflection of the trust gap in India when it comes to Washington these days — a problem that Gor, despite his best efforts, has so far been unable to fix.

Ultimately, given the significance of what Gor said and who he is, it would be wrong to dismiss all this as much ado about nothing. But at the end of the day, there's no change in policy or diplomatic alignments to speak of. It's just another case of an unconventional administration doing unconventional things.

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The Mecca pact is for joint defence. Against whom?



DP SRIVASTAVA

THOUGH THERE is a pause in the shooting war, the situation in West Asia continues to be volatile. The Strait of Hormuz remains closed.

Houthi attacks on the Bab el-Mandeb at the mouth of the Red Sea have closed the second waterway for the transport of Saudi oil to Asian markets. This also affects shipments of Russian crude oil to India. Amid these developments, Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Pakistan have signed the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement. This raises the question: Joint defence against whom? There could be three possible threats: The Houthis, Iran, and Israel.

The joint statement issued after the Makkah Al-Mukarramah Summit stipulates that "any armed attack against any of the three states shall be regarded as an attack against them all". However, the extent and nature of commitments by the three countries for joint defence are not known. Nor has the geographical scope of such an arrangement been spelt out. Will this include conflicts outside West Asia? Can Pakistan invoke it in case of an Indian riposte to a future terror attack?

Has the Mecca Agreement created an Islamic NATO? Article 5 of the North Atlantic Treaty provides for collective self-defence but limits its scope to Europe. The only time Article 5 was invoked was in Afghanistan, post 9/11. NATO's travails in Ukraine and absence in the Iran war point to the fact that what matters is common threat perception, not a formal pact. Within the Mecca Agreement, the threat perceptions differ. Houthi attacks on Red Sea shipping do not pose a direct threat to Turkey or Pakistan. Turkey is more concerned with the Israeli presence in Syria. Pakistan regards India and Afghanistan as threats. In 2015, Pakistan did not take part in the action against the Houthis despite requests from Saudi Arabia and the UAE.

Is the Mecca Agreement an alliance of Sunni powers against Shia Iran? Iran has emerged as the most important regional power, having withstood more than 23,000 Israeli and US bombing raids in the war. Can Turkey and Pakistan provide Saudi Arabia with the protection from Iranian retaliation that the US could not? However, they do not mind sharing Saudi riches. The accord gives Pakistan a diplomatic profile at a time when its economy is sinking and it is beset by internal problems in Balochistan and PoK. Saudi Arabia and Pakistan had signed a Strategic

Mutual Defence Agreement (SMDA) last year. A Pakistan Air Force contingent and 13,000 ground troops were deployed in the eastern part of Saudi Arabia in April this year. Did the Pakistanis fire a single shot in discharge of their obligations under the SMDA?

The third possible threat is Israel. PM Netanyahu's pronouncement of a Greater Israel may have made Arab governments uncomfortable. However, the US umbrella could provide better protection to Saudi interests than Turkey could.

The trilateral pact has not gone unnoticed in Tehran. The influential daily Kayhan, close to the IRGC, has carried a strong editorial against Pakistan, questioning its credentials as a neutral mediator in Iran's talks with the US. In Pakistan, Shia cleric Jawad Naqvi has already criticised the government for joining the alliance.

India has friendly relations with Saudi Arabia. It is a good customer for Saudi oil. Saudi Arabia has a mature diplomatic establishment. It will nevertheless be useful to sensitise them to our concerns. If attacked, India is bound to exercise its right of self-defence.

The lasting solution to the West Asia crisis is mainstreaming Iran, so that it has a stake in a peaceful region. The June 17 MoU holds the promise of lifting both secondary and primary sanctions against Iran. This goes beyond the Obama-era nuclear deal. Iran's capacity to dominate Hormuz is tacitly recognised by all countries. This should be used as a deterrent against future aggression, rather than as a toll, which would bring a small fraction of the revenue Iran could earn from the export of its oil and petrochemicals once sanctions are lifted. The US should lift the blockade. The nuclear issue need not be insurmountable. Iran has already committed in the MoU to not "procure or develop nuclear weapons". The US has to moderate its demands. Insistence on "zero enrichment" will only be a deal-breaker. Iran has a legitimate sense of grievance. It was twice attacked by Israel and the US amid negotiations. But the future of its people is more important. The alternative to an agreement is continued disruption of global oil supplies, loss of revenue for the Gulf states and Iran, and chaos in West Asia.

The writer is former ambassador to Iran. He negotiated the Chabahar Agreement



SHASHANK PANDEY



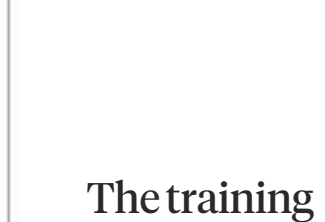
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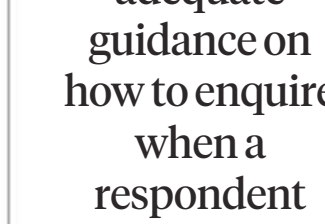
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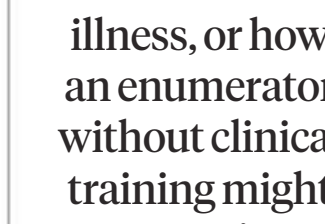
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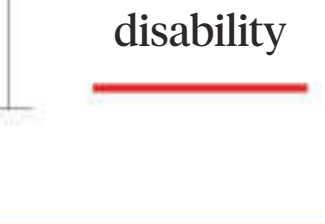
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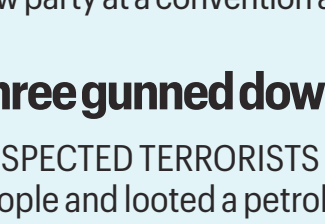
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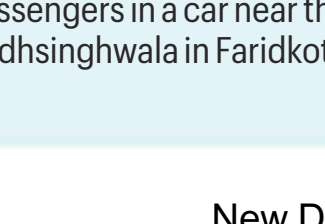
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Counting out the disabled citizens

SELF-ENUMERATION for Census 2027 began on August 17 in Jammu and Kashmir, Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand, ahead of door-to-door enumeration from September 1 and the national count in February 2027. Having examined the disability question, we find apprehensions of an undercount well-founded.

Question 13 asks whether the respondent is a person with disability and permits up to three selections from nine: Seeing, hearing, speech, mobility, intellectual disability, mental illness, acid attack, chronic neurological disease and, now, blood disorder. This appears to be an improvement: Nine categories rather than the eight of 2011, blood disorder introduced, and "mental retardation" replaced with "intellectual disability". But it is inadequate. The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 expanded recognised conditions from seven to 21, including dwarfism, cerebral palsy, autism spectrum disorder and specific learning disabilities, each with entitlements such as certification, reservation and welfare. None will appear as a distinct category in the Census. Autism is often recorded as intellectual disability by certification boards lacking the capacity or intent to distinguish them. The Census mentions intellectual disability without a separate entry for autism and other developmental conditions, reproducing that error at national scale. This misidentification leads to real consequences in early interventions, education and employment.

The schedule has also regressed: The options for multiple disabilities and "any other" have been withdrawn, and it is unclear whether 13(b)'s three selections will be recorded as multiple disabilities or as duplicate counts. The options are the broad heads of the Disability Act, until acid attack appears, although the statute situated it within locomotor disability. Placing a narrow sub-condition beside an umbrella term like mobility raises the question of what governed this classification. The customary response — the Unique Disability ID database will supply what the Census omits — does not hold. UDID registration reaches only about half the disabled population as per the last Census figures. Census data is crucial to map this access gap. Enumeration is proceeding in districts where assessment infrastructure is thinnest and formal diagnosis rare due to lack of specialists. The training material has no adequate guidance on how to enquire when a respondent hesitates to disclose mental illness, or how an enumerator without clinical training might recognise intellectual disability.

Welfare allocations depend on disaggregated data. Parliament recognised thalassemia, haemophilia and sickle cell disease as distinct conditions. A single figure for blood disorder doesn't convey this, and neither the National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission nor thalassemia care under the National Health Mission can be evaluated without a baseline. Specific learning disabilities, absent altogether, present another difficulty: Remediation must be available where most affected children live. Education departments are left with CSO estimates.

None of this required reinventing the Census, only aligning the question with the statute — by adopting all 21 recognised conditions or, at minimum, restoring multiple disabilities and a structured "other, please specify" — and training those who ask the questions. The Census returns once in a decade. If this occasion is missed, a generation of disabled Indians will grow up undercounted, underbudgeted and invisible to the state.

Pandey is a lawyer and founder of the Politics and Disability Forum. Batra is co-founder of Believe in the Invisible

40 YEARS AGO

August 25, 1986



Threat of crackdown in Pakistan

THE PAKISTANI government warned that it would resort to "drastic action" unless opposition groups end their drive to oust President Zia-ul-Haq and force early elections. But the leaders of the Movement for the Restoration of Democracy said they would not abandon the campaign. Security officials said the country was quiet and there had been no clashes between anti-government activists and security forces.

Revolt against Benazir Bhutto

TWO SENIOR associates of the Pakistan People's Party (PPP) leader, Benazir Bhutto,

have broken ranks to set up a rival opposition party in Pakistan, accusing Bhutto of being an "autocrat out of touch with the people". Ghulam Mustafa Jatoi, a former chief minister of Sindh province, and Ghulam Mustafa Khar, a former chief minister and governor of Punjab province, will join forces to formally launch a new party at a convention at Lahore.

Three gunned down in Punjab

SUSPECTED TERRORISTS killed three people and looted a petrol pump in different parts of Punjab during the last 24 hours. Two suspected terrorists gunned down three passengers in a car near the village of Budhsinghwal in Faridkot district. The ter-

rorists wielding sten guns stopped the car and shot their victims. The police and the CRPF rushed to the spot immediately and started combing operations.

India fined for CWG boycott

INDIA HAS been asked to pay £245,000, about Rs 4.4 million, for having boycotted the 13th Commonwealth Games in Edinburgh last month. The 32 entrants who boycotted the games have been asked to pay £2.7 million the newspaper publisher Robert Maxwell said. The boycott was in protest against the British government's refusal to impose wide-ranging economic sanctions against South Africa.

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● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
Netanyahu is dragging Israel into another pointless conflict — this time with Turkey — *Haaretz, Israel*

Could perverse incentives lead to inflated OBC numbers in Census? Answer is no



DESHKAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

I RECEIVED a pleasant surprise last week. In an article in this newspaper ('Count caste by all means. But abandon belief that counting settles anything' *IE*, August 21), Surjit Bhalla, no *dimagi* Naxal by any stretch, endorsed the central claims I have been making in these pages on the caste census. Bhalla favours a caste census. And he does so for the right reasons: "Yes. Count caste — India allocates education and employment on caste." I have been arguing for years that it is a scandal for a country to have legally enforced quotas for a social group — the OBCs — and not count its population. Bhalla also shares my assessment that the caste census is now dead, actually being killed by the government: "Yadav is right that the [caste] Census is now being killed by design." And he agrees with my analysis of why the Modi government has done so: "His diagnosis of the politics [behind the technical choice of the wording of the caste question] is sort of persuasive."

I could not ask for more. I should have just posted his article on social media, while thanking and tagging him. But there is a technical twist in this tantalising tale. Bhalla wants me to realise that even in the absence of sabotage, the caste census would not have told us "the truth" and advises us to "abandon the belief that counting [castes] settles anything". This does disservice to his own position and begs a question: Why should we trouble the already burdened Census enumerator with this additional question if its answer does not settle "anything"?

Minus such verbal excesses, the main argument in Bhalla's article is fairly straightforward. Counting castes by using a drop-down menu of categories like SC/ST/OBC is bound to produce unreliable data. If the Central Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

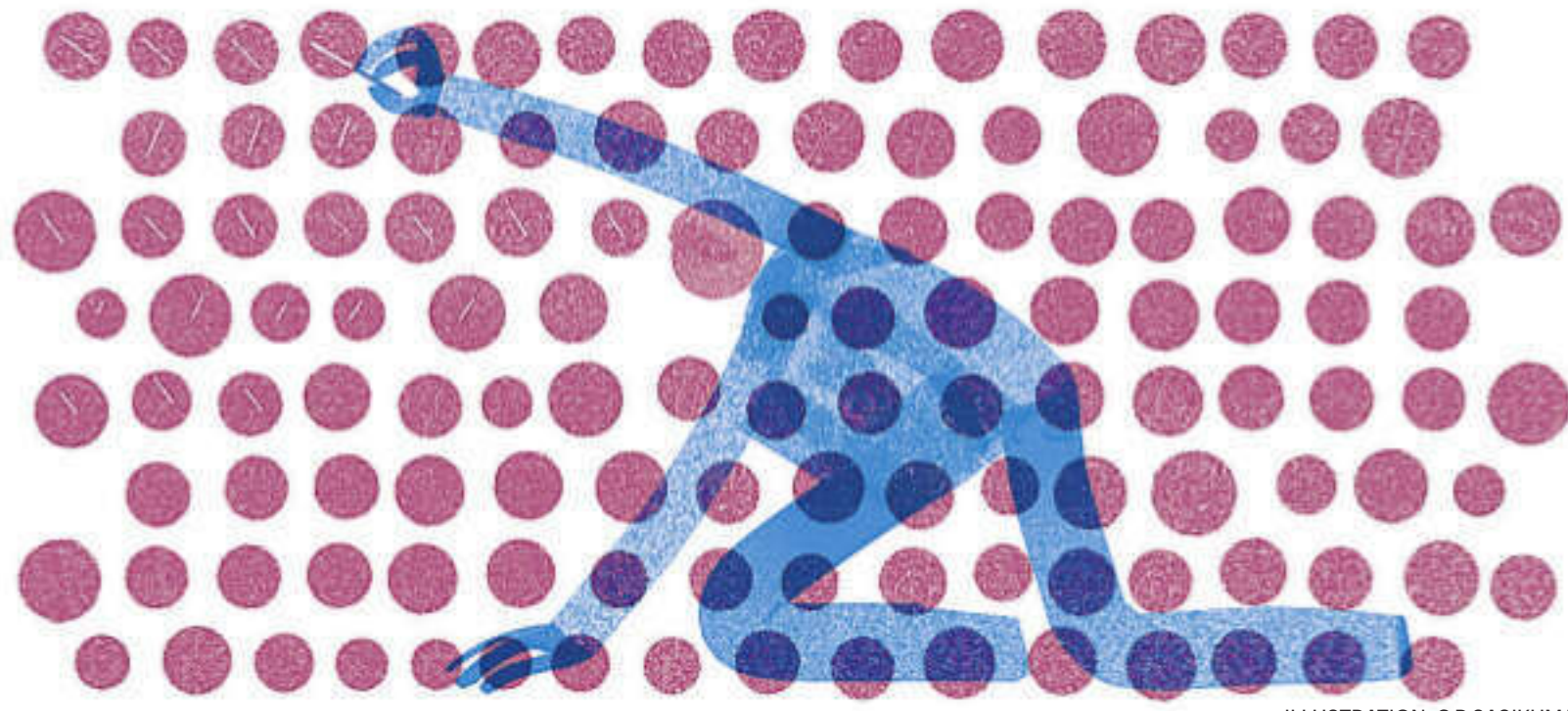


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

sus allows every person to choose a caste category, which is linked to his or her entitlements, we are creating a perverse incentive to lie, to claim membership of a category to which the person does not belong. This could lead to a massive exaggeration in the numbers for OBCs. Hence his suggestion: "Ask for caste, sub-caste and surname, never for category." He lays out a dazzling array of data to make an innocuous point: Human beings respond to incentives. Indeed, no proof was required for this.

Sadly, Bhalla chooses a bad example to make an otherwise valid point. He presents the unusual rise in the estimated population of OBCs between the 55th (1999-2000) and 61st (2004-05) rounds of the National Sample Survey as evidence of incentivised manipulation in caste numbers. He correctly shows that such a rise could not have happened due to an increase in population. But he wrongly assumes that this must have been caused by respondents falsely reporting OBC status to claim entitlements. He does not mention that 1999 was the first time OBCs were counted in the NSS and were thus prone to being under-counted. He does not examine a competing and compelling hypothesis: OBC was still a recent category in 1999, and many more OBCs were unfamiliar with it then compared to five years

While dissecting data from 1999 and 2004, Bhalla does not share the figures for 2009-10, 2014 and 2017-18, which report a fairly stable share for OBCs — between 42 and 43 per cent

later. Most importantly, while dissecting the data from 1999 and 2004, Bhalla does not care to share the NSS figures for 2009-10, 2014 and 2017-18, which report a fairly stable share for OBCs — between 42 and 43 per cent. If the respondents were over-reporting OBC status, why did this trend halt in 2004?

Regardless, let's stick to his general argument about perverse incentives that might lead to exaggeration of population numbers for the OBCs in the coming Census. That would be a valid apprehension if you do not know something basic about the Census of India, a surprising omission on Bhalla's part. Section 15 of the Census Act, 1948 guards the privacy of Census responses and says that Census records are not open to public scrutiny and cannot be used as evidence in a civil or criminal court. The Supreme Court has reiterated that no person can use his or her self-declaration in Census responses to claim entitlements, reservation, or any statutory benefits. In sum: There is zero individual incentive to misreport your category in the Census.

If not an individual one, is there a collective incentive for social groups to inflate their numbers in the Census to claim higher community benefits, say, a higher quota for OBCs? Hypothetically, yes. But why would the non-OBCs participate in such a conspiracy if there

are no individual gains for misreporting? Besides, history belies such apprehensions: If entitlements incentivise lying in the Census, why has the population share of SCs and STs not leapt up beyond credible population trends in the last seven decennial censuses?

Now that the perverse incentive theory is laid to rest, may I invite Bhalla to rethink whatever remains of our difference on this issue. Although he does not spell out his alternative, it seems Bhalla does not favour an open-ended question on caste that simply records any answer offered by the respondent. As a seasoned survey researcher himself, Bhalla would know that it would be an invitation to a data disaster — millions of responses that defy post-coding. I understand his opposition is to a stand-alone caste category question — Are you SC/ST/OBC/General — as this method is vulnerable to large-scale errors. But that is not the proposal from the proponents of the caste census.

What we are suggesting is what survey researchers call a two-stage hierarchical question using cascading response categories. This is exactly how the question about SC and ST has always been asked in the census: First you are asked to choose a category, then presented with a list of caste names within that category to choose from. In case you chose the wrong category, the drop-down menu in the next question helps to rectify it there and then. So, our proposal is that the same should be extended this time to the OBCs and the General category. As for Bhalla's fair insistence that professional sociologists should be involved in classifying castes and sub-castes, I may again point out that this job has already been done by various commissions in the case of OBCs. And by the 43-volume *People of India* series by the Anthropological Survey of India for the rest. Why reinvent the wheel, if the desire is not to sabotage the caste count?

This is not meant to be a rebuttal. I really hope to persuade Surjit Bhalla, whose voice carries weight with the present dispensation, unlike mine.

The writer is member, Swaraj India, and national convener, Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan.

Views are personal

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Opposition has only one agenda: Disrupting Parliament



KIREN RIJJU

A CURIOUS formula now passes for democratic concern in sections of our political and commentariat classes: Disrupt Parliament, prevent Question Hour, shout down ministers, reject offers of debate and then publish solemn articles lamenting that Parliament did not debate.

Critics have cited the Monsoon Session's numbers: The Lok Sabha functioned for 15 per cent of its scheduled time and the Rajya Sabha for 33 per cent. Question Hour operated for barely 1 per cent of its allotted time in the Lok Sabha and 12 per cent in the Rajya Sabha. But these numbers cannot be separated from their cause. The same analysis records that the session was marked by repeated disruptions and adjournments. The Opposition's arithmetic is therefore deeply cynical: First ensure that Parliament cannot function, and then use the resulting loss of time as evidence against the government.

The Constitution gives the Opposition every right to question, criticise, protest, move amendments and vote against the government. It does not give the Opposition a remote control with which it may switch Parliament off whenever its political demands are not accepted. The government has listened, negotiated, amended legislation and accommodated legitimate concerns. What it will not do is surrender the people's mandate to an Opposition that paralyses Parliament and then cites that paralysis as proof of authoritarianism.

Nothing exposes the hollowness of the present campaign more clearly than the Opposition's own response when it was offered the parliamentary debate it claimed to want. On the Jantar Mantar protests, Union Home Minister Amit Shah offered a detailed discussion in Parliament. He offered to begin the debate at 3 pm that day and continue it until 3 pm the following day. He committed to responding to the questions raised. The Leader of the Opposition, Rahul Gandhi, rejected the offer, declaring that the Opposition was not interested in the Home Minister's "lecture". A leader genuinely denied a debate seizes a 24-hour offer. He does not dismiss it as a lecture. One cannot refuse a full parliamentary discussion and then complain that Parliament has been silenced.

The contradiction becomes even more striking when seen against Rahul Gandhi's own parliamentary record. During the 17th Lok Sabha, he recorded just 51 per cent attendance, participated in eight debates against a national average of 46.7, asked 99 questions against an average of 210, and introduced no Private Member's Bill. Yet he now declares that the government has "destroyed our democracy". He goes to the UK, Germany and the US and complains about the lack of democracy in India. But he doesn't have the gall to attend Parliament and seek accountability. Neither he nor the Congress party are defenders of democracy. They excel in political theatre bordering on parody.

The allegation that the government refuses to listen is equally detached from the record. When concerns were raised regarding the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, the government referred the Bill to a Joint Parliamentary Committee for detailed examination. Remarkably, sections of the Opposition opposed even the JPC referral and demanded that the Bill be withdrawn altogether. This reveals the real problem. For some Opposition parties, consultation no longer means that the government should listen. It means that the government must surrender. Debate is considered meaningless unless the minister accepts the Opposition's conclusions in advance.

The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill provides another instructive example. The Lok Sabha debated it for nearly 11 hours, with 48 MPs participating. The Rajya Sabha discussed it for more than six-and-a-half hours, with 35 members taking part. This was not a law being "rammed through".

The government also engaged directly with Sonam Wangchuk during his hunger strike. Following discussions, he subsequently ended his 26-day fast. Prime Minister Narendra Modi personally appealed to him to follow medical advice and prayed for his recovery.

Consider the democratic sequence: A protest was held; civil society concerns were heard; Union ministers engaged with the protester; written assurances were provided; the Prime Minister responded; Parliament conducted an extensive debate; and legislation was strengthened. It is difficult to imagine a more democratic chain of engagement and accountability.

Parliament belongs neither to the government nor to the Opposition. It belongs to the people of India. The mandate they have delivered is not a decorative certificate that may be suspended whenever defeated parties choose disruption over argument.

Slogans outside the House cannot substitute for arguments inside it. Those who cannot defeat a government through debate or the ballot cannot be permitted to defeat Parliament through noise.

The writer is Union Minister of Parliamentary Affairs and Minister of Minority Affairs

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Jobs for youth

AS A young Indian, I feel that a job is not merely a means of earning a living ('What young want, and why creating good jobs is no longer optional', *IE*, August 24). We want stability, fair wages and a genuine chance to grow. Education must lead to employable skills, and apprenticeships should connect young people with actual workplaces. Small businesses also need easier credit and fewer hurdles. Creating enough decent jobs must become a clear priority if India's young population is to become its strength.

S.M.Jeeva, Chennai

Politics and policy

INVESTMENT DECISIONS cannot be separated from political stability, institutional credibility and predictable rules ('Investment question has a political answer', *IE*, August 24). The article rightly points to the risks created when economic policy becomes too dependent on political considerations. India needs stronger regulatory institutions, transparent decision-making and stable taxation to sustain investor confidence. Public investment should crowd in private capital rather than replace it. A competitive economy requires sound markets and good governance, with policy continuity despite changes in political leadership.

A Senthil Kumar, Kaniyur

Restrain Israel

CONTINUED SETTLEMENT expansion in the West Bank makes a negotiated settlement harder and risks deepening an already serious conflict ('Israel's West Bank push imperils long-term peace', *IE*, August 24). Whatever the disagreements, civilian security and international law must remain central. India, with long-standing ties with both sides, can support dialogue and a credible two-state framework. Major powers should press for restraint rather than allowing facts on the ground to determine the region's future. Durable peace requires sustained engagement, not territorial consolidation.

K.P.Muthukumar, Chennai



MANOJ KUMAR JHA

THERE ARE books that record an era, and then there are books that interrogate the future. Hiren Mukherjee's *Portrait of Parliament: Reflections and Recollections (1952-77)* belongs to the latter category. Written by one of my favourite parliamentarians, the book is a meditation on what Parliament means to a democracy and what happens to a democracy when Parliament itself begins to forget what it is meant to be.

Mukherjee sounded a warning that appears prophetic today: He lamented the growing "deterioration in parliamentary functioning" and cautioned that if Parliament failed to prize its own dignity, its powers, too, would be imperilled. At the time, many may have regarded it as the melancholic reflection of an old parliamentarian witnessing inevitable institutional change. Today, it reads more like a diagnosis.

Parliament was conceived not as an appendage of executive authority but as the sovereign arena where the nation could converse with itself. The executive had to govern and Parliament had to hold power accountable. Increasingly, however, Parliament appears to be losing its deliberative soul. The first symptom of decay is the concentration of power in the executive. Parliamentary democracies function on the principle that governments derive legitimacy from legislatures and remain accountable to them. However, this relation has gradually become inverted. Parliament today often appears as an institution expected to ratify decisions already taken elsewhere.

The question before us is not whether Parliament remains constitutionally supreme. The more troubling question is whether it still possesses the moral confidence to act as the nation's conscience

The Opposition, constitutionally intended to be a watchdog rather than an enemy, increasingly finds itself being treated as an inconvenience. But the health of a legislature is measured not by the comfort of the treasury benches but by the confidence with which dissent can be articulated.

The second symptom is the decline of debate. Mukherjee belonged to a generation that regarded preparation for parliamentary intervention as an ethical responsibility. Disagreement could be sharp, even ideological. Opponents were challenged, but not dehumanised as has become the norm these days. Today, much of parliamentary communication is designed not for persuasion within the House but for circulation outside it. Speeches increasingly seek virality rather than illumination. The result is a paradox: Parliament is more visible than ever and yet less heard.

The third symptom is the erosion of institutional memory. Parliament survives not merely through rules but through conventions — unwritten understandings that teach restraint to power and responsibility to the Opposition. Once these conventions weaken, the rulebook cannot save democratic culture. The tragedy of contemporary politics is that institutional continuity is often dismissed as elitism while disruption is celebrated as authenticity. When debate declines, politics does not become calmer; it becomes more polarised outside the institution.

A fourth symptom is the diminishing role of parliamentary committees and other mechanisms of

scrutiny. The committee system was designed to allow detailed examination away from the heat of partisan contestation. Representation has certainly deepened. But representation without deliberation is incomplete. Mukherjee defended a principle: The idea that democracy requires institutions capable of slowing down power and compelling it to explain itself. That principle is under strain now. When parliamentary sessions become shorter, when scrutiny becomes weaker, when disagreement is portrayed as obstruction, and when political majorities begin to confuse electoral victory with institutional entitlement, democracy loses one of its most vital safeguards.

The true measure of Parliament is not how loudly the government speaks, but how fearlessly questions can be asked. It is not the speed with which legislation is passed, but the depth with which it is examined. It is not the size of a majority, but the space available for minorities. The question before us is not whether Parliament remains constitutionally supreme. The more troubling question is whether it still possesses the moral confidence to act as the nation's conscience. Mukherjee's *Portrait of Parliament* reminds us that democratic institutions rarely decay overnight. Their renewal, if political will still permits it, may also have to begin quietly with the recovery of a simple but profound belief: That Parliament is not an obstacle to governance. It is governance in its most democratic form.

The writer is Member of Parliament, Rajya Sabha, Rashtriya Janata Dal

Question for Delhi Master Plan: Whose city is it?

glimpse of this contradiction. As Delhi prepared to host global leaders, roadside vendors were removed from prominent locations and informal settlements screened from public view. It exposed an uncomfortable truth: Delhi needs its informal economy, but often does not want its informal workers to be visible. Street vendors, construction workers, domestic workers, sanitation workers, small traders and delivery riders are essential to the Capital's functioning. Yet they are frequently treated as obstacles to a cleaner and more "planned" city.

Gig workers make this contradiction particularly clear. Delhi's platform economy increasingly depends on delivery riders who move through the city at all hours. Yet conventional planning rarely recognises them as an urban constituency. A delivery worker

needs safe parking, toilets, drinking water, charging points, rest spaces and affordable housing close to employment centres.

Housing presents a similar problem. The existence of housing in peripheral locations alongside informal housing closer to employment shows the limitations of a numbers-based approach. For a low-income household, housing cost includes rent, transport, commute time, childcare and access to work. A formally affordable house can be unaffordable if reaching work consumes hours

Planning determines who gets access to housing, employment and public space, who benefits from rising land values and who bears the costs of development

and a significant share of income.

Caste and occupation shape access to housing, land, dignity and public services. Workers in precarious occupations face insecurities that cannot be captured by income classifications alone. Likewise, women's inclusion cannot be achieved simply by adding toilets or childcare facilities. The location of affordable housing affects commuting, unpaid care work and access to employment. Housing, transport and care infrastructure must be planned together.

The same principle applies to persons with disabilities. A ramp is meaningless if the pavement leading to it is inaccessible or public transport cannot be reached independently. The test should be whether a person with a disability can independently travel from home to wherever necessary for work, education, healthcare and recreation.

Rehabilitation must also protect livelihoods. The principle of "*Jahan jhuggi, wahan makan*" is important, but relocation cannot simply mean moving residents to distant housing. It also raises the question of who captures the value created by public investment. New Metro lines and commercial corridors increase surrounding land values. If these gains accrue primarily to property owners while poorer residents are priced out, public investment risks producing private wealth while socialising displacement.

The real test of Delhi 2047 is not whether the capital becomes richer, taller or more connected. It is whether the people who build, clean, deliver, drive and sustain the city can still afford a place in its future.

Khan is a Delhi-based architect

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender No. PRYJ-Sig-407-2026-27
Dated: 21.08.2026
E-Tender Notice

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Co-ordination/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **15:00 hrs. on 15.09.2026**. The details of the Tender is as under :-

S. N. 1 | Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-407-2026-27
Name of Work: "S&T work for provision of shifting of Electronic Interlocking equipment form Khurja ASM old building to Khurja ASM new building and S&T work for Extension of platform No. 1 to at Aligarh station."
Approx. Cost of work (in ₹): ₹ 8480430.72/- (Eight-Four Lakhs Eighty Thousand Four Hundred Thirty and Seventy-Two Paise Only).
Bid Security/Earnest Money (in ₹): 169600.00 **Completion Period:** 12 Months
Date of Closing of tender: 15.09.2026
2. Availability of tender form: Tender forms shall be available on www.irops.gov.in 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender. **3. Earnest Money to be deposited:** The prescribed amount of Earnest Money as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form. The tenderer(s) should note that, Tenders without earnest money shall be summarily rejected. **4. Time, date & place of opening of tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre-determined date at 15:30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. **5. Validity of offer:** 60 days from the date of opening. **6. Right of Railway to deal with tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. **1964/26(AK)**

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPNCR

CSB Bank
PUBLIC NOTICE ON AUCTION OF PLEDGED GOLD ORNAMENTS
The borrower/s in specific and interested bidders in general, are hereby informed that on account of non-repayment of the Banks due by the borrowers as under despite the payment notice and recall/auCTION notice issued by the Bank, the gold ornaments pledged with the bank security by the respective borrowers for the loan availed by them will be sold in public auction on "as is where is" and "non-recourse" at branch premises on **25th September 2026 at 10.30 AM**. The auction may be adjourned to any other later date at the discretion of the bank upon publication of the same in the Bank's notice board. The borrowers are hereby further inform that the gold ornaments will be disposed of by Public auction/e-auction, if the auction is not successful and if there is a further balance to be recovered thereafter, legal action will be initiated against the borrower/s for recovery of the balance amounts due to the bank. "In case of deceased borrower, all conditions will be applicable to legal heirs."

S. No.	Auction Center CSB Branch	Account Name	Client ID	No. of Acc.	Bal. Outstanding as on 20-08-2026	Weight (grams)
1	Gautam Nagar	Bhavna Sethi	07081674	002	6,79,351.71	145.70
2	Karol Bagh	Surender Kumar Ram	044551921	001	1,36,746.59	15.37
3	Palam	Anupam Ashish	05044080	001	3,88,531.69	63.53
4	Palam	Bhanu Ranjan Kumar	04291492	001	6,14,932.68	61.50
5	Palam	Manish Kumar Kanojia	07417960	001	1,96,853.73	34.90
6	Palam	Sunita	04746802	001	2,14,354.62	23.20
7	Dwaraka	Bhanu Ranjan Kumar Janaki	04291492	001	2,01,282.05	19.50
8	Rohini Sector 7	Kunal Singh	10361384	001	5,16,824.60	73.44
9	Rohini Sector 7	Mr Sakirul Islam	10215249	001	6,58,001.24	69.27
11	Shalimarbagh	Paramjeet Singh	04455876	001	3,10,187.91	32.08
12	Okhla	Amil Anand	10134417	001	4,19,637.71	44.89
13	Okhla	Bharti	10222198	001	1,31,778.36	14.33
14	Okhla	Deepa Bansal	07997240	001	5,20,705.93	96.54
15	Okhla	Manita	04315650	002	7,49,947.52	87.64
16	Okhla	Vinodra	04456582	005	4,26,047.05	61.99
17	Palat Nagar	Nidhi Thakur	04757653	001	2,37,638.87	44.67
18	Mayur Vihar - New Delhi	Sumit Kumar	10220923	001	24,20,273.40	248.68
19	Mayur Vihar - New Delhi	Sushma Bhati	10220914	001	1,92,285.37	251.43
20	Tiaik Nagar, New Delhi	Rahul Kumar Gupta	10278824	002	12,83,529.42	119.24
21	Dilshad Garden	Hukam Singh	08136923	002	75,141.01	22.00
22	Dilshad Garden	Jai Bhagwan	04627312	002	21,39,474.85	229.01
23	Narela	Anil Khan	10213885	001	1,92,285.37	20.27
24	Bhajanpura - New Delhi	Gautam	10252222	001	1,42,166.24	25.90
25	Bhajanpura - New Delhi	Zubair	05066571	002	6,28,161.84	111.25
26	Shyam Nagar - New Delhi	Ashif Khan	04896613	001	88,123.38	10.68
27	Shyam Nagar - New Delhi	Swati Kumari	04932719	002	1,16,071.38	22.49
28	Laxmi Nagar	Shweta Singh	10222224	001	2,57,456.48	27.07

For more details/account wise information borrowers/interested bidders may contact respective branches and for participating in the auction

NCT OF DELHI | 23.08.2026

Sd/- Authorized Officer, CSB Bank

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B)
DIVISION NAGROTA, JAMMU
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Fresh Shorte-NIT No. 60 of 2026-27 Dated 21-08-2026
Consultancy service (Through e-procurement mode) (TWO COVER SYSTEM)

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, Executive Engineer, PWD(R&B) DIVISION NAGROTA, JAMMU invite Tender for selection of consultant for Architectural and allied Engineering Consultancy Services from Registered firms /Consultants/Agencies under Indian Partnership Act/Societies Registration Act or registered companies under companies act or the following work

S. No	Particular	Advised Cost (In Lacs)	Tender fee	Earnest Money (In Rs)	Time Allowed for completion	Type of consultancy
1.	Rendering of Service for Providing of Architectural Drawings / Structural Designing of various works incl. Soil investigation test (With Bore Method only), provision of 3D view and including vetting of structural drawings from IIT/DIO/CGCTEY/ NIT/ any other recognized Institute and preparation of complete BOQ for Tendering incl. time to time supervision of project during whole Construction of office Building of the Relief & Rehabilitation Commissioner (M) Jammu Complete Job).	Rs.26.25 lacs	Rs. 600	52500/-	Upto physical completion of work	

the bidding document consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, bill of Quantities set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be viewed/ downloaded from the website www.jktenders.in as per the schedule given below

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	21-08-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 22-08-2026 to 02-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	27-08-2026 at 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Nagrota
4	Bid submission Start Date	22-08-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	02-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening Technical (Online)	03-09-2026 onor after 1100 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Nagrota
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online).	To be notified after technical bid evaluation

Sd/-

Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Div. Nagrota
Jammu

कार्यालय: नगर निगम गोरखपुर
पत्रांक:- 293 / चार-साठनिविदा / 2026-27
दिनांक: 24 / 08 / 2026
ई-निविदा आमन्त्रण सूचना

नगर निगम, गोरखपुर द्वारा आमन्त्रित निविदा में 11 कार्यों की पुनः तीसरी बार ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती है। नगर निगम के समस्त पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों/अनुभवी फर्मों से उनकी श्रेणी के अनुसार ई-निविदा के माध्यम से निम्न निर्माण कार्यों की पुनः निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है। शासनादेश सं0 3890 / नी-5-149सा / 2019, नगर विकास अनुभाग-05 उपग्र0 शासन लखनऊ, दिनांक 20 सितम्बर 20.09.2019 के क्रम में उक्त निविदा में नगर निगम, गोरखपुर में अपंजीकृत ठेकेदारों भी प्रतिभाग कर सकते हैं। सर्वसूचन निविदादाता होने पर सम्बन्धित ठेकेदार को नगर निगम, गोरखपुर में पंजीकरण की अर्हता पूर्ण कराकर नगर निगम, गोरखपुर में पंजीकरण करना होगा। पंजीकरण की अर्हता सम्बन्धी विवरण/ आवश्यक प्रपत्र की सूचना किसी भी कार्य दिवस में नगर निगम कार्यालय के निर्माण विभाग में देखी जा सकती है। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र उपग्र0 की ई-प्रक्रायेमेंट की वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर नगर निगम की वेबसाइट gorakhpurnagar.nigam.up.gov.in पर देखी जा सकती है। शासनादेश सं0 4848 / नी-5-2018-470सा / 2018 नगर विकास अनुभाग-5 उपग्र0 शासन, लखनऊ दिनांक 10 दिसम्बर, 2018 के क्रम में निविदा शुल्क + जीएसटी010 एवं धरोहर धनराशि पृथक-पृथक ऑन लाइन/NEFT/RTGS के माध्यम से नगर निगम कोष में नगर निगम, गोरखपुर के खाता सं0 0243523000000011 (IFSC Code: YESB0000243) YES Bank, शाखा-पार्क रोड, गोरखपुर में जमा किया जाना अनिवार्य होगा, जिसकी स्कैन कॉपी ई-टेंडर अपलोड करते समय अपलोड करनी होगी। ई-निविदाएं निम्नानुसार आमन्त्रित की जाती है:-

निविदा डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि एवं समय

क्र0सं0	विवरण	दिनांक एवं समय
1	ई-निविदा डाउनलोड/ प्रारम्भ की तिथि	31-08-2026
2	ई-निविदा अपलोड की अन्तिम तिथि/ समय	09-09-2026 @ 05:00 PM
3	ई-निविदा खोले जाने की तिथि/ समय	10-09-2026 @ 11:00 AM

कार्यों का विवरण, नियम व शर्तें नगर निगम, गोरखपुर के वेबसाइट gorakhpurnagar.nigam.up.gov.in पर व ई-प्रक्रायेमेंट की वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है साथ ही नगर निगम कार्यालय के नोटिस बोर्ड पर चरपा कर दी गयी है। किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिये उक्त वेबसाइट एवं नोटिस बोर्ड पर देखी जा सकती है।

अधिशाली अभियन्ता
नगर निगम, गोरखपुर

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA
TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, BHITWANI	PAVEMENT OF ROAD BEYOND FROM DEVI LAL CHOWK TO LUNARJI CANAL IN P.C. CHANANI + 21 WORKS	20.08.2026 01.09.2026	9,77,38,789/-	https://tenders.hry.nic.in	9996629555 meenchivani@gmail.com

48544/HRY FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

Pimpri Chinchwad Municipal Corporation,
Pimpri – 411018

Tender No: 09/2026-27
Publication of Notice for Request for Proposal (RFP)
for
Appointment of Agency for Implementation of GIS/GPS-Based Tree Diversity Mapping and Quantitative Assessment of Trees within PCMC Limits
Pimpri Chinchwad Municipal Corporation (PCMC) hereby invites 'Appointment of Agency for Implementation of GIS/GPS-Based Tree Diversity Mapping and Quantitative Assessment of Trees within PCMC Limits'. Bidders are advised to study this RFP document carefully before submitting their proposals in response to this RFP published. Submission of a proposal in response to this notice shall be deemed to have been done after careful study and examination of this document with full understanding of its terms, conditions, and implications. Interested Bidders are requested to download the RFP document published on www.mahatenders.gov.in from 25/08/2026. The last date for bid submission 08/09/2026 by 3:00 PM. The bidder must submit their proposal on www.mahatenders.gov.in. The downloaded bidding document shall be considered valid for participation in the electronic bidding process (e-Tendering) subject to the payment of RFP Fee. For any type of clarifications, Bidders can visit www.mahatenders.gov.in or contact help desk contact no. 0120-4001 462, 0120-4001 002, 0120-4001 005, 0120-6277 787, Email: support-eproc@nic.in.

Name of Works	Tender Fees (Non-Refundable)	EMD
Appointment of Agency for Implementation of GIS/ GPS-Based Tree Diversity Mapping and Quantitative Assessment of Trees within PCMC Limits	INR 22,523/- (Rupees Twenty-Two Thousand Five Hundred and Twenty- Three only)	INR 10,00,000/- (Rupees Ten Lakhs only)

Commissioner, PCMC, reserves the right to reject any or all applications without assigning any reasons thereof. In this regard his decision will be final and legally binding on all the Bidders.

Sd/-
Add. Commissioner (1)
Pimpri Chinchwad Municipal Corporation
Pimpri – 411 018

ADVT No.:-2026-27/126

CSB Bank
PUBLIC NOTICE ON AUCTION OF PLEDGED GOLD ORNAMENTS
The borrower/s in specific and interested bidders in general, are hereby informed that on account of non-repayment of the Banks due by the borrowers as under despite the payment notice and recall/auCTION notice issued by the Bank, the gold ornaments pledged with the bank security by the respective borrowers for the loan availed by them will be sold in public auction on "as is where is" and "non-recourse" at branch premises on **29th September 2026 at 10.30 AM**. The auction may be adjourned to any other later date at the discretion of the bank upon publication of the same in the Bank's notice board. The borrowers are hereby further inform that the gold ornaments will be disposed of by public auction/e-auction, if the auction is not successful, and if there is a further balance to be recovered thereafter, legal action will be initiated against the borrower/s for recovery of the balance amounts due to the bank. "In case of deceased borrower, all conditions will be applicable to legal heirs."

S. No.	Auction Center CSB Branch	Account Name	Client ID	No. of Acc.	Bal. Outstanding as on 20.08.2026	Weight (grams)
1	Gautam Nagar	Aarti	04627791	002	2,15,124.84	42.62
2	Gautam Nagar	Nilesh Saini	10225615	002	1,62,805.16	17.80
3	Palam	Pawan Kumar Sangita	04724133	001	54,322.12	5.40
4	Palam	Kulvinder Singh Parveen	04820478	001	26,530.23	3.99
5	Janakapuri	Manoj Kumar	07937680	001	3,35,511.00	34.70
6	Dwaraka	Chhavi Mittal	08349200	001	99,329.18	11.88
7	Shalimarbagh	Mahesh Kumar Sanjay	07807105	001	4,55,652.64	65.82
8	Shalimarbagh	F.A Kamal Hasan	10222870	001	14,05,471.51	152.84
9	Okhla	Rakesh Kumar Jeet Kumar	10171478	001	1,03,525.69	12.21
10	Okhla	Rakesh Kumar Jeet Kumar	04395306	002	3,15,029.62	48.95
11	Okhla	Naresh Kumar	10225552	004	31,77,516.66	392.25
12	Patel Nagar	Amil Kumar	10225393	001	1,59,217.23	15.80
13	Mayur Vihar-New Delhi	Amil Kumar	10733354	002	8,12,063.77	87.63
14	Mayur Vihar-New Delhi	Juhi Choubey	10222870	001	14,05,471.51	152.84
15	Tiaik Nagar, New Delhi	Archana	08261707	001	2,43,119.95	44.89
16	Tiaik Nagar, New Delhi	Nitin Kumar	08141434	001	2,64,888.60	48.74
17	Rajouri Garden	Lovely Jaiswal	10225188	001	1,96,874.46	19.84
18	Rajouri Garden	Puneet Kumar	10908661	001	7,04,190.24	59.86
19	Narela	Naresh Sharma	08160301	001	4,24,783.57	43.96
20	Shyam Nagar-New Delhi	Peni Swamy	10055342	002	8,10,385.32	104.39
21	Laxmi Nagar	Ankit Gupta	10122203	003	29,69,970.32	347.93
22	Paschim Vihar	Mahesh Kumar	04301316	001	1,42,651.66	32.50
23	Saraswati Vihar-Pilampura	Kusum Lata	10225094	001	7,03,813.34	76.43

For more details/account wise information borrowers/interested bidders may contact respective branches and for participating in the auction

NCT OF DELHI | 24.08.2026

Sd/- AUTHORIZED OFFICER, CSB BANK

NORTHERN RAILWAY
(E-Auction Notice)

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi Invites e-Auction through IREPS (www.irops.gov.in) for allotment of Misc contracts of NFR at following railway stations:

E-Catalogue No	Type of Asset	Station	Date & Time for e-auction
Advt-Sept-02-26	Unipole OOH	Cluster-B	Start: 07.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Sept-02-26	Vinyl Stickers/ Wrapping Exterior	Train No. 14041/42	Start: 07-09-2026 at 11:00 hrs

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen. <https://irops.gov.in> (E-Auction-Leasing)

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2939/26

Govt of Gujarat
N.W.R.W.S.& Kalpasar Deptt
ON LINE TEDNDER NOTICE NO.07 Total Work: 3
Estimate Cost:- 15.01 Cr. To 34.05 Cr.
Tender Upload Date:-25-08-2026 To 24-09-2026
Last Date Download of Tender: 24-09-2026 Time: 18.00 Hrs.
Executive Engineer, Kakrapar Right bank Canal Division, Surat, 1st Floor, Sinchai Bhawan, Athwalines, Surat – 395 007 (0261 2669048)
Visit :- www.statetenders.gujarat.gov.in & <https://tender.nprocure.com>
Pre Bid Meeting:- 03-09-2026, Time: 12.00 Hrs. The Superintending Engineer, Surat Irrigation Circle, Nr. M.T.B. College, Athwalines, Surat.
INF-SURAT-521-2026

झारखण्ड सरकार ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
कम्पाइंड बिल्डींग, ओल्ड चास कोट एरिया, बोकारो।
ई- निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
ई-निविदा संख्या :- 01/2026-27/RWD/EE/BOKARO
दिनांक – 22.08.2026

कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, बोकारो द्वारा निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र0 सं0	आवैदेनी विवरण संस्था / फेज/ जिला	कार्य का नाम	आक में	प्राक्कलित राशि (कार्य में)	कार्य समाप्ति की आखिरी तिथि	टेंडर का कोड
1	RWD/EE/ BOKARO/ 01/2026-27	पत्तकी कब्रिस्तान से झापा टोला माया बोलगढ़ा तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लम्बाई= 2.410 कि०मी०)	2,09,07,300.00	दो करोड़ नी लाख सात हजार तीन सौ रू० मात्र	12 माह	प्रथम
2	RWD/EE/ BOKARO/ 02/2026-27	नव प्राथमिक विद्यालय खोजासा से गोपाल मांजी के घर तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लम्बाई=1.100 कि०मी०)	1,06,78,700.00	एक करोड़ छः लाख अठ्ठावन हजार सात सौ रू० मात्र	09 माह	प्रथम
3	RWD/EE/ BOKARO/ 03/2026-27	कच्छेर पंचायत अन्तर्गत सिमरखेडा आर०डी०ओ रोड लालवी होटल से टांगरी ऊपर आखड़ा तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लम्बाई= 1.730 कि०मी०)	1,78,49,500.00	एक करोड़ अठ्ठावन लाख उनचास हजार पाँच सौ रू० मात्र	12 माह	प्रथम
4	RWD/EE/ BOKARO/ 04/2026-27	धवाटांड शिव मंदिर से दामोदर नदी तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लम्बाई= 2.670 कि०मी०)	2,83,50,700.00	दो करोड़ तिसरी लाख पचास हजार सात सौ रू० मात्र	15 माह	प्रथम
5	RWD/EE/ BOKARO/ 05/2026-27	कच्छेर पंचायत अन्तर्गत जहारलैन आर०डी०ओ रोड से दरहाखड़ा तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लम्बाई= 3.170 कि०मी०)	2,80,87,500.00	दो करोड़ अस्सी लाख सतासी हजार पाँच सौ रू० मात्र	15 माह	प्रथम
6	RWD/EE/ BOKARO/ 06/2026-27	भाइरो पंचायत के कांजीयाया आर०डी०ओ पथ से ग्राम-मोदीडीह होते हुए टुंगरा पथ तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लम्बाई= 3.110 कि०मी०)	2,87,58,000.00	दो करोड़ सतासी लाख अठ्ठावन हजार रू० मात्र	15 माह	प्रथम
7	RWD/EE/ BOKARO/ 07/2026-27	सुरीखेडा आर०डी०ओ पथ से कुमिरखेडा आर०डी०ओ पथ तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लम्बाई= 1.090 कि०मी०)	1,21,93,200.00	एक करोड़ इक्कीस लाख तिरपन्ने हजार दो सौ रू० मात्र	09 माह	प्रथम
8	RWD/EE/ BOKARO/ 08/2026-27	आर०डी०ओ रोड चन्दनटांड से आर०डी०ओ रोड एका मोड़ तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लम्बाई= 3.010 कि०मी०)	2,74,64,000.00	दो करोड़ चौहत्तर लाख चौसठ हजार रू० मात्र	15 माह	प्रथम
9	RWD/EE/ BOKARO/ 09/2026-27	किडुडिया पंचायत अन्तर्गत ग्राम मोदीडीह आर०डी०ओ सड़क से आमकीडी गाँव तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लम्बाई= 2.640 कि				

'INDIA IS WORKING TO OPEN THE DOORS TO INTERNATIONAL ENGAGEMENT'

India, Japan to review trade pact, streamline investments: Official

Sandeep Singh & Ravi Dutta Mishra
Tokyo/New Delhi, August 24

INDIA IS set to review its trade agreement with Japan signed in 2011 with an aim to fix the widening trade gap with the country and streamline committed investments worth 10 trillion yen (over \$62 billion) in the next 10 years, a government official said on Monday. This comes as a delegation of over 220 stakeholders from Indian industry, led by the Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal, is in Japan from 24th to 27th August to deepen collaboration with their Japanese counterparts.

Pitching for investment in India, Goyal at a roundtable here said that India is the fastest-growing large nation in the world and is poised to become a \$30 trillion economy by 2047. Bridging this gap is clearly on the agenda, and a roadmap has been laid out, Goyal said, adding that India is working to open the doors to international engagement.

"Today we have free trade agreements (FTAs) or preferential market access in markets

worth \$17 trillion," he said.

"I have three suggestions or asks, as I invite you to leverage the cost competitiveness of our FTAs and our engineering talent. I urge each one of you present in India and those who will be coming to deepen your localisation. It will help you become even more cost-competitive and actually help you supply your components to the rest of the world. The government is also willing to support you in innovation funding," Goyal said.

Goyal cited the example of the first large investment by Suzuki Motor Corporation in the 1980s and said that the market cap of Suzuki in India is over 1.6 times that of the parent company Suzuki Motor Corporation. Stating that "some of the largest and most profitable operations are coming out of India," the minister pointed to the journey of 1,580 Japanese companies in India, adding that "We would like to see 1,580 Suzukis being created out of India and the doubling of the number of the companies operating out of India."

Piyush Goyal held several meetings during the day, including

TRADE RESET

INDIA AIMS to fix the widening trade gap with Japan and streamline committed investment worth 10 trillion yen (over \$62 billion) in the next 10 years

INDIAN DELEGATION, led by the Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, is in Japan from 24th to 27th August to deepen collaboration with their Japanese counterparts

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1
Further, during the fireside chat with Nikkei Asia editor-in-chief Akito Tanaka, he said "We only use safeguards for the low end of the market, which is available in India. In any country, there will be certain areas where there are conflicting demands: local industries... foreign companies coming into the country, protecting certain sectors... sensitivities and because of that it could lead to a situation where in certain areas you may find it difficult to immediately get the attention of the policymakers..."

Responding to concerns over the use of safeguard measures raised by the Japanese companies during the round table, Goyal suggested the Japanese companies source steel from India rather than importing,



Meiji, Serum eye vaccine tie-up

Tokyo/New Delhi: Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal also discussed opportunities to strengthen India-Japan cooperation in the pharmaceutical sector and avenues to expand manufacturing and R&D with the President & Representative Director of Meiji Seika Pharma, Toshiaki Nagasato. The CEO, after the meeting, said that Meiji Seika Pharma is looking to partner with the Serum Institute of India for the supply of vaccines for Japanese Encephalitis. **ENS**

investors into India. The Commerce and Industry Ministry is working very actively to bring investment into the country and is always in the service of investors and business to help them in their journey in India and wherever possible we sort out the case," Goyal said.

Sandeep Singh is in Japan at the invitation of FICCI.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Gold at 3-mth high, India demand rises

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 24

AFTER WEEKS of correction, gold prices have rebounded to their highest level in over three months, led by a weaker dollar, easing expectations of a US Federal Reserve rate hike and US Treasury measures to manage its debt, which have boosted demand for alternative assets.

The precious metal now trades above \$4,630 per ounce on the London Bullion Market Association, the highest level since mid-May, and up over 16% from the \$3,900-\$4,000 levels just last month. It has also followed a similar pattern in the Indian market, now trading at around Rs 1.6 lakh per 10 grams on the Multi Commodity Exchange.

The rally follows the US Treasury's announcement last week that it will at least double buybacks of its longer-term bonds to maintain yields amid high US government debt levels, leading to yields subsidising a bit. Lower yields are positive for gold as they lower the opportunity cost of holding a non-yield-bearing asset, making it a good asset for safe-haven demand.

The treasury's market intervention has also weakened the dollar due to an infusion of liquidity in the market, making the precious metal more affordable.

"The recent yield rise suggests that investors no longer as-

sume the Treasury supply will be absorbed effortlessly. Instead, the balance between supply and demand has become an increasingly important determinant of pricing," noted Johan Palmberg, Senior Quantitative Analyst at the World Gold Council (WGC). "Our view is that the positives would likely outweigh the negatives and likely invite substantial interest in gold," he added.

While the Treasury intervention last week fueled gains, gold had already been rising prior to that as prospects of a rate hike by the Fed eased. The market is now pricing in just a 38% chance of the central bank hiking interest rates in its meeting this month, compared to a nearly 84% chance a month ago.

Chances of the Fed maintaining a status quo on rates for the remainder of the year have also increased recently, after the last few meetings showed that some of its members had favoured a rate hike.

Meanwhile, the demand for gold in the Indian market has picked up as the festive season draws close, spurred by the correction in prices since hitting a peak around late January. A recovery in demand for the jewellery industry and continued interest in gold as an investment avenue have driven this demand, said the WGC.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SEBI rejects Adani-linked offshore fund's requests

Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) rejected applications last week from at least three Mauritius-based funds with investments in the Adani Group to settle cases of regulatory violation involving failure to disclose their shareholder details, two sources

with direct knowledge of the matter said.

Thirteen offshore investors of the Adani Group have been under SEBI investigation since Hindenburg Research in 2023 alleged the group's improper use of tax havens, triggering a stock selloff. **REUTERS**



On a regional basis, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, and Delhi together account for over half of India's total Claude use. **REUTERS**

with per-capita income. India's per-capita use is consistent with what this relationship would predict. Without ad-

ressing structural barriers related to income, digital infrastructure, and awareness outside the IT sector, Indian AI

TCS, Porsche ink €1.25 bn AI deal

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 24

TECH ALLIANCE

● TCS will acquire 100% of MHP Management-und IT-Beratung GmbH (MHP), Porsche's management and IT consulting subsidiary

● It will establish a dedicated AI Mobility Centre of Excellence for Porsche to drive innovation across manufacturing, engineering, operations and customer experience

TATA CONSULTANCY Services (TCS) has announced a strategic partnership with sports car maker Porsche AG of Germany to enable AI services across its mobility value chain, under which TCS will acquire 100% of MHP Management-und IT-Beratung GmbH (MHP), Porsche's management and IT consulting subsidiary, for €320 million (around Rs 3,575 crore).

To support this partnership, Porsche has signed a five-year strategic agreement with MHP and TCS valued at €1.25 billion (Rs 13,967 crore). The partnership is reinforced by a five-year strategic deal from Porsche. As part of the deal, TCS will establish a dedicated AI Mobility Centre of Excellence for Porsche to drive innovation across manufacturing, engineering, operations and customer experience, TCS said. "The proposed partnership and acquisition remain subject to regulatory approvals. MHP brings strong automotive and industrial consulting and implementation experience, with strengths in business transformation, AI, SAP, manufacturing digitalization, and connected mobility," it said.

Its long-standing track record in delivering complex automotive and industrial transformation programs will complement TCS' global scale and engineering prowess, TCS said. K. Krithivasan, Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director, TCS, said, "TCS is pleased to partner

Porsche in its transformation journey. As AI, software, and data redefine the automotive industry, this partnership brings together TCS' capabilities in AI, engineering, technology and business transformation with MHP's strong automotive consulting expertise."

"Together, we will industrialize AI at scale for Porsche, accelerating innovation across the value chain to deliver intelligent, software-defined mobility experiences of the future."

Michael Leiters, CEO, Porsche AG, said, "Porsche is taking another important step in its strategy to focus resolutely on its core business with the transfer of MHP to TCS. At the same time, we are gaining a strategic partner in TCS."

"By combining Porsche's automotive expertise with TCS' digital technology and AI capabilities, we will further strengthen our innovative power, increase efficiency, and boost our competitiveness in an increasingly data and software-driven world of mobility," he said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

FX swap schemes built buffers with 'maximum cost-efficiency': Fin Min

New Delhi: Terming the response to the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) concessional swap facilities for Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposits, Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings, and External Commercial Borrowings as "spectacular", the Ministry of Finance on Monday said the government had added to its external buffers with "maximum cost-efficiency".

The ministry's comments come after speculation the RBI closed the window early due to its high cost. As per the scheme, the RBI is set to bear the entire hedging cost of the FCNR(B) deposits. However, economists have argued the cost of the scheme — estimated by some to be around \$10 billion over a period of five years, assuming \$70 billion is raised in total — is unlikely to have been a factor in the decision to close the facility early.

The RBI's concessional swap facilities, which became operational on June 8, had raked in \$72.85 billion by August 21. Such has been the success of the FCNR(B) scheme in particular that the RBI on August 14 said the swap window would close on August 31, a month earlier than the initially-announced deadline of September 30.

The swap facility for Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings and External Commercial Borrowings will remain open till December 31, as announced originally. **ENS**

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BRIEFLY

FM to leave for 8-day official trip to Canada, US

New Delhi: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman will embark on an official visit to Canada and the US from August 25 to September 2 to hold talks on bilateral economic and financial cooperation, investment opportunities and global economic priorities, besides participating in the G20 Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors meeting. During her visit to Toronto, she will participate in the inaugural Economic and Financial Dialogue with Canada's Finance and National Revenue Minister Francois-Philippe Champagne. **PTI**

CIL sets up arm in Singapore for critical minerals

New Delhi: Coal India Ltd, India's largest coal producer, has incorporated a new wholly owned Singapore-based subsidiary, CIL

Tata Sons board likely to meet on September 17

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 24

THE BOARD of Tata Sons Ltd, the holding company of the Tata group, is likely to meet on September 17 to consider Chairman N Chandrasekaran's resignation and finalise a date for the annual general meeting (AGM), which was adjourned on August 18.

Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata and trustee Venu Srinivasan, who is Chairman Emeritus of TVS Motors, are on the board of Tata Sons. Apart from Chandrasekaran, other directors include former Unilever global COO Harish Manwani, former World Bank official Anita M George and Group CFO Saurabh Agrawal.

Tata Trusts have already decided to initiate the process of setting up a search committee to select Chandrasekaran's successor.

The AGM will happen only when Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), which holds a 23.56% stake in Tata Sons, is able to come out of the restraining order issued by the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner in May. Tata Sons' AGM on August 18 was adjourned due to a lack of quorum, as the regulatory freeze imposed on the SRTT prevented Tata Sons from securing the shareholder representation required to convene the meeting.

The adjournment means the uncertainty over the resolution for the reappointment of Chandrasekaran as a director of Tata Sons will continue.

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PRIVATE AIRPORT SECTOR FACES OLIGOPOLY CONCERNS

Centre plans to cap airports a bidder can win in next privatisation round

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, August 24

IN A bid to minimise risks related to market concentration and over-leveraging, the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) plans to cap the number of airport bundles that can be awarded to the same bidder in the upcoming round of airport privatisation, as per the ministry's submission to Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC) earlier this month.

The submission by MoCA was in response to a query from PPPAC Chair and Secretary, Department of Economic Affairs, Anuradha Thakur in an August 4 meeting on the planned privatisation of 11 airports — clubbed into five bundles — for a 50-year period. The panel gave its in-principle nod to the proposal, as per the minutes of the meeting.

Thakur had sought the ministry's response on what

measures were envisaged to ensure that the risks related to concentration and over-leveraging are minimised, given the oligopolistic nature of the aviation sector. The PPPAC, under the Department of Economic Affairs, is responsible for appraisal and approval of central sector public private partnership (PPP) projects exceeding Rs 100 crore.

India's private sector-operated airport ecosystem is dominated by two groups — Adani and GMR — and concerns over the sector's oligopolistic nature have been flagged over the past few years. In the previous round of airport privatisation in 2019, the Adani Group walked away with all the six airports that were on offer. At present, the group operates eight airports — Mumbai, Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Lucknow, Guwahati, Thiruvananthapuram, Mangaluru, and Navi Mumbai. GMR operates six airports, including Delhi, Hyderabad, North Goa

(Mopa), Visakhapatnam, Nagpur, and Bidar.

"The number of airport bundles that may be awarded to a single bidder would be capped to mitigate the risks arising from market concentration and potential over-leveraging, including their possible cascading impact across projects. The modalities of such capping are being finalised and would be submitted as part of the proposal seeking final recommendation by the PPPAC," MoCA said in response to Thakur's query.

The airports planned to be offered in the next round of privatisation include Amritsar and Kangra-Gaggal (bundle 1), Raipur and Aurangabad (bundle 2), Bhubaneswar and Hubballi (bundle 3), Tiruchirappalli and Tirupatti (bundle 4), and Varanasi, Gaya and Kushinagar (bundle 5). All of these are currently under the Airports Authority of India.

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Govt allows 4-month relief for clean energy projects amid West Asia crisis

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, August 24

THE CRISIS in West Asia is threatening to disrupt India's renewable energy expansion momentum, with the government extending deadlines for projects scheduled to be commissioned on, or after the outbreak of war in the region.

In its latest advisory, the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) has asked renewable energy implementing agencies — including Solar Energy Corporation of India, NTPC Ltd, National Hydroelectric Power Corporation Ltd and SJVN Ltd, as well as the power,

energy and renewable energy departments of the state and Union Territory governments — to consider extensions of up to four months for projects scheduled to be commissioned on or after February 28, 2026. The move comes weeks after industry bodies sought relief from the ministry, warning that disruptions due to the conflict were affecting the procurement, manufacturing, logistics and execution of utility-scale renewable energy projects.

Meanwhile, government data also points to a slowdown in India's pace of solar capacity addition in the latest quarter. In the April-June 2026 quarter,

solar capacity additions stood at 11.8 GW, down 18.1% from 14.4 GW in the previous quarter.

In FY26, the country added 44.61 GW of solar capacity, of which 16.3 GW, or 36%, came from distributed solar, leaving 28.31 GW from mainly utility-scale projects. In its advisory, MNRE referred to an April office memorandum issued by the Department of Expenditure under the Ministry of Finance, which clarified that the situation in West Asia should be treated as a "war" and provided for a time extension of up to four months on account of the crisis.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

India is Claude's second-largest market, but ranks 101st in per-capita usage

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, August 24

INDIA IS the second-largest market for Anthropic's Claude AI by overall usage, but ranks near the bottom globally when that usage is adjusted for the size of its working-age population. The finding highlights how adoption of the chatbot remains limited to a relatively small section of users in the country — and India's per-capita income may have a role to play.

According to Anthropic's latest Economic Index, India ranks 101st among 116 countries in Claude usage per working-age person. The gap between India's high aggregate usage

and its low per-capita ranking suggests that the country's position as one of Claude's biggest markets is driven largely by its population size, rather than widespread adoption of the AI tool across workers and consumers. "This gap suggests that India's high Claude use overall reflects the sheer size of its population, not that the average person is using Claude heavily," Anthropic said.

As of 2025, India's per capita income is \$2,702 (Rs 2,58,548) per year. For reference, the per capita income of Bangladesh is \$2,597 while that of Sri Lanka is around \$5,000. The US has a per capita income of around \$90,000.

Snapshot of India's AI use

The findings point to a broader challenge for AI adoption in India, where access to and use of advanced AI tools remains uneven despite the country's large technology workforce and the government's push to expand domestic AI capabilities.

Anthropic's analysis shows that higher-income countries generally record greater Claude usage per person, with factors such as income, access to digital infrastructure and awareness of AI tools likely influencing adoption.

"Globally, per-capita AI adoption is strongly correlated

with per-capita income. India's per-capita use is consistent with what this relationship would predict. Without ad-

option is likely to remain concentrated," it added.

The data also suggests that Claude's use in India is currently more closely linked to professional and technical work than broad-based consumer adoption.

This could limit the extent to which productivity gains from generative AI spread across sectors, particularly outside technology-heavy occupations and major economic centres.

It is worth noting that Anthropic's analysis is based on Claude usage and may not be a measure of overall AI adoption in India, though it is one

of the most popular AI companies in the world.

Indian states using Claude

Claude use in India is concentrated in a few economically high-performing states. Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, and Delhi together account for over half of India's total Claude use — and "this pattern closely mirrors India's IT sector geography and urban economic output," the company said.

"The concentration in these four states — home to Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Mumbai, and Delhi NCR — sug-

gests that current AI adoption is driven primarily by India's established technology workforce rather than broad-based consumer uptake," it said.

The primary reasons that Indians are using Claude also reflect that gap. Anthropic said the occupational mix of Indian Claude AI use, inferred by mapping tasks to related occupations, skews towards software development and engineering roles, consistent with the country's large IT services sector. "Broadening AI's economic impact will require looking beyond software and IT services," it added.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Trump threatens 50% tariffs on all cars and trucks from Canada

Reuters
Washington, August 24

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump on Monday threatened to raise US tariffs on all cars, trucks and automotive parts from Canada to 50% starting January 1, 2027, escalating a trade fight after negotiations collapsed last week.

The trade deal on the table would have cut the top-line tariff rate on Canadian cars and light-duty trucks from 25% to 15% and the tariffs on aluminum and steel from 50% to 25% but the deal fell apart on Friday over a number of points of contention including whether the US tariff relief would have applied to medium- or heavy-duty trucks.

The escalation threatens to disrupt one of the world's most integrated auto supply chains. U.S. auto production is heavily reliant on Canadian-made parts and vehicles, and higher tariffs could raise costs for American automakers and consumers while deepening a trade standoff that has already weighed on auto stocks. "Build in the US and there are ZERO TARIFFS. Canada will be treated like a State no longer!" Trump wrote in a social media post.

COUNTRIES FACILITATING TEHRAN WILL BE CUT OFF FROM DOLLAR-BASED FINANCIAL SYSTEM: BESSENT

US declares expansion of sanctions in its 'economic onslaught' on Iran

Treasury imposes sanctions on nearly 60 entities, vessels and individuals

David Lawder & Humeyra Pamuk
Washington, August 24

THE US on Monday announced an expansion of secondary sanctions it hopes will "sever every economic lifeline" that sustains Iran, US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said at a press conference.

Bessent unveiled what he described as an "economic D-Day" that aims to give a final warning to countries to cut their business ties with Iran or risk having key companies and entities cut off from the dollar-based financial system.

"We are launching an economic onslaught against Iran's financial connections around the globe. Our objective is to sever every economic lifeline that sustains this tyrannical re-



United States Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent speaks at a news conference on Monday. AP

gime until Tehran stands alone," Bessent said.

The US Treasury Department has mapped the networks, facilitators, and financial channels that Iran uses to smuggle oil and evade sanctions and said that Washington would be working with US partners to target any source of Iran's "illicit revenue."

The department said it has issued determinations against

five sectors — digital assets, technology, gold, aviation and shipping — that the Iranian government is using to prop up its economy. The Treasury has also imposed sanctions on nearly 60 entities, individuals and vessels.

China has for several years been the biggest buyer of Iranian oil and Washington has intensified its efforts to clamp down on Chinese purchases, but has so far stopped short of

designating larger Chinese banks that may be facilitating the oil trade.

Trump's war with Iran, which has pushed energy prices higher worldwide, is about to hit its six-month mark. While heavy fighting has subsided, diplomatic efforts to end the war have stalled and oil and raw material shipping through the Strait of Hormuz remains blocked, keeping energy prices elevated.

Trump's approval rating has fallen to a low point, with just 33% of Americans in the latest Reuters/Ipsos poll approving of his performance. He says the economic costs are necessary to ensure Iran does not have a nuclear weapon.

The US has maintained sanctions against Iran for decades, most of which have been aimed at curtailing the country's oil revenues, aviation sector, cryptocurrency, procurement of weapons components and other military hardware, and cutting off funding for business enterprises controlled by the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, a dominant force in the Iranian economy.

China, Jordan call for restoring Hormuz passage

Reuters
Beijing, August 24

CHINA AND Jordan on Monday said the ceasefire between the US and Iran should be maintained, and that the normal passage through the Strait of Hormuz should be restored, the two countries said in a joint statement, according to China's Xinhua news agency.

China and Jordan said "a comprehensive solution capable of eliminating the root causes" of regional tensions should be reached through dialogue and negotiations. The two also expressed "deep concern over Israel's dangerous escalatory actions in the West Bank and East Jerusalem."

Chinese President Xi Jinping met with Jordan's King Abdullah in Beijing on Monday.

• BRIEFLY

DENMARK

PM rebukes unsolicited beauty advice from surgeon on Instagram



Danish Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen

DANISH PRIME Minister Mette Frederiksen is fed up with getting unsolicited beauty advice. The 48-year-old wrote Monday on Instagram that she had just returned back home from a trip to Ukraine, where she was exposed to air raid sirens in the ongoing war, only to find a message by a plastic surgeon offering her to "fix that little spot on your nose." "I've lost count of how many messages I've received over the years about my appearance," Frederiksen wrote. "Especially that I have ugly teeth and thin hair. That I have an ugly 'wart' on my nose and well-meaning advice to get some Botox." The prime minister of the Nordic country posted a screen shot of the plastic surgeon's offer on Instagram but without identifying him. AP

LIBYA

Govt executes 10 people on terror charges

AUTHORITIES IN eastern Libya said they executed 10 people after their conviction by military courts on terrorism-related charges. The executions, announced on Sunday, triggered condemnations by rights groups in the country that is divided between rival groups, each backed by a set of militias and foreign governments. The office of the military prosecutor said the 10 people were executed by firing squad after years-long trials. AP

UNITED STATES

5 bodies found outside Portland, probe underway

FIVE BODIES were found on a rural property outside Portland in the US and authorities said Sunday it was being investigated as a quintuple homicide. The Washington County Sheriff's Office said authorities initially responded early Saturday to reports of a vehicle fire at a property in Forest Grove, about 48 kilometres west of downtown Portland. Responders then found the remains of five people and "several domestic animals." AP

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

NEPAL

First modern tunnel road opens for public

NEPAL'S FIRST modern road tunnel, the Nagdhunga passage, connecting Kathmandu to other districts, was opened to the public on Monday, allowing small private vehicles to use the tunnel road on a trial basis. Cars, jeeps, vans and other light private vehicles carrying up to nine passengers have been allowed to use the tunnel, which was previously limited to emergency services only, said Kabiraj Shrestha, deputy chief of the Nagdhunga Tunnel Road Safety Unit. PTI

PAKISTAN

Sunni cleric killed in sectarian attack in Punjab

A RENOWNED Sunni cleric was shot dead in a sectarian attack inside a mosque in Punjab province of Pakistan, police said Monday. The incident took place in Shadiwal town of Gujrat, about 200 kms from Lahore, in the early hours of Sunday. Sunni cleric Muhammad Talha Raza was present at the mosque when 4 armed men entered and opened fire on him, police said. The attack left him critically injured and he was taken to a hospital, where he succumbed to his wounds. PTI

Ukraine wants peace but won't give in: Zelenskyy

Reuters
Kyiv, August 24

UKRAINE WANTS peace but will not just surrender to Russia at any price, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said in a defiant speech on Monday to mark Independence Day, as foreign leaders pledged their support.

Flanked by British Prime Minister Andy Burnham and European Council President Antonio Costa, Zelenskyy praised the resilience of the Ukrainian people during more than four years of war with Russia. "Ukraine absolutely wants peace, but it is not ready to simply surrender," Zelenskyy said, warning that Russia would not halt its aggression even if Ukraine ceded to its demands for more territory in the country's east.

Wearing a traditional Ukrainian embroidered shirt, Zelenskyy thanked several foreign leaders for travelling to Kyiv to show their continued backing, on the 35th anniversary of Ukraine's break from the Soviet Union.



British PM Andy Burnham meets soldiers at the Main Military Hospital in Kyiv on Monday. AP

Burnham, who took office last month, said his choice of Kyiv for his first foreign visit showed the importance he attached to assisting in Ukraine's defence.

"We are with you in this struggle all the way, heart and soul," Burnham said, vowing to continue that support "despite Russia's outrageous threats to my country."

Britain announced on Monday it would allow Kyiv access to classified technology to start production of European SCALP long-range cruise missiles in Ukraine, capable of carrying out strikes deep within Russia.

Jemima questions Britain's 'long silence' on Khan's penalisation

Lahore: Jemima Goldsmith on Monday questioned the "long silence" of the British government on Pakistan's former prime minister and her ex-husband Imran Khan's "brutal penalisation" by his political opponents and Chief of Defence Forces Field Marshal Asim Munir.

Khan, 73, was arrested on August 5, 2023, in a corruption

case and has remained in custody since then. He has been lodged in Adiala Jail, a detention facility on the outskirts of Rawalpindi.

"Prime Minister @andyburnham and Foreign Secretary @Ed_Miliband: how much longer will Britain remain silent?" Goldsmith said in a post on X. PTI

Bangladesh tribunal orders 3 journalists in '24 uprising case be held until trial

Dhaka: A special tribunal in Bangladesh's capital on Monday asked authorities to keep three journalists jailed until their trial in a case involving a mass uprising that ousted former prime minister Sheikh Hasina from office in 2024, lawyers said.

During the student-led uprising, hundreds of people were killed, and Hasina was later sentenced to death on charges of crimes against humanity. She fled to India two years ago and was tried in absentia.

The tribunal asked that Muzammel Babu, editor-in-chief of private Ekattor Television, its principal correspondent Farzana Rupa and Shyamal Dutta, editor of daily *Bhorer Kagoj* and former general secretary of the National Press Club in Dhaka, remain jailed. PTI

Trump to codify rule imposing \$1,00,000 fee for H-1B work visa

Proposed rule would extend the fee imposed by Trump last year

Daniel Wiessner
August 24

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump's administration on Monday released a proposed regulation to codify an unprecedented more than \$1,00,000 fee on new H-1B visas for highly skilled foreign workers that Trump first imposed last year but has been blocked by the courts.

The fee first imposed by Trump in a temporary proclamation last year vastly raises the cost of the visas that are heavily relied on in the tech, education and research sectors. A federal judge in June ruled that the fee was illegal and blocked the



The H-1B program offers 65,000 visas annually

Trump administration from collecting it.

A Boston-based appeals court is reviewing that decision while a different court considers whether a judge in Washington, DC, properly rejected a challenge to the fee by a major business group. Trump's 2025 proclamation imposing the fee expires in September, one year after it was issued, but directed the US Department of Homeland Security (DHS) to adopt regulations making it permanent.

The proposed \$103,265 fee by DHS, posted online in the Federal Register on Monday to be

Washington Post ordered to reinstate columnist who posted on Kirk: NYT

Reuters
August 24

THE WASHINGTON Post has been ordered to reinstate opinion columnist Karen Attiah and provide her with back pay, the *New York Times* reported on Monday, after the newspaper fired her in September over social media posts about conservative activist Charlie Kirk's assassination.

Private arbitrator Sarah Miller Espinosa found the news-

paper "did not have good and sufficient cause" to terminate Attiah and had "violated" its labour agreement. The ruling comes amid broader scrutiny of the Post's Opinion section after owner Jeff Bezos pushed to refocus it on themes including personal liberties and free markets. The dispute began after Attiah's posts on Bluesky following Kirk's September 2025 assassination, including one in which she noted Kirk's past comments on Black women.

Museum heists have turned more violent, with thieves hired on social media: Europol

Reuters
Brussels, August 24

ART THIEVES in Europe are committing more violent robberies focusing on gold and jewels, and specialist gangs have been replaced by ad-hoc opportunists recruited through social media, Europol said on Monday.

The heist at the Louvre Museum in Paris in October last year was a prime example of these shifts, Europol said, as the thieves threatened guards and visitors, and stole €88 million



A crown worn by French Empress Eugenie was targeted by thieves in 2025

worth of jewels such as Empress Eugenie's tiara.

Over the last two years, art

thieves have shifted their attention to precious metals, jewels and cultural artefacts that offer greater profits, the EU's law enforcement agency said in a report.

The price of gold has surged 85% over the past two years, as investors and central banks turn to the metal as a safe haven.

The London Bullion Market Association, which oversees London's over-the-counter gold trading hub, has warned that "as gold prices rise to historic levels, illicit flows and

market distortions are also increasing."

Europol said: "Offenders are breaching premises and displaying cases using tools such as sledgehammers, axes, crowbars and, in some instances, explosives. "Where traditional gangs used "deception and stealth", had a central leader and niche expertise, recent thefts were carried out by a decentralised ad-hoc group of profit-seeking opportunists, recruited through social media on a "crime-as-a-service" basis, it said.

• RUSSIA AND UKRAINE TOGETHER ACCOUNT FOR NEARLY A THIRD OF THE WHEAT THAT THE WORLD BUYS; THIS YEAR, JUST AS HARVESTS BEGAN, THEIR GRAIN SHIPMENTS HAVE NEARLY GROUND TO A HALT

World's breadbaskets are getting pounded by war, weather and trade spats

Somini Sengupta
August 24

INSTANT NOODLES. Hot chapatis. Sliced bread.

Wheat is at the heart of the modern diet, and this year, it is facing an accumulation of modern dangers. The breadbaskets of the world are getting pummeled by drone strikes and devilish weather, nudging prices higher amid already soaring food costs in the wake of the Iran war.

Heat and drought have diminished harvests in some of the biggest wheat-producing countries, including the United States, which is expected to have its worst wheat harvest in a half-century, spiking prices. Low-income countries that agreed to buy American wheat under the threat of Trump tariffs could be

stuck paying abnormally high prices.

The Black Sea, a crucial passage for the global wheat trade, is an active theater of the Russia-Ukraine war, while the Houthis militia's attacks on shipping in the Red Sea have already forced grain shipments to take a longer, more expensive route around South Africa.

Beyond that, a supercharged El Nino further threatens water levels in the Panama Canal, while drought has reduced water levels to perilously low levels in transit routes like the Rhine and Danube rivers in Europe, raising transportation costs. All this at a time when the global atmosphere is hotter than normal because of a century of fossil fuel burning, threatening the livelihoods of small farmers in low-income countries.

The simultaneous troubles reveal the risks inherent in the global food system today. Only a few crops, like wheat, provide most of the world's calories. Relatively few governments dominate the export of wheat, including Russia, Canada, the United States, Ukraine and the European Union. Their customers are mainly low-income countries that no longer grow much of the food their people eat. "The system we currently have in place depends on three things: seamless trade, cheap energy, stable climate," said Evan Fraser, a professor who studies the global food system at the University of Guelph in Ontario. "Today, it seems none of these assumptions are met."

Few things are as politically potent as the price of bread, and wheat prices were already at a



Ukrainian soldiers patrol in an unharvested wheat field along frontline positions near Barkovkove. FILE/NYT Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGF9mljMzg1

three-year high in July, according to the Food and Agriculture Organization. The UN agency has warned of higher prices later this year.

The saving grace is that the world had a bumper harvest of

reinforce one another."

"A combination of El Nino-related weather impacts across major exporters, renewed constraints on Black Sea exports and further disruptions to key shipping routes would have implications far beyond wheat production itself," she said.

Russia and Ukraine together account for nearly a third of the wheat that the world buys. This year, just as harvests began, their grain shipments have nearly ground to a halt.

In recent weeks, Russia and Ukraine have stepped up their attacks on each other's grain export terminals and ships in the Black Sea, a waterway they share to get their goods out to the world.

Wildfires this summer spared the wheat belt of France, the EU's largest wheat producer.

But the heat has not.

France expects lower yields because of record heat this summer, according to government projections. Germany's main farmers group said Tuesday that yields were down for several crops, including wheat, because of drought and heat. In July, the European trade group for agricultural commodities, Cooeral, issued a special bulletin, estimating lower grain yields of 286.6 million metric tons this year, compared with 310 million metric tons in 2025, for the Continent and for Britain.

Australia, also a major wheat exporter, planted fewer acres of wheat because of high fertiliser costs, stemming from the Strait of Hormuz closure.

The United States is about to have its worst wheat harvest since 1970, largely because of a

terrible drought in the Great Plains, the US Department of Agriculture estimated in its latest report this month. American farmers had devoted fewer acres to wheat, and yields per acre were also down.

Rising prices of imported wheat put enormous pressure on governments that are forced to buy high and then help subsidise the costs to keep bread prices within the reach of its people.

Egypt, which buys most of its wheat from abroad, including from Russia and Ukraine, has tried to bolster wheat production at home, with the government offering higher prices to farmers. Still, Egypt remains far from reaching anything close to self-sufficiency. There is simply not enough water to produce what the country needs. NYT

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

INFRASTRUCTURE

Inside Andhra’s policy to enforce ‘right to walk’

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, August 24

IN INDIA, one in every five persons killed in a road accident is a pedestrian. After the Supreme Court’s order recognising the right to walk on footpaths as a fundamental right earlier this year, Andhra Pradesh has become the country’s first state to formulate a pedestrian safety policy.

The Andhra Pradesh Pedestrian Safety and Universal Accessibility Policy 2026, notified on August 7, mandates a three-step system: road safety audits, fixing footpath infrastructure (including removal of encroachments) and behavioural change.

The policy will apply to all local body areas. Agencies responsible for roads in cities with populations above one million have been directed to implement it first.

The policy also invokes Section 198A of the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988, under which officials, contractors, and consultants can be fined Rs 1 lakh if infrastructural or design failures cause pedestrian death or disability.

Footpath audits

Local authorities will conduct an audit of the existing footpaths with priority to crowded and high-footfall areas such as markets, railway stations, bus stands, religious and educational institutions. It says authorities must prioritise at least 15-20 specific “black spots” — places where there have been frequent pedestrian injuries or deaths in the last 2-3 years.

The audit will cover the assessment of the physical condition of the pavement and pedestrian crossings. The authorities must survey 20% of roads within one year of policy commencement to assess additional pedestrian crossing requirements, and finalise the work within seven months.

The policy directs the mandatory removal of unauthorised structures, illegal stalls and other encroachments on footpaths. But it does not specify any timeline for this. It recommends automated and camera-based monitoring systems for these footpaths, and deployment of pedestrian guardrails and bollards.

PEDESTRIAN DEATHS

● In 2024, out of 8,346 road accident deaths in Andhra Pradesh, 1,739 were pedestrians. Of 1.77 lakh road deaths recorded in 2024 across India, 36,526 were pedestrians.

● Around 31% of pedestrian deaths occur on national highways alone.

Specifications of footpath

The footpaths shall have a minimum walking area of two metres to accommodate wheelchairs comfortably, 0.4-1 metre of buffer space and a 1.5-metre area for multi-utility zone to accommodate tree pits, auto rickshaw stands,

seating and on-street vending.

The height shall not be more than 150 mm from the road. The surface must be firm, stable, even and slip-resistant. The bollards to prevent bikes from entering the footpath should be 0.5-0.7 metres high with a clear spacing of 0.6 metres between them, and one with 1 metre width for wheelchair access.

The pedestrian policy also mandates the tactile pavers to aid visually impaired persons and curb ramps at all crossings. It discourages forcing pedestrians onto inaccessible foot overbridges where at-grade crossings like zebra crossing can be safely provided.

Social policing and performance

The policy has also included the provision of behavioural change among citizens. A district-level grievance mobile application or portal will be created to facilitate the reporting of violations by citizens. It also mandates the ranking metric for evaluating the performance of different urban local bodies on pedestrian safety.

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ECONOMICS

The other ‘NEET’ that India needs to address



UDIT MISRA

YOUTH PROTESTS that forced the resignation of India’s Union Education Minister almost exactly a month ago have not only brought the issue of education into sharp focus, but also highlighted concerns related to unemployment — especially among the youth.

Until now, the government has often cited data on the Unemployment Rate (UER) to suggest that Indians are doing well on the jobs front. The UER is calculated as the number of unemployed people within the total labour force (those currently working or looking for work). Official data from the Periodic Labour Force Surveys (PLFS) says that the UER has fallen steadily from 6.1% in 2017-18 — hitting a 45-year high — to just 3.1% in 2025.

This is the UER for those aged 15 years and above, suggesting that broadly, the Indian economy has been creating jobs. However, at least three immediate problems arise even if one looks only at the UER.

Youth unemployment: Growing worry

The first problem is that the UER for those between the ages of 15 and 29 years is still quite high, even though this number has also been falling. It has fallen from almost 18% in 2017-18 to around 10% in 2022-23 but has since stayed at this level.

In fact, not only is the unemployment rate highest among the youth as a cohort, it rises with educational attainment. As *Chart 1* shows, graduates aged 25 face the highest unemployment rate — as high as almost 40%. It means that on average, 4 out of 10 graduates aged 25 years looking for work fail to get it.

The data is from the State of Working India (SWI) 2026 report by researchers at the Azim Premji University. They also calculated that the UER among young Indians with education up to graduation or more was actually higher in 2023 than in 1983.

While graduates being unemployed is not a new phenomenon in India, so much so that even movies of yesteryears capture this routine but crushing reality, the situation

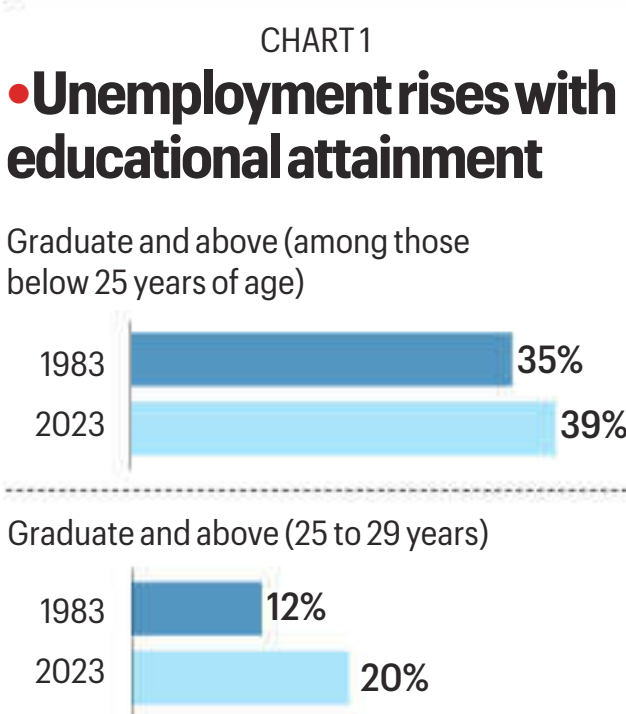
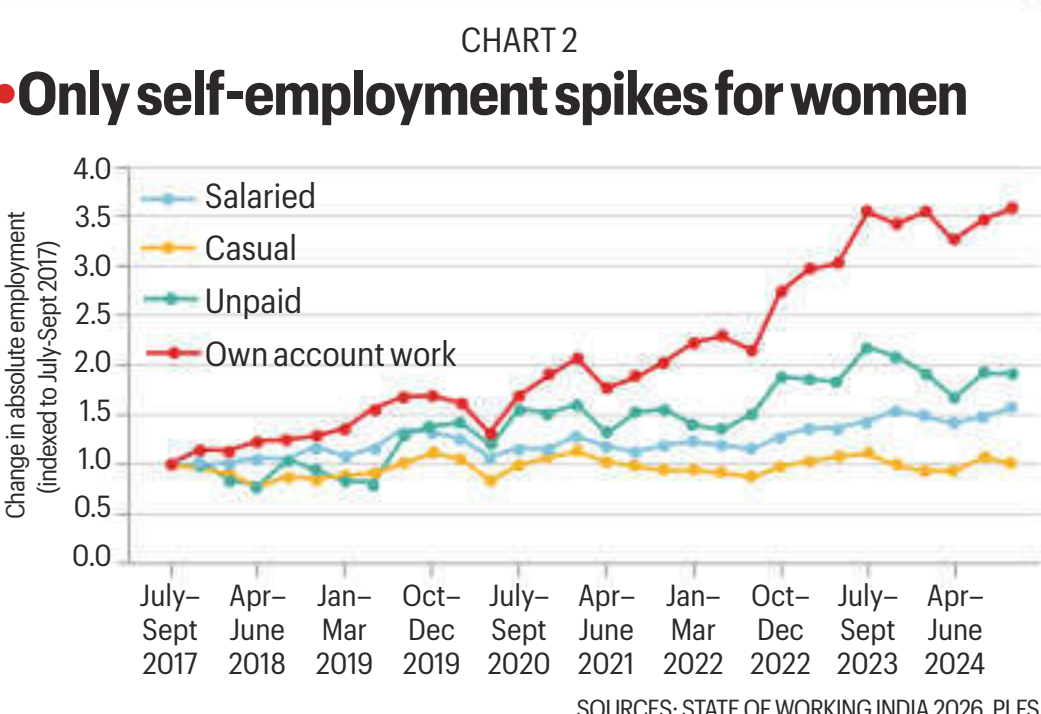


TABLE 1

● Size of workforce (in millions)

Year	Male	Female	Total
2017-18	338	94	433
2018-19	343	97	440
2019-20	357	122	480
2020-21	357	126	483
2021-22	363	126	490
2022-23	349	128	477
2023-24	387	186	573
2025 (Jan-Dec)	416	206	616



SOURCES: STATE OF WORKING INDIA 2026, PLFS

seems to be worsening over time.

Quality of jobs, not just quantity

The second problem is that while more jobs have been created since 2017-18, there is a big question mark on their quality. *Table 1* shows the size of the Indian workforce — the total number of people with a job. It has risen from 43.3 crore (or 433 million) in 2017-18 to around 61 crore as of December 2025.

But a closer look shows that most new jobs are either in agriculture or in pursuits that pay little or see stagnant earnings. The SWI 2026 pointed out: “In the post-Covid period India’s employed population has increased... with employment rates rising from 71 to 74 percent for men and from 26 to 34 percent for women, between 2021-22 and 2023-24. But the majority of employment creation has been in agriculture. Of the 83 million jobs added between 2021-22 and 2023-24, 40 million have been in agriculture, with women accounting for a large share (38 million).”

Similarly, while women have increasingly joined India’s workforce — from 94 million in 2017-18 to 186 million in 2023-24 — as *Chart 2* shows, most earn very little. “The number of women in own-account self-employment has seen a nearly four-fold increase since 2017. Self-employment earnings among women and salaried earnings (for men and women) have largely stagnated,” states the report.

Unemployment rate misleads

Lastly, in a developing economy such as India, using the UER to assess job market stress can be deeply misleading. That’s be-

Capturing lack of jobs

In India, there is evidence to show that not everyone registers in official surveys as people looking for a job.

● NEET, an acronym for ‘Not in Employment, Education, or Training’, is a metric that can help measure unemployment in a more comprehensive manner.

cause the unemployment rate is measured as a percentage of the people demanding a job. While this is a reasonable approach generally, in India, evidence shows that not everyone registers in official surveys as people looking for a job. As such, the number of people unemployed is often far more than what is captured.

Rosa Abraham, an associate professor of economics who teaches at APU and is one of the authors of the SWI report, told *The Indian Express*, “Unemployment is only measured when you are willing to work and/or searching for a job. But, especially in the case of women (in India), what would happen is that regardless of their education, and even when they have, say, completed graduation, they may not explicitly record or be recorded (in the surveys) as looking for work.” Such women thus get counted out of the “labour force”.

If these people were counted as unemployed, they would then be part of the labour force, and the unemployment rate would be much higher.

“So UER is really the lowest estimate of people who are not being mobilised into the workforce. There is an entire pool of people who are out of the labour force who are either discouraged workers, or there are social norms (often for women) that keep them out of work,” explains Abraham.

The other NEET

Another metric better captures how the Indian economy is failing its youth. It is called NEET — an acronym for “Not in

Employment, Education, or Training”.

NEET “is a comprehensive measure of this labour under-utilisation while excluding those in education or training. NEET not only includes the unemployed, but also those who are of working age and are neither in education/training nor employment,” the APU report says.

Simply put, NEET presumes that many people may be pursuing education and, as such, they cannot be expected to join the workforce. So, NEET attempts to understand the share of people outside this umbrella.

According to PLFS data from March, 25% of Indian youth were NEET. Population projections by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare state that India’s youth population in 2026 stood at 36.8 crore, making it the world’s largest youth population. If one applies the same proportion of NEET to 2026, out of a total youth population of 368 million (36.8 crore), around 92 million or 9.2 crore are in NEET.

In other words, the number of Indian youth neither involved in education nor skilling nor any kind of employment today is around 9.2 crore — almost equal to the entire population of Iran.

Apart from the high youth unemployment rate, such a high absolute number of NEET population may explain the growing youth unrest in the country. It is also important to remember that these numbers are at a time when the government is happy with the pace of economic growth based on GDP figures, even calling it a “goldilocks” period.

HISTORY

Tracing Ashoka in Ujjain: What new dig at Vaishya Tekri can reveal

Nikita Mohta
New Delhi, August 24

THE MADHYA Pradesh government has begun restoring Buddhist monuments linked to the Mauryan emperor Ashoka, starting with a fresh excavation at Vaishya Tekri in Ujjain.

Initial excavations by the Department of Archaeology of the erstwhile Gwalior State in 1938–39 unveiled large bricks and punch-marked coins here, prompting archaeologists to date the structure to the Mauryan period.

In his 2011 paper, “Asoka and Buddhist Nuns: Early Buddhism in Ujjain and Malwa”, academic Peter Skilling wrote: “The largest stupa, popularly called Vaisya Tekri, is about 350 feet at its base and 100 feet high. Nearby is a smaller stupa, called Kumbhar (or Kumhar) Tekri. Both are relatively undisturbed, except for the unfortunate fact that a power line runs between them, and a giant pylon squats rudely on Kumbhar Tekri’s shoulder.”

But academic Himanshu Prabha Ray, in an interview with *The Indian Express*, urged caution, noting that the excavation report is decades old and that its interpre-

tation was shaped by earlier accounts, particularly Alexander Cunningham’s writings on Ashoka. While acknowledging the mound’s impressive size and its reported comparison with the Great Stupa at Sanchi, Ray said, “I think we are jumping the gun. We need to investigate further beyond the 1938-39 excavation.”

Ashoka’s years in Ujjain

Ujjayini (modern Ujjain), on the banks of the Sipra, a tributary of the Chambal, was the capital of Avanti and an important commercial centre. Historian Romila Thapar, in *Asoka and the Decline of the Mauryas*, notes that Ujjain was a major cross-roads, linking trade routes to western coastal ports such as Broach and Sopira, as well as to Pataliputra.

Ashoka was sent to Avanti as viceroy by his father, Bindusara. Unlike his brief sojourn in Taxila, he is believed to have spent about a decade in Avanti, with Ujjain as his headquarters. Thapar writes, “We feel that he was sent to Taxila for a special purpose and after having completed his work there, he was then appointed to the viceroyalty at Ujjain in recognition of his work.”

Ancient city

● Mud fortifications were first built around Ujjain in the seventh century BCE. By about the sixth century BCE, Avanti, with Ujjain as its capital, had emerged as a powerful independent kingdom.

● Historian Nayanjot Lahiri says of Ujjain, “By the time Ashoka got there, it was an urban centre of respectable antiquity, having flourished along the Sipra river for 300 years or more before it became his place of functioning.”



Vaishya Tekri has an estimated height of 100 ft, against the 54 ft Sanchi Stupa. EXPRESS Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mljMzg1

Where Ashoka met Devi
On his way to Ujjain, Ashoka stopped in Vidisha, where he met Vedisadevi, the daughter of a merchant. They later had a son, Mahinda, and a daughter, Sanghamitta. Ashoka’s appointment to Ujjain appears to be well supported by historical evidence: his own edicts, issued after he became emperor, refer to the presence of a prince, or kumara, at Ujjain. Lahiri also points to the geography, “Ashoka is shown as meeting Devi at Vidisha, and Vidisha falls on the way to Ujjayini from Pataliputra”.

CLIMATE

Why Indian cities flood after heavy rain and overheat in summer every year



EXPERTS EXPLAIN
AMAN KUMAR
& SALONI SRIVASTAVA

RESEARCHERS AT GATEWAY RESEARCH (IGSD INDIA), NEW DELHI

FROM INTENSE heat across Delhi-NCR in May to heavy rain inundating the city’s arterial roads and low-lying sectors on Monday, both extreme weather events exposed the same problem. Weather translates into an urban disaster when it is met with dense construction, weak drainage, loss of open land, unsafe housing and public systems that aren’t ready for those most at risk.

When does a natural hazard become an urban disaster?

A heatwave, cloudburst or cyclone is a hazard, but it becomes a disaster when it strikes a place where people, buildings, and public services are exposed and lack the capacity to withstand it.

Heavy rain need not cause severe flooding in a city if water can drain, spread or seep into the ground. But the same rain can bring it to a halt when natural drains have been narrowed, lakes and floodplains built over, and large areas covered with concrete.

The same applies to heat. Dense construction, asphalt, poor ventilation and the loss of tree cover cause neighbourhoods to absorb heat during the day and retain it after sunset.

The danger is greater for people living in poorly ventilated homes and for those who work outdoors without reliable access to shade, drinking water or healthcare.

The hazard may begin with the weather, but the extent of the damage depends on how the city has been built and governed.

Why are Indian cities becoming more vulnerable?

Heatwaves and periods of intense rainfall are becoming more severe, while cities continue to replace soil, vegetation and water bodies with buildings, roads and other hard surfaces. This raises local temperatures and leaves less ground through which rainwater can drain. The World Bank estimates that temperatures in Indian city centres can be 3-4°C higher than in surrounding areas.

India’s urban population is expected to reach 951 million by 2050, and more than half the infrastructure that Indian cities will need by then is yet to be built. Whether this adds to the risk will depend on where construction is permitted, what materials are used, and whether natural drainage systems and open spaces are retained.

What do these disasters cost?

Official estimates generally capture deaths and damage to roads, buildings and other public assets. They are less likely to capture wages lost by informal workers, the

cost of illness, the disruption of small businesses or the time spent recovering from repeated flooding.

In terms of avoidable losses, the World Bank estimates that timely adaptation could prevent annual urban flood losses of about \$5 billion by 2030 and \$30 billion by 2070. Measures to reduce extreme heat could also save more than 130,000 lives by 2050.

What has changed in the law?

After a 2025 amendment, Section 41A of The Disaster Management Act, 2005, allows state governments to constitute an Urban Disaster Management Authority in every state capital and city with a municipal corporation, except Delhi and Chandigarh. These authorities are responsible for preparing and implementing an urban disaster management plan.

A separate change was made to disaster financing in August 2026, when heatwaves and lightning were included in the list of notified natural calamities. States can now use disaster response funds for eligible relief,

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Vn2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F> what plinth levels buildings must maintain. Heat maps should inform requirements for shade, ventilation, tree cover and building materials.

Where does the system fall short?

The amendment leaves the constitution of urban disaster authorities to state governments and sets no deadline. Except Bengaluru, responsibility in most cities remains divided among municipal corporations, district administrations and state departments, which may work under different plans and lines of authority.

There is also a shortage of basic planning capacity. A 2021 NITI Aayog report found that 65% of India’s 7933 urban settlements had no master plan. State planning departments were either understaffed or had posts lying vacant.

What would reduce the risk?

Disaster planning needs to become part of the routine decisions through which a city grows. Flood maps should determine where construction is prohibited, where drainage capacity must be increased and

Weather risk cannot be removed from a city. But when the same roads flood and the same neighbourhoods overheat each year, the failure lies in decisions that were made well before the season began.

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

	HEAD CONSTABLE UDAYENDU HALDAR 09 BN BSF 13.01.1964 – 25.08.2011	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Udayendu Haldar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in a grenade blast triggered by militants in Baramulla area (J&K) and later succumbed to his injuries at 92 base hospital.
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CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

	Veer Balidani Head Constable Bhopendra Prasad Singh 159 Bn 7-1-1953 To 25-8-2008	DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Bhopendra Prasad Singh of 159 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Gaya district, Bihar, on 25 August 2008. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.
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	Veer Balidani Constable Shyamveer Singh 125 Bn 1-1-1969 To 25-8-2000		Veer Balidani Constable Jitendra Kumar Tripathi 125 Bn 4-4-1970 To 25-8-2000
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DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Shyamveer Singh and Constable Jitendra Kumar Tripathi of 125 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in a massive IED blast in Assam on 25 August 2000. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

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2	29264742	02/09/26	POH Kit for RR20100 CGM air compressor.	19 Set.	248780/-
3	25263613	08/09/26	High Speed Pantograph.	65 Nos.	545340/-
4	25263622A	14/09/26	Microprocessor based Electronic speed cum energy monitoring system.	25 Nos.	180860/-
5	29263257	16/09/26	M12 Kit for Air Dryer of Trident make.	218 Set.	142000/-
6	60260048	02/10/26	1 IN 8.5 WELDABLE CAST MANGANESE STEEL CROSSING B.G. (1673 MM) etc.	80 Set.	627010/-
7	60260011-PA	21/09/26	Price Agreement for Manufacturing and Supply of 6 mm thick pocket type Nylon Cord Reinforced Grooved Rubber Sole Plates for fan shaped 1 in 8.5 Turnout for 60 Kg rails etc.	1000 Set.	269040/-
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10	60260014	14/09/26	1 IN 12 CAST MANGANESE STEEL CROSSING B.G. (1673 MM) FOR 60E1 RAIL etc.	190 Set.	1613800/-
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17	38263335	16/09/26	Striker Casting with Wear Plate for up-graded HT-CBC.	750 Nos.	184970/-
18	33263233	21/09/26	Regulated Battery Charger for LHB Coaches etc.	60 Nos.	114700/-
19	30263618	21/09/26	FRP Window complete etc.	1505 Nos.	106450/-
20	30263549	16/09/26	FACE PLATE FOR BUFFER PLUNGER etc.	2758 Nos.	129720/-
21	30261792	14/10/26	Silent Block for Anchor Link etc.	9300 Nos.	112820/-
22	29263995	31/08/26	Set of step size racers for axle boxes etc.	409 Set.	190160/-
23	29263268	10/09/26	Kit for Auto Drain Valve.	794 Set.	209700/-
24	29265036	21/09/26	Set of Axle Box Bearing Component etc.	150 Set.	293840/-
25	IF265951	11/09/26	New Doorway Stiffening Cross Bar for BOXNHL	3500 Nos.	238720/-

Interested tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full Details/Description/ Specification of the tenders and submit their Bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **N.B:** Prospective Bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all other tenders & any Corrigendum published thereafter.

(PR- 660)

**GOVERNMENT OF ANDHRA PRADESH
A.P. TOWNSHIP & INFRASTRUCTURE
DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED**
Block-2, besides CRDA New Building, Rayapudi, Amaravati

Name of the work: APTIDCO Vishakhapatnam Circle- "Balance works of Physical Infrastructure such as Block Approaches, CC Road, Road Safety & Retaining Walls, Plinth Protection Works, Storm Water Drains, Chain Link Mesh, Hard Barricading, Bore wells, etc., in the approved layouts at TIDCO Colony at Achammaidulova location in Visakhapatnam District, Andhra Pradesh under AHP-PMAY-HFA (U) with 2 years defect liability period under Lump sum Contract. **Publication of E-tender Notice for the work related to Visakhapatnam Division -Requested-Reg. ECVAmount:- ECV of Rs. 5,75,25,103.86/-**

E-Procurement Notice

Tender Notice No :1). NIT No.05/DCO/APTIDCO/ANL-Balance Infra/VSP/2026-27, Dt.20-08-2026 of DCTO, APTIDCO, Visakhapatnam Circle.

Bid Document Downloading Start Date	27-08-2026 @ 11:00 Hrs
Bid Document Downloading Close Date	09-09-2026 @ 14:00 Hrs
Last Date and Time for Receipt of Bids	09-09-2026 @ 15:00 Hrs
Technical Bid Opening Date	09-09-2026 @ 17:00 Hrs
Financial Bid Opening Date	10-09-2026 @ 11:00 Hrs

Name & Address of the Concerned Officer: O/o DEPUTY CHIEF TECHNICAL OFFICER, APTIDCO, VISAKHAPATNAM CIRCLE, 3rd Floor, VMRDA, SIRIPURAM, VISAKHAPATNAM-530 003.

The details can be seen in website <http://tender.approcurement.gov.in>. Thereof Contact Nos: +91 9676476111, +919959378999.

Sd/-24-08-2026 Managing Director APTIDCO, Amaravati
R.O. No. 5360PP/Dt. 24.08.2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Open tender through E-tendering are invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRS, Electric Loco Shed, Khanalampura Yard, Northern Railway, Saharanpur (Ambala Division) for and on behalf of the President of India from the registered tenderer on web site www.ireps.gov.in for the following work upto 11:00 hrs on the date of closing shown against the work and will be opened thereafter:-

1.	Open Tender No.	ELS-SRE-T52RTI
2.	Name of work	Complete body cleaning, cyclonic filters cleaning in 3-phase locomotive at Electric Loco Shed Saharanpur for period of eighteen months.
3.	Date of Closing/Opening	18.09.2026
4.	Approx. Cost	Rs. 18,85,113/-
5.	Earnest Money	Rs.37,700/-
6.	Completion period	18 (Eighteen) Months
7.	Validity period	60 days
8.	Cost of tender form	'Free of cost' for downloading from IREPS & Rs. 2000/- for obtaining from Sr.DEE/TRS/SRE office.

1. Tenderer(s) should have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate to participate in E-Tendering of Works Tenders 2. Tenderer are required to upload self-attested scanned copies of all related eligibility documents as per conditions 3. Taxes & Charges will be applicable as per extant rule. 4. For details, please log on IREPS website www.ireps.gov.in

E-TENDER NOTICE No. ELS-SRE-T52RTI Dt. 22/08/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

ADITYA BIRLA CAPITAL
HOME LOANS

Regd Office: Indian Rayon Compound, Veraval, Gujarat - 362 266 | TT) +91 2243567100 | (Toll free) 1800 270 7000 | CIN: U65922GJ2009PLC083779 | homefinance.adityabirlacapital.com

Branch Office - Aditya Birla Housing Finance Ltd, Unit No. 710 A | 7th Floor | Corporate Park | B-109 | Sanjay Place | Agra - 282002.

APPENDIX IV
[See Rule 8 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002]
Possession Notice (for Immovable Property)

Whereas the undersigned being the authorized officer of **Aditya Birla Housing Finance Limited** under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 had issued a **Demand notice dated 13-09-2023 calling upon the borrowers Manta Wo Vinod Rajoriya (In The Capacity Of Available Legal Heir Of Late Vinod Rajoriya), mentioned in the notice being of Rs. 8,95,602.56/- (Rupees Eight Lac Ninety Five Thousand Six Hundred Two and Fifty Six Paise Only)** within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The borrowers having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers and to the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of the powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act. read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on **this 21st day of August of the year, 2026.**

The borrowers in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the **Aditya Birla Housing Finance Limited** for an amount of **Rs. 8,95,602.56/- (Rupees Eight Lac Ninety Five Thousand Six Hundred Two and Fifty Six Paise Only)** and interest thereon. Borrowers attention is invited to the provisions of Sub-section 8 of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

All That Piece And Parcel Of Part Of Plot No. 11, Land Bearing Khasra No. 211, Measuring 70 Sq. Yds. i.e. 58.52 Sq. Mtrs., Situated At Mauza: Kaulakha, Tehsil & District: Agra, Uttar Pradesh-282001, And Bounded As: East: Part Of Plot No. 11, West: Plot No. 12, North: Rasta & Nikas 18 Ft. Wide, South: Land Digar.

Date: 21.08.2026 Authorised Officer
Place: AGRA Aditya Birla Housing Finance Limited

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM					
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NET NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED ROHTAK	2026_HBC_539064_1	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 07.09.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 08.09.2026 AT 11:30 AM	vftanda@gmail.com	9896401185 vftarohtak@gmail.com
2	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED ROHTAK	2026_HBC_539417_1	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 31.08.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 01.09.2026 AT 11:30 AM	vftanda@gmail.com	9896401185 vftarohtak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 48522HRY

Telangana Pollution Control Board
A-3, Industrial Estate, Sanathnagar, Hyderabad-500018

e-TENDER NOTICE

Tender No.963/TGPCB/LAB/PROC/GC-MSMS/2026, Date: 25-08-2026

e-Tenders are invited on behalf of the Member Secretary, TGPCB from Manufacturer/ Suppliers in India for supply of Gas Chromatograph Triple Quadrupole Mass Spectrometer (GC-MS/MS) compatible with ATD of Make Markes international and model: Unity-XR. The tender document can be downloaded from <https://tender.telangana.gov.in> The last date for submission of e-tender is 09.10.2026 at 03.00 PM.

Sd/-MEMBER SECRETARY
TGPCB, HYDERABAD

DIPR R.O.No.454-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:24-08-2026

U.P. POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
Electy. Substation Design Circle-II,
13th Floor, Shakti Bhawan Extension, Lucknow.

“INVITES-OPEN TENDER (E-TENDER)”

“Engineering, Supply, Erection and Commissioning for Increasing Capacity at 220kV Substation Hardoi from 2x160 MVA to 3x160 MVA on Turnkey Basis E-Tender Specification No. SD-1044”

Tender ID: 2026_PTRCL_1178961_1

Bid Portal (Download & Submission): www.etender.up.nic.in

Mode of Bidding: Open E-tender

EMD: Rs. 7.78 Lakh

KEY DATES

Online Bid Submission Start: 22.08.2026, 06:30 PM

Online Bid Submission Closing: 14.09.2026, 03:30 PM

Technical Bid Opening: 15.09.2026, 03:30 PM onwards

Note:- Bidders are advised to visit the e-portal regularly for amendments/ corrigenda, if any.

E-mail: seesdc1@upptcl.org, Contact No.: +91 9415099037

“Save Electricity for Nation”

No.170 -ESDC-I (G.S.)/Tender Notice, Dated:24.08.2026

BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Sarvagnanagara Division,
9th C Main, HRBR Layout 1st Block, Kalyanagara,
Bangalore-560043.

No: EE/SGN/KPPP/TEND/07/2026-27 **Date:24.08.2026**

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER
(Through KPP Portal Only) (Two Cover System)

The Executive Engineer, Sarvagnanagara Division, BNCC Zone-1 invites tenders from registered contractors of Bengaluru North City Corporation, or equivalent registration with CPWD / KPWD/ Railways / MES or any State Government Organizations for the work detailed in the table below.

Sl.No	Name of the work
1.	PACKAGE-10 Comprehensive Development of Parks, Play Grounds, Buildings and Samudaya Bhavan in Ramaswamy Palya Park Part1, Part 2 & Play Ground in Subbaiahnapalya ward, MLA Office Park, Dr. Rajkumar Park, Dr. Puneeth Rajkumar Park in Kalyana Nagara, Telecom Layout Park in Hennur ward , HRBR Bande Park in Kalyana Nagara ward, Pillana Garden Dr. B.R Ambedkar Park, Pillana Garden 9th Park & Play Ground in Venkateshapura ward, ABCD Park in Kacharakana halli, MEG Officers Colony Park, Jeevanahalli Children Park in Maruthi Seva Nagara, 3rd Block, 1st Stage, HBR Layout Park, 4th Block HBR Layout Park Sarvagnanagar Constituency, Construction of Surveillance Building in Jeevanahalli Play Gound, Balance Construction of Samudaya Bhavana in Ward No.35 Kammanahalli, in Ward No-37 Jeevanahalli. (Anubanda-08, GO No: 4.5,7,&8). Estimate Cost: 800.00 Lakhs. EMD: Rs.12,00,000/- (1.00 lakh through e-payment balance Rs. 11,00,000/- through BG/FDR should be submitted before opening of Technical bid. Period of Completion: 240 Days.

1)Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> 2) Last date of receipt of queries: **19.09.2026 up to 13:00 Hrs.** 3) Pre-bid Meeting: **21.09.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.** 4) Last Date & Time for receipt of tenders : **25.09.2026 up to 16:00 hrs.** 5) Opening of technical bids: **28.09.2026 after 16:30 hrs.** 6) Opening of financial bids: **After Approval of Technical bids.** Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Executive Engineer
Sarvagnanagara Division.

Crescent
Innovation
Incubation
Council

B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute of Science and Technology
Seethakuthi estate, GST Rd, Vandalur, Tamil Nadu 600045.

TENDER NOTICE

Notification For Procurement Of Lab Equipment
CIIC BioNEST Supported by BIRAC

Invites sealed tenders from reputed vendors

LAST DATE TO SUBMIT 1st SEPTEMBER, 2026 - 05:00 PM

MODE OF SUBMISSION - OFFLINE (HARD COPY ONLY)

For further details, please visit - @ cltc.ventures@biocnest.clic@crescent.education | ☎ 9527 89490, 98842 82809

CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF KASHMIR
Ganderbal 191131 www.cukashmir.ac.in

ADMISSION NOTICE -2026 ONE -YEAR POSTGRADUATE (PG) PROGRAMMES

The Central University of Kashmir announces admission to one-year postgraduate programmes in M.A. (Political Science) and M.A. (Islamic Studies) under NEP-2020 *Multiple-Entry Multiple-Exit* scheme for the academic session 2026-2027. Candidates who have completed a four-year bachelor's degree (B.A./B.Sc. Honours) in the relevant discipline and are interested in seeking admission to the above-mentioned programmes offered by the university are hereby informed to register. The registration process will begin on 22nd August 2026 and close on 27th August 2026. For detailed information regarding the registration process and eligibility criteria, candidates are advised to visit the official university website at www.cukashmir.ac.in

Date: 21-08-2026 S/d Director (I/C) Directorate of Admissions

RAJASTHAN LIVESTOCK DEVELOPMENT BOARD
Pashudhan Bhawan Parisar, Tonk Road, Jaipur, Phone: 0141-4064974

No. :- FV() RLDB/RGM/Semen Depot/2026/3685 **Dated :- 21/08/2026**

Corrigendum

This is with reference to Bid No. FV() RLDB/RGM/Semen Depot/2026/3116 dated 31.07.2026 for procurement of Portable fully automatic multi-species veterinary Computer Assisted Semen Analyzer published on <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> (**Tender ID- 2026_RLDB_580229_1** and <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> (UBN No.- ANH2672GLRC00160), some amendments are made in accordance to pre-bid meeting clarification/ queries. Details of amendments can be seen and may be downloaded from the above mentioned websites and RLDB website (rldb.rajasthan.gov.in).

Raj.Samwad/C/26/10430 **Chief Executive Officer**

VJTI MUMBAI
वीरमता जिजाबाई तेंडनकर संस्था
Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute
(Autonomous Institute of Govt. of Maharashtra)
H. R. Mahajani Road, Matunga (East), Mumbai - 400 019
Phone: +91 22 24198101/102 • Fax: +91 22 24102674 • www.vjti.ac.in

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

VJTI, Mumbai invites online e-tenders from reputed and experienced companies for 'SITC of Swing Barriers, Flap Barriers, RFID/Contactless Smart Cards, Biometric Fingerprint and Face Recognition Access Control System with Centralized Access Management Software and Visitor Management Module at VJTI, Mumbai'. The detailed tender document is available on the MahaTender Portal at mahatenders.gov.in and in the VJTI website at vjti.ac.in. Last date for online submission: 09.09.2026 up to 15:00 hrs.

Sd/- Registrar, VJTI Mumbai.

NORTHERN RAILWAY		
E-TENDER NOTICE		
Sr. DEE/EMU/GZB for and on behalf of President of India, Invites open e-tender for the under noted work:		
1	Tender Notice No.	RT-1-232-Elect-EMU-WC-08-25-26
2	Name of the work	Complete Electrical & Mechanical Overhauling of Hydraulic Lifting Platform for 4/8 Wheeler Tower Wagon at EMU Car Shed, Ghaziabad for the period of 03 Years.
3	Tender cost	NIL
4	Approximate Cost	Rs. 82,63,665.55 inclusive of GST
5	Earnest Money	Rs. 1,65,300.00 (payment mode available on IREPS website)
6	Completion period	36 Months
7	Validity of offer	60 days
8	Date & Time from tender advertised on IREPS website	22.08.2026 12:50 Hrs.
9	Date & Time from tender submission start and end	31.08.2026 to 14.09.2026 15:00 hrs.
10	Tender closing Date & Time	14.09.2026 15:00 Hrs.
11	Date & Time of tender Opening (immediately when tender submission ends)	14.09.2026 15:00 Hrs.
Note 1: All participant Tenderer/Tenderers will submit their requisite documents along with their tender offer. "No post tender correspondence for submission of additional document shall be entertained after opening of the technical & commercial offer. Even suo-moto post tender letters of the tenders shall be treated as null & void". Note 2: Duplicate documents should not be enclosed/ uploaded. Tender Notice is available on website of www.ireps.gov.in . RT-1-232-Elect-EMU-WC-08-25-26 Date: 22.08.2026		
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE		2931/26

BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Gandhinagar Division,
2nd Floor, BMP Complex, Dhanvantri Road, Bangalore-560009

NO.EE/GNR/TEND/KPPP/007/2026-27 **Date: 24.08.2026**

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (IFT)
(TWO COVER SYSTEM)

(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)
Tenders on item rate basis are invited by the undersigned for the work mentioned below from the registered contractors of Bangalore Central City Corporation equivalent registration with CPWD/KPWD/Railways/MES or any State Government Organizations.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1.	Providing Cement Concrete to Manivartapete, Sowrashtapet, Mamulpet, and Surrounding area in Ward No. 109 Chickpet. Est Cost: Rs. 150.00 Lakhs EMD : Rs. 2,25,000.00
2.	Providing Cement Concrete to Akkipete, Binnypet and Surrounding area in Ward No. 120 & 121 Cottonpete. Est Cost: Rs. 150.00 Lakhs EMD : Rs. 2,25,000.00

Calendar of Events : (1) Last date & Time for receipt of tenders : **08.09.2026 up to 16**

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Mayank Bhardwaj S/o Kailash Chand Sharma R/O M-3B, 9/1, Akash Apt-4, Rajendra Nagar, Sector-3, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201005, have changed the name of my minor daughter Anaisha Bhardwaj to Riddhi Bhardwaj aged 1 years

0071056458-1

I, Pradeep Solanki S/O Suresh Kumar R/O H.No.128, Pooth Kalan, Delhi-110086, have Changed my minor son name from Arjun to Arjun Solanki.

0040874164-4

I, Namita Rajan, W/o Sunil Nagarajan, residing at 1104, Arvind Tower, Griha Pravesh, sec77, Noida, have changed my name from Namita Rajan to Namita Saxena. Henceforth, I shall be known as Namita Saxena for all purpose.

0071056397-1

I,MAMTA,W/O JANAK RAJ
ARORA,R/O,G-252,2ND FLOOR
SANIK COLONY SECTOR-
49,NEAR DAB PUBLIC
SCHOOL,FARIDABAD-121001
HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO
JYOTI ARORA. 0040874166-3

I,Vardhan Kamboj S/O Deepak Kamboj R/o Suncoart Apartment No Sun0020201, 2nd Floor Tower-2,Land-1, Greater Noida Jaypee Greens, Gautam Budh Nagar Uttar Pradesh,Have Changed My Name To Vardaan Kamboj For All Future Purposes.

0071056439-1

I,Pulkrit Mittal,S/o Rajesh Mittal,R/O,AD-49,Tagore Garden,New Delhi- 110027, have change my minor child name Suryansh to Suryansh Mittal. 0040874157-6

I, Mohammad Fuzail, S/o Mohammad Afzal, R/o House No.1761/64, Pataudi House, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Mohd Fuzail, permanently.

0040874112-9

I, Jannat Nisha, D/o Mohd Shakir, R/o T-250, Gali No.4, Jag Parvash Hospital, Gautampuri, Seelampur, North East Delhi, Delhi-110053, declare that my mother's name has been wrongly written as Shabina in my 10th and 12th Certificates. The correct name is Samina, which may be amended accordingly. 0071056364-1

I,BALJEET SINGH KALSI,S/O SURENDER SINGH,R/O-4/47,FIRST FLOOR,JANGPURA EXTENSION,NEW DELHI-110014,have changed my name from BALJEET SINGH KALSI, to BALJIT SINGH KALSI, for all purposes. 0040874165-8

I,GULISTA ANSARI,w/o-MOHD NASEEM,r/o-B-134,Near-Moti Masjid Shaheed Nagar,Chikamberpur,sahibaba d,Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201006,has changed my name to GULISTA, permanently for all future purpose 0040874166-5

I,A Dharumang/Darman, S/o T P Arunagaram R/o-House No-615, B-Block, Jahangir Puri, Delhi-110033, have changed my name to Dharman, Permanently 0040874107-2

I,SHREYA,D/O ARUN ARORA,R/O A-151 DAYANAND COLONY, LAJPAT-NAGAR, SOUTH EAST DELHI,DELHI-110024,have changed my name to SHREYA ARORA. 0040874112-2

I, Kedar Dutt Bhatt,S/o Padma Dutt Bhatt,R/o-B-60-A, Jai Vihar,Najafgarh, New Delhi-110043, have changed my name as KEDAR BHATT, for all future purposes. 0040874037-1

I,Zakira Zaidi,W/O Furqan Haider,R/O 1-97,third floor,back side,muradi Road Batli house Jamia nagar, south Delhi 110025,have changed My Name to Zakra Zaidi

0040874165-1

I, Vinod Goyal S/o Ratan Lal R/o B-34 NEAR CENTRAL MARKET SECTOR-50 Noida UP-201301, have changed my name to Vinod Kumar Goyal for all future Purposes. 0071056442-1

I, Bachha Babu Chaurasiya S/o Baidhanath Prasad residing at Village Bhagwanpur, Post-Gheghawa, Tetaria, East Champaran, Tetaria Factory, Bihar-845436, have changed the name of my minor daughter Chansu Kumari aged 16 years and she shall hereafter be known as Chansi Kumari. 0071056418-1

I,Md Qamre Alam,S/o-Md Nasim Ahmad,R/O-D-6/12,3rd Floor,DDA-MIG Flat,Sarai Khali,Delhi Sadar-Bazar, Delhi-110006 have changed my name to MOHD QAMRE ALAM, for all purpose. 0040874157-8

I, Mohammad Moosa, S/o Ikramuddin, R/o B-24, Street No.-1, Near Jain Mandir, Shastri Park, Delhi-110053, have changed my name to Mohd Moosa, for all purposes.

0040874064-1

I,Nisha Rawat W/o Pankaj Singh Bisht R/O Darimkhet, PO-Salani, Bageshwar, Uttarakhand-263635, have changed my name to Nisha Bisht. 0040874165-10

I,Ashwini Kumar s/o-Gopi Chand, R/o-RZ-84/345, Mohan Nagar, Pankha Road, New Delhi-46,have changed my name to Ashwani Kumar Verma. 0040874070-1

I,PAWAN KUMAR MITTAL S/O, MAHENDRA KUMAR, R/O,WARD.NO-9, AMINAGAR SARAI, BAGHPAT,UTTAR PRADESH-250606,have changed my name to PAWAN KUMAR. 0040874157-2

I,MOHIT KUMAR S/O, PAWAN KUMAR,R/O, WARD.NO-9,AMINAGAR SARAI, BAGHPAT, UTTAR PRADESH-250606 have changed my name to MOHIT MITTAL. 0040874157-1

I,Manisha Aggarwal, W/o Mr. Nikhil Kuchhal, R/O 387, 3rd Floor, Gram Sabha Colony, Pooth Kalan, Delhi-110086 is also known as Manisha Kuchhal. Both names are of one and the same person.

0040874034-2

I,ANU BALA,W/o-Sanjay Jain,R/o-BE/354-A,Gali-no1,Harl Nagar New Delhi-110064,have changed my name to ANU JAIN,after marriage Henceforth,I shall be known as ANU JAIN. 0040874165-3

I, Yaminii Swami D/o Sh. Suresh Chand Kaushik R/o 31, FF, Chirag Delhi, New Delhi-110017 have changed my name from Yaminii Swami to Yaminii Sharma for all future purposes.

0071056426-1

I,Rajesh Kumar S/o SHRI RAMA KANT SINGH R/O D-122, UPKAR APARTMENTS, MAYUR VIHAR PHASE-1 EXTENSION, DELHI-110091, have changed my name to RAJAN PRATAP SINGH for all future purposes. 0040874142-1

I, Jan Mohammad.,F/o No.14688508X,Rank NK, Shaheed Ahmed serving at,29 RB BN,C/O-56,APO R/o Village Jogipur, C/To,Shahid/District Nuh Mewat, Haryana,inform that I have changed my name from Jan Mohammad to Jaan Mohd, and my DOB 01/07/1948 written wrongly in my documents. My actual DOB is 20/10/1956 which is true. 0040874157-10

I SANDEEP SHRIVASTAVA S/O SHRI SHALENDER PARTAP R/O H. NO-R-68 BLOCK R MOHAN GARDEN UTTAM NAGAR WEST DELHI -110059. I HAVE CHANGED MY NAME SANDEEP KUMAR TO SANDEEP SHRIVASTAVA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. AS BOTH ARE ONE AND SAME PERSONS.

0040874164-1

I,PREMA LATHA SHARMA Mother of AMITH RAJ SHARMA, Resident of BALAJI NIWAS, NO 51, KUDLU LAST BUS STOP, KUDLU, BENGALURU-560068 have changed my name from PREMA LATHA SHARMA TO PREMLATHA SHARMA. 0040874062-1

I, Ex-Sub,Ghulam Jaffar, S/O-Ghulam Hassain, R/O-Prandass Drass declare that my daughter's name and D o B is inadvertently written in my army service records as Fatima Saura, 19-06-2004,instead of Fatima sugra, 27-5-2006, It needs correction vide affidavit NO- IN-LA 11629586034778Y,dated 14-07-2026 before public notary Kargil, Ladakh. 020518804-1

I,GYANENDRA GAUTAM, S/O, MAHENDRA KUMAR, R/O,1021, Sector-1,Vasundhara, GHAZIABAD,UTT AR PRADESH-201012,have changed my name to GYANENDRA KUMAR. 0040874157-3

I, Surjeet kaur,W/o-Raj Singh, R/o-B-44,Gali No-6, Bhajan Pura,Delhi-110053, Have Changed My Name To Surjit Kaur, for all future purpose.

0040874112-4

I, SIDDHANT BHARIJA,F/O PRIYANSH BHARIJA,R/O-B-107 ANAND-VIHAR,DELHI-110092,HAVE CHANGED MY SON NAME TO PRITHVIK BHARIJA

0040874112-6

I,NITI BHATIA alias NEETI BHATIA,D/O KRISHAN KUMAR BHATIA,W/O RAJESH BHATIA,R/O-134-135 Ist-Floor,Pocket-20,near Mother Dairy,Sector-24 Rohini,North West Delhi-110085,have changed my name to NEETI BHATIA. 0040874165-5

I, Shaijia Singhal/Shalu Singhal W/o Arun Singhal R/o-230/9, Scheme-7, Shastri Nagar, Meerut have changed my name to Shalja Singhal.

0071056430-1

I, Mayank Bhardwaj S/o Kailash Chand Sharma R/o M-3B, 9/1, Akash Apt-4, Rajendra Nagar, Sector-3, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201005, have changed the name of my minor daughter Anaaya Bhardwaj to Siddhi Bhardwaj aged 1 years

0071056457-1

I,LAL JI S/O RAM GOPAL TIWARI R/O 351,Baniya Wada,Pooth Khurd, Delhi-110039 have changed my name to LAL JI TIWARI. 0040874164-3

I, HINGNEKAR PRANJU ASHOKRAO ALIAS PRANJALI HARSHA HEDGAO D/o ASHOK RAMAJI HINGNEKAR W/o HARSHA NATTHUJI HEDAOO R/O A-99, BLOCK-A, PANDARA ROAD, PO:- LODHI ROAD, DIST:- CENTRAL DELHI, DELHI-110003 have changed my name to PRANJALI HARSHA HEDAOO for all purposes. 0071056396-1

I,Mrs.Arshdeep Kaur Bhatia,wife of.Sh.Mohinder Singh,aged about-41 years,resident of,9/6997,Prem Gali,Mahavir Chowk,Gandhi Nagar,East Delhi-110031,have changed, my name from Arshdeep Kaur, to Arshdeep Kaur Bhatia. 0040874166-2

I,Usha W/o,Gopal Raj,R/O Flat.No-234,Tower C, Aditya World City,Urban Homes, Ghaziabad,have changed my name to Usha Raj. 0040874157-5

I, Nidhi W/o. Sh. Hemant Kumar D/o. Late Sh. Nirmal Kumar Singh R/o 906, T-8, RPS Savana, Sector-88, Kheri Kalan(113), Faridabad, Haryana-121002, have changed my name to Nidhi Singh for all future Purposes. 0071056394-1

I,Aruna Rani,W/o Sanjay Jain,R/o-7/100,60 FT.Road, Arjun Gali,Vishwas Nagar, Shahdara,Delhi-110032,have changed my name to Aruna,for all purposes. 0040874112-8

I, MOHD UMAIR S/O NOOR HASAN R/O 1468 GALI NAWAB SAHEB DURGA MANDIR, FARASH KHANA, DELHI 110006 , have changed my name to MOHAMMAD UMAIR Permanently. 0071056356-1

I, ASHA BISHT R/O. H NO-A-7/44, STREET NO-7, DAYALPUR EXTN, KARAWAL NAGAR, DELHI-110094, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JASULI DEVI.

0040874165-7

I, Soam Harbir Singh R/o G-3, Plot No-9/5, Sector-3, Rajendra Nagar, Sahibabad, UP-201005 have changed my name to Harbir Singh Soam.

0071056437-1

I,Sunil Dabas S/O Sube Singh R/o 330,Harshuke Panna, Pooth Khurd,Delhi-110039,have changed my minor daughter name Aradhya to Aradhya Dabas. 0040874166-4

I, Vardraj, S/o Dharman, R/o-House No-615, B-Block, Jahangir Puri, Delhi-110033, have changed my name to Varadaraj, Permanently

0040874107-1

I,MEENA KUMARI,W/O SUDARSHAN KUMAR JHA,R/O,H.NO-4/4 PALIKA-VIHAR MOTHER TERESSA CRESCENT, SOUTH AVENUE CENTRAL, DELHI-110011,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MEENA JHA. 0040874112-1

I, Ramni Singh Soam D/o Harbir Singh Soam, G-3, Plot No-9/5, Sector-3, Rajendra Nagar, Sahibabad, UP-201005 have changed my name to Ramni Harbir Singh. 0071056441-1

Ihitherto known as NEELIMA D/O NEM SINGH CHAUHAN W/O VIRENDER KUMAR SINGH R/O 80/356,Sisodia Mohalla,VTC:Bakhtawar Pur PO:Bakhtawar Pur,District:North West Delhi,Delhi-110036 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as NEELIMA SINGH. 0040874164-5

It is for general information that I, Rahul Kumar Nag S/o Aaytaram Nag R/o Post-Pakela, Gram-Birsatpal, Birsatpal, Sukma, Chhattisgarh-494111 declare that name of mine, my father and my mother has been wrongly written as Rahul Kumr Nag, Aaytaram Nag and Hermie Nag respectively in my Secondary & Senior Secondary Marks Statement Cum Certificate. The actual name of mine, my father and my mother are Rahul Kumar Nag, Aaytaram Nag and Hirme Nag respectively, which may be amended accordingly

0071056398-1

I, Shaista Begam, W/o Mohd Afzal, R/o House No.1761/64, Pataudi House, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Shaesta Begum, permanently.

0040874112-10

I Vikas,S/o Vinod Kumar,R/o-F8, Godrej Retreat Symphony, Sector 83, Faridabad,121002, have changed my name to Vikas Kumar for all purposes.

0040874165-9

I,NITI BHATIA alias NEETI BHATIA,D/O KRISHAN KUMAR BHATIA,W/O RAJESH BHATIA,R/O-134-135 Ist-Floor,Pocket-20,near Mother Dairy,Sector-24 Rohini,North West Delhi-110085,have changed my name to NEETI BHATIA. 0040874165-5

I,Manu Vig S/o Late Shri Som Nath Vig, R/o 252, Nirman Apartments Mayur Vihar Phase-1, Ext. Delhi-110091 have changed my name to Manas Sn Vig for all purposes.

0040874034-1

I Arush S/O Daya Nand Gupta R/O H.NO-1936,Third Floor,Outram Line,Kingsway Camp,Delhi-110009 Have Changed my Name to Arush Gupta. 0040874165-2

Ihitherto known as Ragini Karval D/o Ram Kumar and W/o Sanjay Singh residing at Ward-32, Balpurva, Housing Bord Colony, Shahdol, Sohagpur, PO- Shahdol, Dist:- Shahdol, Madhya Pardesh-484001, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Durga Singh. 0071056422-1

I,Md.Nawaz S/o Mohd Saraj Ahmed R/o House No.-393, Near Sant Kripal Hospital, Alipur, Delhi-110036, have changed my name to Mohd Nawaz 0071056444-1

I,NARENDER PAL CHANDOLIA, S/o-Chet Ram,Address-42/4866 Raigar Pura, Central Delhi, Delhi-110005, have changed my name to NARINDER PAL CHANDOLIA. 0040874157-9

I, Archana, W/o Mr. Kamal Verma, resident of 89, Choupal wali, Yadav Choupal, Haider Pur, Shamli Bagh, North West Delhi, Delhi-110088 have changed my name from Archana to Babita Goala vide Affidavit dated 21.08.2026. Henceforth, I shall be known and identified as Babita Goala for all purposes. 0130068396-1

I,SIDDHARTH,S/O AMIT KUMAR BHATI,R/O-HN-240 MAVI MOHALLA TEH KHAND-VILLAGE, NEW DELHI-110020,have changed my name to SIDDHARTH BHATI, for all purposes. 0040874112-5

I, KM Sushma Arya W/o Om Prakash Jaiswal R/o-660, UG-1, Sec-1, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Sushma Rani. 0071056428-1

I,hitherto known as KM POOJA TIWARI, D/o SANTOSH TIWARI, R/o H.NO.F-172-A, 2ND FLOOR, F-BLOCK, MAIN BAZAR, LAXMI NAGAR, (EAST DELHI) PO-SHAKARPUR, DIST EAST DELHI, DELHI-110092, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as MEDHAA TRIPATHI. 0040874043-1

I,Parvej Malik S/o Saleem Ahmad,R/o 30, Futa Road, NearAisha Masjid, Hindon Vihar,Ghaziabad, have changed my name to Pravej.

0040874157-7

I,SHEHNAZ BANO D/O NISHA W/O GULSHAN GOSWAMI R/O-A-4-KATYANI VIHAR,NEW KARALA ROAD,HANUMAN CHOWK, BEGAMPUR,DELHI-110086,have changed my name to SHANU GOSWAMI.

0040874165-4

I, Anuj Verma S/o Udayveer R/o Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301, have changed my name to Anash.

0071056455-1

I,Saraswati Mandal,M/o No. 17011479Y Ram HAV Gopi Mandal serving at 29RR BN,C/O-56 APO R/o-Village,Durganagar No.9,(Nazrulnagar),Post -Easgaon Camp,Tehsil-Kagznagar,District Kungurambheem, Asifabad, Telangana- 504296,inform that I have changed my name from Saraswati Mandal to Saraswathi Mandal for all purposes. And my actual DOB is 01/01/1971 which is true.

0040874157-11

I,RITU SINGH D/O KAPTAN SINGH R/O FLAT NO-8308,Pocket-8,Sector-c,Vasant Kunj, Delhi-110070 have changed the name of my minor daughter From SMAYRA to SMAYRA SINGH. 0040874164-2

I,RUTUJA RAVINDRA BHOSALE,W/O-VIKRANT VISHWASRAO DESHMUKH,R/O-DWARKA, BUNGALOW BHARATGAON,WADI SATARA MAHARASHTRA-415519 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RUTUJA VIKRANT DESHMUKH

0040874166-1

I,BHARAT GAUTAM,S/O,GYANENDRA KUMAR, R/O,1021, Sector-1, Vasundhara, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201012, have changed my name to BHARAT CHOUDHARY. 0040874157-4

I, Md Haroon,S/O-Abdul Jalil,R/O House no.H-513 Third-floor Right side Gali no-19, Jaitpur-Extension Part-2, New Delhi-110044,have changed my name to MOHD HAROON Permanently 0040874112-7

I,RAM NIWAS ALIAS R.N.BANSAL ALIAS RAM NIWAS BANSALS/S/O LATE R.G.BANSAL,R/O-C-9/13 Sector-8,Rohini Delhi-110085,have changed my name to RAM NIWAS BANSAL.

0040874165-6

I, MOHD RASHID S/O MOHD MUNNU R/O-L-40, BLOCK-L, SUNDER NAGRI, DELHI-110093, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MUHAMMAD RASHID.

0071056434-1

LOST & FOUND

Lost original Documents of Property-Registry No.2023/19/22535 of Property No.293,First Floor,Shop No.17,Hanuman Market,Katra-Pedan, Tilak Bazar,Khari Baoli,Delhi-110006, Founder May Inform,Monika Aggarwal,W/o Vikas Aggarwal-D-11, East-Jyoti Nagar,Delhi-110093#9951697000.

0040874112-12

I,MAHESH CHAND,S/o Late RAM KISHORE,R/O C-71,RETREAT APARTMENT,20,IP Extension,Delhi-110092, have LOST my SHARE CERTIFICATE, ALLOTMENT & POSSESSION LETTER. Finder Please Contact-9987671199.

0040874157-14

I, Navin Garg S/O Shri A.C. Garg R/O Flat No. 604, Tower-12, Orange County, Ahinsa Khand, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, hereby inform that the Builder-Buyer Agreement and Allotment Letter of my above-mentioned property have been lost. If anyone finds these documents, kindly contact me at the above-mentioned address.

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Under instructions from and on behalf of my clients, Shri Ravinder Prakash, son of Late Shri R.O. Badola, and his wife Smt. Usha Badola, both residents of Sector 1/98, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh (hereinafter referred to as "my Clients"), I hereby issue the following Public Notice:

- That my Clients are the absolute owners in possession of the self-acquired movable and immovable properties.
- That due to the continuous bad habits, unfaithful conduct, and unbecoming behavior of their son, Shri Akshat Badola, and his wife, Smt. Vishesha, my Clients have completely severed all family, moral, social, and legal relations with both of them.
- That my Clients have formally disowned and debarred Shri Akshat Badola and Smt. Vishesha from all their movable and immovable properties (present and future), and they have no right, title, interest, claim, or demand of any nature whatsoever in any of the assets owned by my Clients.
- That the general public is hereby cautioned not to enter into any transaction, dealing, financial arrangement, loan, or agreement of any kind with Shri Akshat Badola or Smt. Vishesha on the basis of any relation to my Clients or their properties.
- Any person, bank, or entity dealing with Shri Akshat Badola and/or Smt. Vishesha shall do so strictly at their own risk, cost, and consequences. My Clients shall not be held liable or responsible for any act, deed, financial liability, misrepresentation, or transaction undertaken by them.

Sd/-
SHASHANK THAPALIA
Advocate
E. No.-16/228/2020
Office: RZ-1/356 Gali No. 5,
Mahavir Enclave, Palam,
South West, New Delhi-110045

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notified that my client Mrs. Dulati Sharma W/o Late Shri Malavir Sharma R/o 465/10, Chander Quarter Rampura, Okar Nagar North West Delhi-110035, has severed relations from her daughter-in-law Anita Sharma wife of Late Sh. Manoj Sharma and her grand-children (1) Mr. Pragy Sharma (2) Mr. Khushi Sharma. Due to their cruel and harassing behavior towards my above named client. Now she have no domestic relations with them and have disowned and discontinue them from all movable & immovable properties. Any person dealing with him/her/their will do at their own cost & risk and my clients should not be responsible for them. If any,

Sd/-
SAURABH GUPTA (Advocate)
Enrl. No. D/2809/2011

PUBLIC NOTICE

The general public is hereby informed that our Clients Sh. Naren Khren & Sh. Sanjay Khren both S/o Sh. O.P. Khren 20, Kailash Indira, Pratimgan, Delhi-110043, are willing to purchase build-up free hold property No. V-252, Rajouri Garden, New Delhi-110027 amounting to 68 sq yards by way of absolute sale deed. All person claiming an interest in the above said build-up property or any part thereof by way of sale, gift, lease, alienation, exchange, mortgage, charge, lien, trust, possession, encroachment, or otherwise have been hereby required to inform or intimate the undersigned at his office at M 4 Aadhaar Bhawan commercial complex Azadpur Delhi 110033 or contact on Mobile number 98100066, 9810070457 within 15 days from date hereof, failing which the sale will be initiated and will be completed thereof, and if any time claim arises the same shall be considered as waived off.

Sd/-
Sukabhan Bhatnagar
Advocate
Enrl. No. D/2808/2015

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that Mr. Amit Gupta (formerly known as Amit Ramesh Gupta) has revoked/cancelled the General Power of Attorney executed in favour of his father Shri Ramesh Gupta, attested by the Constular Section, Embassy of India, Washington D.C., vide Document#S. Nox, 2813 dated 02.08.2012, and 2005 dated 05.06.2012, with effect from 19.05.2026. Accordingly, the general public, banks, financial institutions, registrars, government, non government authorities and all concerned are hereby cautioned not to deal with or act upon any authority or transaction purportedly undertaken by Shri Ramesh Gupta under the said revoked GPA, except to the limited extent specifically authorized for handling existing/past Indian Income Tax matters and outstanding liabilities. Any person dealing with Shri Ramesh Gupta in violation of this notice shall do so at his/her/its own risk and consequences.

Sd/-
Mayank Gupta & Rishpreet Singh
Advocates
Ch. No. 71, Western Wing,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

My clients Mr. Sanjay Kumar Verma and Mrs. Vinita Verma R/o H. No.395-A, D.D.A, Flats Gaspur Delhi-110096 have disowned their son namely Prashant Verma and his wife Mrs. Sanjana aka Laxmi from their all movable and immovable properties due to their ill conduct and behavior. If anybody deals with them in any manner, he/she shall do so at his/her own risk, costs and consequences. The family of my clients hereby disassociate themselves from any of the misdeed of Mr. Prashant Verma and his wife Mrs. Laxmi aka Sanjana or otherwise and any of their misconduct there onwards shall not be binding on my clients and their family.

Sd/-
LOKESH KUMAR Advocate
Ch. No. 277A, Western Wing
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

The Builder - Buyer Agreement is lost / misplaced since 14.08.2026 and the same could not be traced out.

LOST & FOUND

My client Mr. Sanjay Kumar Verma and Mrs. Vinita Verma R/o H. No.395-A, D.D.A, Flats Gaspur Delhi-110096 have disowned their son namely Prashant Verma and his wife Mrs. Sanjana aka Laxmi from their all movable and immovable properties due to their ill conduct and behavior. If anybody deals with them in any manner, he/she shall do so at his/her own risk, costs and consequences. The family of my clients hereby disassociate themselves from any of the misdeed of Mr. Prashant Verma and his wife Mrs. Laxmi aka Sanjana or otherwise and any of their misconduct there onwards shall not be binding on my clients and their family.

Sd/-
LOKESH KUMAR Advocate
Ch. No. 277A, Western Wing
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

LOST & FOUND

I, Ms. Rhea Suri D/o Mr. Narendar Suri & I, Mr. Satyen Suri S/o Mr. Narendar Suri, owners of property bearing No. 14-B, 14th Floor, Sagar Apartment, New Delhi -110001. The Builder - Buyer Agreement is lost / misplaced since 14.08.2026 and the same could not be traced out.

LOST & FOUND

I, Ms. Rhea Suri D/o Mr. Narendar Suri & I, Mr. Satyen Suri S/o Mr. Narendar Suri, owners of property bearing No. 14-B, 14th Floor, Sagar Apartment, New Delhi -110001. The Builder - Buyer Agreement is lost / misplaced since 14.08.2026 and the same could not be traced out.

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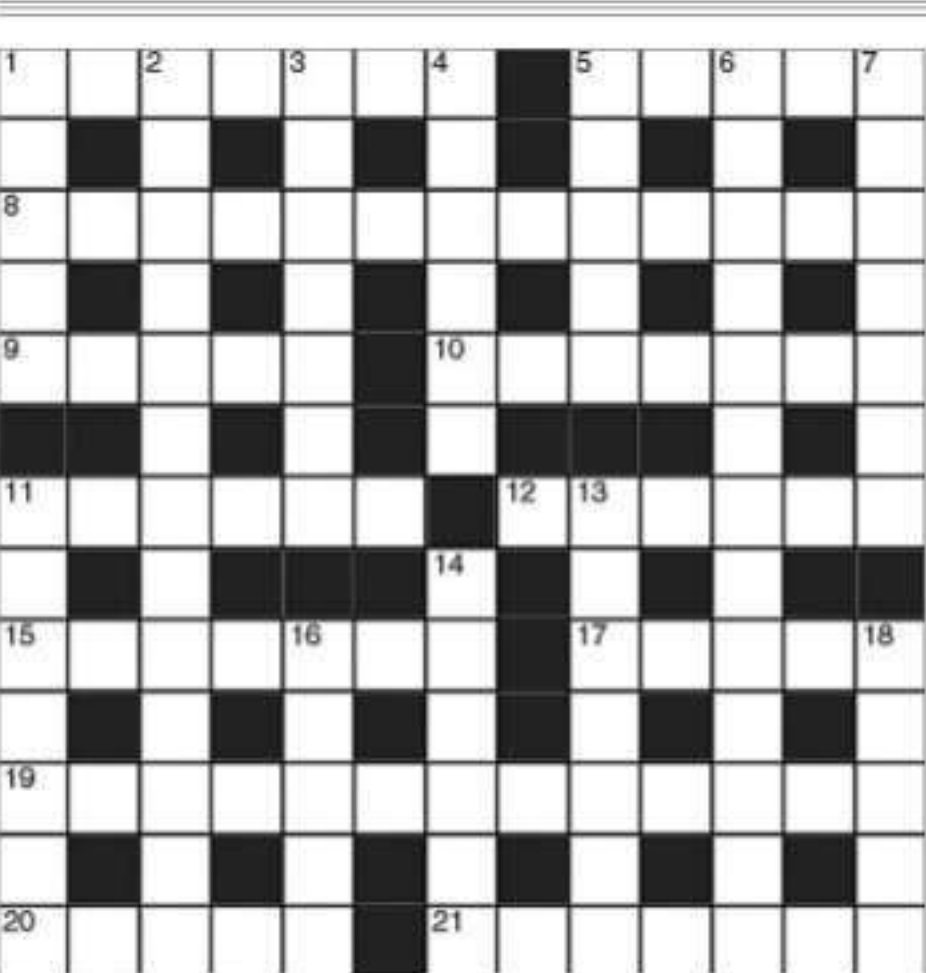
LOST & FOUND

I, Ms. Rhea Suri D/o Mr. Narendar Suri & I, Mr. Satyen Suri S/o Mr. Narendar Suri, owners of property bearing No. 14-B, 14th Floor, Sagar Apartment, New Delhi -110001. The Builder - Buyer Agreement is lost / misplaced since 14.08.2026 and the same could not be traced out.

LOST & FOUND

I, Ms. Rhea Suri D/o Mr. N

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- DOWN
- 1 Alcoholic drink is for the non-driver (7)
- 2 A conclusion showing resolution (13)
- 3 Continue to make a fuss (5,2)
- 4 Former arrangement is better (6)
- 5 A mass rising on the Indian border (5)
- 6 But they're not accommodation for soldiers (7,6)
- 7 Make an effort to study with care (7)
- 11 His wife will be late (7)
- 13 Primate in a role that offers limited protection (7)
- 14 Isn't over-generous with the work allotments (6)
- 16 Change of plane needed in mountainous country (5)
- 18 Likely to snap under pressure (5)
- 5 A spice having no end of use in savouries (5)
- 8 Following a certain style but none too well (5,1,7)
- 9 Is in good time but nearly loses a point (5)
- 10 Drive home an attendant in storm (7)
- 11 In a question of going round a pub say nay (6)
- 12 Put butter on bread for the meal (6)
- 15 Widespread search for criminals may be granted (7)
- 17 Twisted roots used for a perch (5)
- 19 Striking was usual if such staffs were employed (8,5)
- 20 Learn the way it's affecting the kidneys (5)
- 21 Stays if made content (7)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6075 ACROSS: 1 Beast, 8 Mistress, 9 Atlas, 10 Plantain, 11 Grain, 12 Awe, 16 Stilts, 17 Viewed, 18 See, 23 Store, 24 Demeaned, 25 No end, 26 Organdie, 27 Yeast DOWN: 2 Entirety, 3 Spaniels, 4 Willow, 5 At one, 6 Relay, 7 Using, 12 Ass, 13 Eve, 14 Rest home, 15 Bearings, 19 Eyelid, 20 Adios, 21 Omega, 22 Haunt

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

It's not enough that we do our ____; sometimes we have to do what's _____. - Winston Churchill (4,...,8)

CERES

EOIRS

UNTIED

AERUBQ

What's required.

ANSWER: It's not enough that we do our best; sometimes we have to do what's required. - Winston Churchill

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6421

9	5				4		2
		7		3	9	1	5
3	2			4		7	
	8	3	4	7			
	4					1	
			1		2	3	6
	7		5			9	1
5		9	6	7		2	
6		2					5

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6420

9	2	6	3	7	4	1	8	5
8	4	5	6	1	2	9	3	7
3	7	1	8	5	9	2	4	6
7	5	9	1	2	8	4	6	3
1	3	2	5	4	6	7	9	8
4	6	8	7	9	3	5	1	2
6	1	7	9	8	5	3	2	4
2	9	3	4	6	7	8	5	1
5	8	4	2	3	1	6	7	9

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

♈

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Your interactions with friends and members of groups might be intense today. Someone might do something that catches you off guard. You'll meet someone unusual. You'll feel sympathetic for someone and look for ways to help them. Tonight: Be friendly.

♉

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Encounters with someone in authority might be intense today. Pull in your reins a bit in case you offend someone. This could relate to something unexpected that impacts your money, possessions or your earnings. Tonight: You're admired.

♊

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Steer clear of controversial subjects today. They might quickly grow into an argument. Be careful as you might say something you could later regret. Tonight: Explore and learn something.

♋

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): If you're discussing how to divide or share something like a shared property, make sure that your facts are correct. Something unexpected might throw you off guard. Confusion with someone in authority might be a factor. Tonight: Check your finances.

♌

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Discussions with partners, spouses and close friends are intense today. You're surprised by something that a friend or a member of a group does or says. You also might feel sympathetic to the problems of someone far away. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

♍

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is a powerful time for you; nevertheless, something unexpected might occur if you attempt to improve your health or your job. This could relate to an authority figure or your efforts to help someone in need. Do what you can. Tonight: Work hard.

♎

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Surprise opportunities to socialise might pop up today. Act quickly. Romantic connections will be affectionate today. This is also an accident-prone day for your kids. Tonight: Socialise.

♏

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Your home routine might be interrupted today. You also might be involved with a parent or a female family member more than usual. If exploring new health remedies, be careful. Enjoy chatting with others today. Tonight: Relax at home.

♐

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Pay attention to everything you do today as this is a mildly accident-prone day for you. You will feel affectionate towards kids as well as romantic partners. An unexpected inspiration might give you some creative ideas. Tonight: An intense discussion.

♑

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You might impulsively buy something today. You might lose something, so protect what you own. Something unexpected could impact your money. Help a family member today in practical ways or with a sympathetic ear. Tonight: Check your money.

♒

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Today the Moon is in your sign lined up with Pluto, which can make you emotionally intense. You might feel overwhelmed by something or you might feel obsessed with an idea. Tonight: You're strong.

♓

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This is a restless day for you. Fortunately, you might attract money or favours from others to you. Romance will be affectionate, definitely. You also might be attracted to competitive sports. Enjoy your day. Tonight: Privacy.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Arun Kumar S/o Anil Kumar R/o** H.No. 208/1, 1st Floor, Malviya Nagar, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 348/2018 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the Said, **Arun Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Arun Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused said, **Arun Kumar** of **FIR No. 348/2018 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
JMFC-3, Room No. 512
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/11804/SE/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Okeatigwe Kamabili-Collins S/o Okeatigwe Patrik R/o** House No. 37, Jain Road, Water Tank, Bhagwati Garden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 260/16 u/s 33/38 Delhi Excise Act/ Section-14 Foreigner Act at P.S. Ranhola, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Accused** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Accused** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Okeatigwe Kamabili-Collins** accused of **FIR No. 260/16 u/s 33/38 Delhi Excise Act/ Section-14 Foreigner Act at P.S. Ranhola, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.10.2026.**

By Order: Shri Ankit Karan Singh,
Metropolitan Magistrate -08, (West),
Room No. 30,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

DP/11698/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Navita W/o** Lt. Ashok R/o Ground Floor, Premises Adjacent to Pole No. JFPH 907, Village Rawta, Jaffarpur, New Delhi 110073 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Ct Cases 444/2022 U/s 135 Indian Electricity ACT, PS Jaffarpur Kalan, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Navita** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Navita** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Navita** in **Ct Cases 444/2022 U/s 135 Indian Electricity ACT, PS Jaffarpur Kalan, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026.**

By order
Ms. Harleen Singh
Additional District & Sessions Judge (South West)
Special Court Electricity, Court No. 609
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/11572/DW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Jitender, S/o:** Dharam Pal, **R/o:** Premises Right Hand Side to Plot No. 1, Near BES Pole No. NJFAA89, Shiv Enclave, Najafgarh, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT Case No. 750/2021, U/s: 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS: Baba Haridas Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Jitender**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Jitender**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Jitender**, of **CT Case No. 750/2021, U/s: 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS: Baba Haridas Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026.**

By Order
Harleen Singh
Additional District & Sessions Judge (South West)
Special Court (Electricity) Court No. 609
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/11782/DW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Gagan, S/o:** Ratan Lal **R/o:** Near Razia Ka Makan, Gali No. 01, Sanjay Colony, Gokul Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 804/2015, U/S: 452/392/394/34 IPC, PS: Gokal Puri, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Gagan**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Gagan**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Gagan**, of **FIR No. 804/2015, U/S: 452/392/394/34 IPC, PS: Gokal Puri, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026.**

By Order
Babru Bhan
Additional Session Judge-04
Room No. 312, 3rd Floor
North East District
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/11250/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Siraj Sheikh @ Miraj Sheikh @ Babu S/o Murad Sheikh R/o Vegabond, Azad Market, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 101/21 U/s 356/379/411 IPC** at **PS: Kotwali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Siraj Sheikh @ Miraj Sheikh @ Babu** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Siraj Sheikh @ Miraj Sheikh @ Babu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Siraj Sheikh @ Miraj Sheikh @ Babu** of **FIR No. 101/21 U/s 356/379/411 IPC** of **PS: Kotwali, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.09.2026.**

By order
Sayesha Chadha
Judicial Magistrate - 1st Class-08
(Central) Room No.272
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11745/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Naim Singh S/o** Rampal Singh, **R/o:** H. No. B-32, Gali No.5, B Block, Main Nala Road, Amhar Vihar Karawal Nagar, Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. 199/2023, U/s 27/61/85 NDPS ACT**, registered at P.S.: Karawal Nagar, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Naim Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Naim Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Naim Singh** accused **FIR No. 199/2023, U/s 27/61/85 NDPS ACT**, registered at P.S.: Karawal Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Isra Zaidi
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
Room No. 64, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/11880/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Danish @ Khatra @ Salman, S/o:** Imran **R/o:** N.164 & 165, Sunder Nagri, Nand Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 406/2017, U/S: 323/452/506 IPC, PS: Welcome, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Danish @ Khatra @ Salman**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Danish @ Khatra @ Salman**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Danish @ Khatra @ Salman**, of **FIR No. 406/2017, U/S: 323/452/506 IPC, PS: Welcome, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.09.2026.**

By Order
Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/10719/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Sandeep S/o** Hari Ram, **R/o** Village Firojpur Bangar, Tehsil Kharkhoda Distt. Sonipat, Haryana has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 201/2019 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Sandeep** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sandeep** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Sandeep** in **FIR No. 201/2019 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026.**

By order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 114, North District
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11917/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF THE PERSONS ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)/
(84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that two accused persons namely 1. **Karan Singh Negi @ Rahul Negi S/o Bhopal Singh Negi R/o** H.No. G-33, Vijay Vihar, PH-I, Rohini, Delhi (2) **Vipin Kumar @ Babu S/o Lalu Singh R/o** A-292, Vijay Vihar, PH-I, Vijay Vihar, Rohini, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case e-FIR **No. 027819/2024 U/s 305b/317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023** at **PS: Budh Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused 1. **Karan Singh Negi @ Rahul Negi 2. Vipin Kumar @ Babu** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused 1. **Karan Singh Negi @ Rahul Negi 2. Vipin Kumar @ Babu** has absconded (or is concealing themself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused 1. **Karan Singh Negi @ Rahul Negi 2. Vipin Kumar @ Babu** of e-FIR **No. 027819/2024 U/s 305b/317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023** of **PS: Kanjhawala, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.09.2026.**

By order
Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
(North - West) Room No. 112,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11034/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Renu W/o** Lt. Abdul Huq **R/o** New Seemapuri, Dilshad Garden, Delhi, **Also** at: Village-Mednipur, Kolkata, West Bengal, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 10/2014, U/S 4/5/8 ITP Act, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Renu** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Renu** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Renu** the said accused of **FIR No. 10/2014, U/S 4/5/8 ITP Act, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Sanghmitra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
DP/ 11835/SHD/2026 Shahdara Distt., Room No.-54, 2nd Floor,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/ 11835/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Shoav, S/o:** Samshul Islam, **R/o:** D-164 JJ Colony Raghubir Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 328/2024, U/s: 12/9/55 Delhi Gambling Act, PS: Khyala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Shoav**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Shoav**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Shoav**, of **FIR No. 328/2024, U/s: 12/9/55 Delhi Gambling Act, PS: Khyala, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Sheetal Rani
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12 (West)
Room No. 152
Tis hazari Court, Delhi

DP/10250/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

Jurel on ‘Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan’ tattoo: ‘Those are my roots’



Dhruv Jurel. CREIMAS

Express News Service
Mumbai, August 24

DHRUV JUREL endured a tense 13-ball wait to move from 99 to his second Test century, reaching the milestone with a risky single off Asitha Fernando. After removing his helmet and raising his bat, the wicketkeeper-batsman rolled up his sleeve to reveal his left bicep, tattooed with the words ‘Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan.’

The 25-year-old said the tattoo was a tribute to his grandfather and father, a farmer and a soldier, respectively.

“My grandfather was a farmer, my father was a soldier, so those are my roots, where I came from, and I don’t want to forget it,” Jurel told reporters on Monday.

In October last year, the right-hander had celebrated reaching his fifty in a Test against the West Indies in Ahmedabad with a salute, a gesture dedicated to his father. After reaching his maiden Test hundred in the same innings, he dedicated it to the Indian Army.

Stuck on 99

Jurel shared a critical 112-run partnership for the seventh wicket with Rishabh Pant on Monday, which gave India the upper hand. He said that batting with the left-hander made his job easier.

“It makes my batting approach easy, because you are getting runs from one end. It’s easy to bat with him,” Jurel said.

“At the end of the day, whether he gets runs or I get runs, the team should win.”

Jurel was on 95 when the heavens opened up, and early tea was taken. He said that he was used to breaks in play, having toured Sri Lanka earlier with India A.

“I am kind of used to it. I was just trying to bat in partnerships, assess conditions, the situation, pick your pockets and play positively,” he added.

The wicketkeeper-also spoke about being stranded on 99 for 13 balls, admitting that Fernando was bowling well and he took the single because he felt he had found a gap after hitting the ball past the bowler. But he had his heart in his mouth when the fielder threw towards the stumps.

“I don’t know, when I was on 99, before that, he (Asitha) was bowling decently. I was getting runs, I got on 99, he started bowling good lengths and lines, good fielding, so when I played that shot, it was going over the head of the bowler. I thought there was a gap, but when he (fielder) grabbed that ball, I was like, ‘oh God, please save me,’” he remarked.

SRI LANKA VS INDIA, SECOND TEST

Jurel proves himself as man for all seasons with second Test ton

Wicketkeeper-batsman shows he can adapt to different situations; takes team from strong position to dominant one

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, August 24

BY THE time Dhruv Jurel finally got there, he had spent a long time waiting; 171 deliveries, to be precise. And when the moment arrived, it brought a little drama with it.

Jurel punched Asitha Fernando towards mid-off and set off for a single. The throw was coming in the general direction of the stumps. Had the fielder hit, Jurel would have been walking back on 99. Instead, he missed, punching the air before removing his helmet and soaking in the applause.

From the other end, Mohammed Siraj ran towards him and wrapped him in a big hug. Jurel’s shirt and trousers were covered in mud; he lifted his bat and then his sleeve to reveal the tattoo on his left bicep: “Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan.”

Jurel had to wait 13 balls to move from 99 to his second Test hundred, but the innings had been built over much longer. His unbeaten 115 off 177 balls took India to 503/9, putting them firmly in the driver’s seat against Sri Lanka in the second Test in Colombo, especially after the hosts were left tottering at 8/2 in the three overs they had to face at the fag end of the day.

When Sarfaraz Khan was brought in as Sai Sudharsan’s injury replacement, there were murmurs about whether he should walk straight back into the middle order for his ability to play spin and use the sweep efficiently. Instead, the management backed the incumbent option in Jurel. He responded with 51 in Galle. In Colombo, he went several steps further.

Jurel’s innings on Monday had two distinct phases, differentiated by the presence and then the absence of Rishabh

Pant. When Pant joined him, the pair gave India exactly what the team wanted: aggression without recklessness.

Jurel was the calmer half of the partnership, while Pant ensured the bowlers could never settle. The two wicketkeeper-batsmen went about their work in completely different ways. The former trusted his defence, played late and waited for the ball to come to him. The latter moved around the crease, swept, reverse-swept, stepped down the track and occasionally launched the ball into the stands.

It offered a lovely balance to the stand: A right-hander and a left-hander, two wicketkeepers and two different methods.

Jurel was on 11 when Pant came out after Saransh Jain’s dismissal. Soon enough, the two turned a potentially awkward passage into a century partnership. Pant brought up his fifty from 82 balls, while Jurel reached his own half-century in 97 deliveries, pulling a Prabath Jayasuriya long-hop through midwicket.

Pant’s presence gave Jurel the chance to play his natural game. He did not have to force the pace. He could leave the wider deliveries, defend the good ones and cash in when Sri Lanka erred in length. He was playing the perfect foil to his more experienced partner.

Different facets

Then, just after lunch, the equation changed.

Pant danced down the track to Keshara Nuwantha and holed out at long-off on the first ball of the post-lunch session. He was gone for 63 off 89 balls, and his dismissal meant Jurel suddenly had to shoulder a different responsibility.

He kept the scoreboard tick-



Dhruv Jurel scored an unbeaten 115 off 177 deliveries in the second Test in Colombo to take India to a comfortable position. CREIMAS

ing, first with Manav Suthar, before Siraj joined him. The pacer had recently shown a penchant for using the long handle, and it had come off on some occasions.

India had just crossed the 450-run mark. They were safe but needed more runs to feel fully secure. Jurel rallied Siraj, farming the strike for the most part and showing composure to frustrate the Sri Lankans. The heavens opened up when he was on 95, and it seemed like he would remain stranded there.

The rain gods eventually relented, and after resumption,

Jurel quickly moved to 99. He played a maiden against Jayasuriya while sitting on that score, refusing to manufacture a scoring opportunity simply because he was one run from a milestone. When the hundred finally came, the shackles came off. Jurel cleared his front leg and smashed Asitha over deep square leg for six.

In an era increasingly obsessed with scoring rates, Jurel’s batting style offers an interesting throwback. His innings did not have a barrage of ramps, scoops or improvised strokes. It was

● Scorecard	
SRI LANKA vs INDIA	
COLOMBO	
TOSS: India won, chose to bat	
INDIA (O/N- 300/5)	
R Pant c Udara b Nuwantha	
	63 (89b, 6x4, 2x6)
D Jurel not out	115 (177b, 9x4, 2x6)
S Jain c Mishara b Fernando	6 (8b, 1x4)
M Suthar c Dickwella b Jayasuriya	18 (51b, 2x4)
M Siraj lbw b Jayasuriya	3 (29b)
P Krishna not out	4 (7b, 1x4)
● EXTRAS (b 8, lb 3, nb 3, w 7)	21
● TOTAL (138 overs)	503/9d
● FoW: 6-307 (Saransh Jain, 86.5 ov), 7-419 (Rishabh Pant, 112.1 ov), 8-458 (Manav Suthar, 124.4 ov), 9-489 (Mohammed Siraj, 136.1 ov)	
● BOWLING: Asitha Fernando 29-5-106-4; Lahiru Kumara 20-4-68-1; Prabath Jayasuriya 42-7-132-2; Keshara Nuwantha 38-3-154-2; Sonal Dinusha 3-0-8-0; Dhananjaya de Silva 2-0-8-0; Kamil Mishara 4-0-16-0	
SRI LANKA	
Lahiru Udara c Jaiswal b Krishna	1 (6b)
Kamil Mishara not out	5 (5b)
Prabath Jayasuriya lbw b Suthar	2 (7b)
● EXTRAS	0
● TOTAL (3 Overs)	8/2
● FoW: 1-1 (Lahiru Udara, 1.2 ov), 2-8 (Prabath Jayasuriya, 2.6 ov)	
● BOWLING: Mohammed Siraj 1-0-1-0; Prasidh Krishna 1-0-1-1; Manav Suthar 1-0-6-1	

built in orthodox fashion: straight drives, clipped singles, controlled pulls, firm punches and a willingness to defend when the ball demanded it.

Even as wickets fell at the other end, Jurel stayed long enough and ensured they did not lose control of the game. By the time he reached his hundred, Sri Lanka had spent most of two days in the field, and India were closing in on 500.

Jurel has shown in this series that he can absorb pressure without allowing it to consume him. In Galle, the 51 suggested he belonged. In Colombo, the unbeaten 115 has now given him something more valuable: time. After an innings built on patience, discipline and the occasional flourish, India have the upper hand. And Jurel has answered the question that followed him into the series.

Pant’s 63 in Colombo invaluable, like his knock in Manchester



Rishabh Pant played through an injury to score 63 off 89. CREIMAS

SHANKAR NARAYAN
Mumbai, August 24

RISHABH PANT has never done things the conventional way. On Monday in Colombo, with his left forearm still strapped after retiring hurt for 3 the previous evening, he did it again. He was dismissed immediately after lunch, but the damage was done. His 63 may not have been a hundred, but for India, it was worth its weight in gold.

Pant walked out to bat early in the first session on Day 2 after Saransh Jain had fallen cheaply. There were doubts over whether he could play his normal game, whether he could withstand Sri Lanka’s attempts to test the injury. The answers came emphatically. More than the runs, there was an audacity to the way Pant batted, as if the strapped forearm were an inconvenience rather than a reason to retreat.

Asitha Fernando bent his back, sending bouncers towards Pant’s body and shoulder. Pant ducked under some, swayed away from others and was struck again. On one occasion, he was caught between ducking and swaying, taking the ball on the shoulder as it lobbed dangerously close to the stumps. His left hand remained taped, his gloves repeatedly coming off and going back on. Yet he took on deliveries most batsmen would have been happy simply to survive.

The defining moment came in the fifth ball of the 90th over. Kumara went short and into Pant, precisely the delivery Sri Lanka had been using to test him. He rocked back, got into position and hooked it over fine leg. It sailed onto the roof.

He pulled Fernando’s short balls through backward square, tapped Kumara behind point and rotated the strike when the bowlers strayed. The injured forearm made conventional batting difficult, but that only seemed to sharpen his instinct for improvisation and risk.

Using the crease

Then came the spinners, and Pant found another way to disturb their rhythm. Keshara Nuwantha kept bowling around middle and leg, trying to cramp him. Pant used the crease, going deep to create room for the pull and staying down for the sweep, stepping out when the ball was tossed up and occasionally using the reverse sweep.

Against Prabath Jayasuriya, he was particularly inventive. He reverse-swept through deep point, paddled another fine down the leg side and then skipped down the track to loft

The defining moment came in the fifth ball of the 90th over. Kumara went short and into Pant. He rocked back, got into position and hooked it over fine leg. It sailed onto the roof.

the left-arm spinner straight back over his head. When Jayasuriya erred in line towards leg, Pant went deep in his crease and whipped him through backward square. It was not merely shot-making; it was a display of audacity from a batsman carrying an obvious physical limitation.

The 50 came in 82 balls, with Pant going deep in his crease and pulling Nuwantha through midwicket. It was not quite a textbook pull, but it found the boundary.

Then, on the very first ball after lunch, Pant did what Pant does. Nuwantha tossed one up. Pant shimmied down the pitch, got too close to the ball and attempted another big shot. He struck it flat towards deep mid-off, where Lahiru Udara held a sharp catch. The dismissal summed up both the brilliance and risk of his innings. Yet India could hardly complain.

India was 307 for 6 when Pant resumed. By the time he departed, the score had reached 419 for 7. His 112-run partnership with Dhruv Jurel transformed the complexion of the innings and put India ahead in the game.

Pant had done something similar before. In Manchester, after Chris Woakes struck his toe, he walked out in obvious discomfort and still made 54. In Colombo, the physical challenge was different, but the response was similar: play through the pain, absorb the punishment and make the bowlers pay.

His score may appear modest beside the hundreds that define great Test innings. But context matters. This was not a 63 accumulated in comfort. It was 63 earned while Sri Lanka repeatedly attacked the body of an injured batsman, and it came when India needed control.

The maverick had done his job. Those runs carried greater weight than the score suggested. Pant did not need to bat until tea. He did not need to make a hundred. He needed to show that the injury would not stop him - and turn that belief into runs. By the time he walked back, India were firmly in the driver’s seat.

Abid’s 5/39 on red soil gives North Zone a 171-run lead

Venkata Krishna B
Bengaluru, August 24

ABID MUSHTAQ’S delivery to Prithvi Shaw pitched on middle, held its line long enough for Shaw to commit to it, then spun away to take out off stump. The speed gun read 95kmph, roughly 10kmph quicker than anything the other spinners in the match had bowled. It was, in Mushtaq’s own words, the ball Ravindra Jadeja bowls on this kind of surface, red soil, the kind that lets a left-arm spinner attack the stumps at pace rather than loop it up and wait.

That wicket, on the evening of Day 1, set the tone for what followed. In the Duleep Trophy quarterfinal, after North Zone were shut out for 251, it was Mushtaq who pulled them back into the game, his 5 for 39 helping bowl out West Zone for 187

and hand North a 171-run lead.

Mushtaq isn’t North Zone’s most visible spinner on a given day. Mushtaq gets the ball when J&K, or North, need something manufactured rather than just landed in the right areas.

Growing up in Bhaderwah, Mushtaq spent most of his cricket on green tops or low, slow black-soil pitches. Red soil, the kind that lets the ball grip and turn sharply, wasn’t something he had access to until a couple of years ago, when Mithun Manhas took charge of J&K cricket.

“I get goosebumps. I get excited,” Mushtaq says of what a red-soil pitch does to him. “Before that it used to be black soil or a green top. It won’t turn one bit. It is the case actually all across north. So when we got a red soil pitch at home, it was fun. When it was laid, I spiked it up so much to make it hard for



Abid Mushtaq. EXPRESS

batsmen,” he says, cheekily.

His best innings figures, 8 for 18, came on red soil, against Vidarbha in December 2022. His 5 for 111 against Madhya Pradesh and 7 for 68 against Hyderabad, both during J&K’s title-winning Ranji campaign, came on red soil too. Kanhaiya Wadhawan, North Zone’s cap-

tain, has kept wicket to him often enough to know what he’s capable of on it.

“It’s natural,” he says of his habit of taking wickets in clusters. “I was trying to bowl at the stumps as there was help in the wicket. When the wicket is red, I get confidence. I’ve seen the speed at which Jadeja bhai operates. So I try to make it harder for batsmen. When you bowl quick, they can’t sweep me either. And if the pitch is turning, I use the crease a lot,” he says.

He sent down 25.4 overs in the innings, conceded just 39 runs, and bowled 10 maidens. Mushtaq had spent the off-season auditing at the AG’s office in Srinagar, in weather cold enough to stiffen a bowler’s body before he’s bowled a ball.

“For me, it’s hot here. So, I get into the rhythm. I’m trying

for lbw and bowled on this pitch. Since it is turning, if I put too much rotation, I will end up getting beaten. So that’s why I’m attacking the stumps more,” Mushtaq says. With Arshdeep Singh and Anshul Kamboj providing control and breakthroughs around him, West Zone folded for 187, Sams Mulani top-scoring with 52. On a surface already showing signs of wear, North came out looking to score quickly in their second innings.

BRIEF SCORES: North Zone 251 & 107/4 (Ayush Badoni 39 n.o.) vs West Zone 187 (Shams Mulani 52; Abid Mushtaq 5/39).

East Zone 467 (Shahbaz Ahmed 167, Sudip Gharami 146; Pheorijam Jotin 3/64) vs **North East Zone 111** (Abhijit Sarkar 5/20, Shahbaz Ahmed 3/20) & f/o 7/0.

● SPEED DEMON UNLOCKED

Deepesh, 18, cranking up pace in the mid-140s, is Tamil Nadu’s newest prospect

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 24

AT HOME, D Deepesh’s parents speak of a son who can’t eat a meal without watching the Japanese cartoon Shin-Chan. But hand him a cricket ball, and he can consistently bowl in excess of 140kmph. Earlier in the ongoing Tamil Nadu Premier League, playing for Madurai Panthers where he has picked up 5 wickets in 6 games so far, the speed gun clocked him at 146kmph against Trichy Grand Cholas.

Game after game, with a smooth action, he has been cranking up raw pace in the mid-140s and rushing batsmen with his bounce.

In the middle, he doesn’t mind a fiery exchange with the batsmen either; send-offs are common too, and he has a trademark wicket celebration, pulling imaginary arrows from a quiver.

Standing at 6 feet, the 18-year-old is a testament to fast bowling great Dennis Lillee’s old line: “Fast bowlers are not made. They are born.”

Finding the pace

Growing up, until Under-16 level, Deepesh was a batsman. By Under-19, he had evolved into a fast bowler. “Reason elam onum ila na... fast ah pota oru vibe kedalkkum,” Deepesh tells *The Indian Express*: there’s no real reason, if you bowl fast, there’s a vibe to it. “I love watching Dale Steyn, I wasn’t inspired by anyone. I didn’t play cricket wanting to get selected to any team. I’m playing because I love bowling fast. I don’t know where it will take me,” he says.

At the Under-19 World Cup, he clocked 140kmph, but when he delivered the fastest ball at the TNPL, he had no idea it was coming. He admits he was definitely bowling faster than ever

before. “I didn’t specifically work to increase my speed to 145kph. I did a lot of volume and kept bowling after the World Cup. Played the Chennai league and I feel it’s a result of that. I still do the same weights and gym work, but it’s the volume of bowling which has increased. I believe my pace has increased to 145 because of bowling more balls,” he says.

Crickets runs in Deepesh’s blood. His father, V Devendran, played for Tamil Nadu in the inaugural edition of the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy. With Deepesh showing an interest in cricket, Devendran enrolled his son in swimming at age 10, to build a strong physique. “I was his first coach, so I don’t know if that is the reason, he doesn’t open up to me,” Devendran says. “Bowling fast is fine. He needs to understand red-ball cricket is real cricket. Bowling four overs a day shouldn’t be



D Deepesh clocked 146kmph in the Tamil Nadu Premier League. TNPL

enough. I’m preparing him to bowl long. When he is here at home, I make him bowl 25 overs a day. Batsman ah slip la thooka na thaana Sir dhooli,” he adds: you need to get batsmen dismissed in the slip cordon.

AC Pratheepan, Madurai’s bowling coach, has experienced first-hand what Deepesh pro-

vides to his team. For Pratheepan, Deepesh is a wholesome package. “He is a character. Many people have said before that fast bowlers are scary characters, and he is a proper character. Every captain will love to have a fast bowler like him in their team. He is always ready for the fight, he will not shy away. He

“I love watching Dale Steyn, I wasn’t inspired by anyone. I didn’t play cricket wanting to get selected to any team. I’m playing because I love bowling fast. I don’t know where it will take me.”

D DEEPESH
FAST BOWLER

will go hard and look to bowl quick. It is not like I will control and if I hit a good length, it is enough.” He wants control as well as speed,” he says.

What has also caught Pratheepan’s attention is Deepesh’s indifference to the numbers. “He is not a person who looks at his numbers. After each game, he

will ask, ‘how did I bowl?’ He asks for that feedback, doesn’t matter if he got wickets or not. At this level, most are after numbers because that is what will take you to the next level. With him, he is different. Since he has pace, now it is all about getting control,” Pratheepan adds.

Beyond raw pace

Deepesh isn’t about pace alone. At the Under-19 World Cup, he showed a slower-ball bouncer that is hard to pick, and has since gone about adding variations, including the off-cutter and the dipping yorker. These variations are a by-product of working with Tamil Nadu pacer Sandeep Warrier. “To be honest, Deepesh has it in him. It is all about sharing the experience and helping him develop. At 18-19, if you can learn as much as you can, when he hits the peak in a couple of years, he can be a complete fast bowler. So I

just share my experiences and guide him about load, and de-loading, and how to manage the body,” Warrier says.

Early in his own career, Warrier was known for clocking over 140kmph, and though he went on to become a reliable red-ball bowler, he struggled for consistency in white-ball cricket. “With Deepesh, he bowls a lot, which is not common these days. From Under-19, he has to take the next step. If he can learn at 18, it will help him a lot. With the red ball, you can find the rhythm once you get the control. But to be an all-format pacer, you need to add variations. I had nobody to help me when it comes to white-ball cricket, so I’m just sharing my knowledge, so that when he breaks the big doors soon and plays the Ranji Trophy, IPL and for India, he’s ready. Deepesh isn’t obsessed about speed. He wants to bowl fast, but be a complete pacer,” Warrier adds.

Sports ministry stands firm on selection criteria for Asian Games

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

THE 492-STRONG squad for the Asian Games has already been announced. But as is often the case in such matters, athletes who have not made the cut have rallied for a spot in the continental mega event taking place in Aichi-Nagoya from September 19 to October 4. On Monday, the sports ministry made it clear that despite the pressure, they would stick to the selection criteria announced a year ago.

"A lot of pressure was there (on us). Some parents came and said 'my child has not been selected'. We told them if your child merits selection (fulfils the criteria), there is no way he or she will not be selected," a sports ministry source told reporters. It was reiterated that only the top six in Asia in any event would be selected and that the Asian Games was not an event for athletes to 'gain experience'.

"If somebody has to run inside 10 seconds to be a contender for a medal in the 100m event, should we send an athlete who clocks 15 seconds?"

In September 2025, the Sports Authority of India had laid down the selection criteria for athletes to be a part of the Asian Games. While top six in Asia via rankings was the operative standard, in cases where judging by that marker was not possible or realistic, 'a top-six finish among Asian nations in international competitions', or a top-six finish at an Asian Championship would be the operative criterion. The ministry, in its September release, had added a relaxation clause: one that allowed it to choose an athlete for justifiable reasons, as recommended by experts from the concerned federation. Hence, there is still room for additions, subject to approval from the Olympic Council of Asia.

HOCKEY WORLD CUP

Uninspired India crash out of semifinal race without a fight

Harmanpreet-led side's hopes end after going down 3-5 to Argentina in do-or-die match

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 24

INDIA ARE out of the Hockey World Cup, and the manner of their elimination – following a 5-3 hammering to Argentina – was as damning as the result.

They arrived at the Wagener Stadium knowing they needed a big victory to keep their semifinal hopes alive. There was no room for a slow start, a cautious approach or defensive lapses.

Yet, six minutes in, they were 2-0 down.

Craig Fulton clenched his teeth after Argentina scored their second goal. It was the kind of reaction that needed no explanation. India were not being blown away by an irresistible Argentine attack. They were giving Argentina opportunities, reacting late and failing to deal with danger inside their own circle.

At half-time, Fulton put it even more bluntly. "We are giving them a lot of opportunities for no reason." It was perhaps the most accurate summary of India's first half.

The first six minutes exposed India's defensive uncertainty. They were slow to react inside the circle, late to close down attackers and unable to impose themselves on a game they desperately needed to control.

Sukhjeet Singh briefly offered a glimpse of what India should have been doing. Under



India were down 1-5 by the 53rd minute, and two late goals only reduced the margin of defeat. HOCKEY INDIA

pressure from a couple of defenders, he turned and produced a good shot to pull one back. It was a fine piece of skill and execution, the sort of moment India desperately needed.

But it remained an isolated moment. For all the urgency demanded by the situation, India spent much of the second quarter looking anything but urgent. Argentina were not being pinned back. India's midfield was not dictating the game, and couldn't manage a sustained wave of attacks.

Most strikingly, there was a lack of personality. India have players capable of producing spectacular moments. They have players who can eliminate opponents with a piece of skill, burst through a gap or change the tempo of a match with one pass. But there was little of that here.

There was no jaw-dropping move. No passage of hockey

that made you sit up. No showcase of the skill that this team possesses. Instead, India seemed to be waiting for something to happen.

The contrast with Argentina was stark. Their first two goals came from India's defensive uncertainty, but Argentina were alert enough to exploit it. And when the ball entered the Indian circle, they looked more decisive.

Tomas Domene was the clearest example. When the Argentine forward found the net again with a reverse hit, India were once more too slow to react. It was Domene's seventh goal of the tournament. And India knew exactly what he was capable of.

Earlier this year, Argentina had beaten India 8-0 and 4-2 in the Pro League. Domene scored four times in that extraordinary 8-0 victory, while he was again among the scorers in the 4-2

win. He had already established himself as one of the most dangerous forwards India would face at this World Cup. India knew the threat. And yet they continued to give him openings.

Thirty-four seconds into the third quarter, it happened again. Sumit reached for the ball, failed to get enough of it and brought down the Argentine attacker. Another penalty corner. Argentina did not convert that one. India could count themselves fortunate.

But fortune could only protect them for so long. The fourth goal was almost a summary of the evening. Yashdeep Siwach played a square ball that was intercepted, leaving Argentina one-on-one with Mohith H S. The goalkeeper saved the first attempt, but the rebound struck Yashdeep's foot in front of the goal.

Penalty stroke. Domene converted. 4-1.

It was not an elaborate Argentine move that broke India. It was another Indian mistake. That has been the most damning feature of the performance. India have not simply been beaten by a team producing irresistible hockey. They have repeatedly made the game easier for Argentina.

Looking flat

There was another problem, too: India were not creating enough opportunities of their own. They entered the match needing to chase a substantial margin. That should have produced desperation. Instead, they looked flat. Too slow with the ball. Too passive without it. Too often waiting for the opposition to make the next move. This was not simply a night when India failed to convert their chances. They barely created enough of them.

There will be questions about India's defence, their midfield and their attacking structure. There will be questions about why a team with so much individual ability could produce so little collective spark in a match of such consequence.

But the most uncomfortable question may be simpler. Where was the fight?

India did not go out because Argentina produced a performance so overwhelming that they were left helpless. They crashed out after repeatedly making errors, failing to respond to them and then failing to create enough pressure of their own.

A high-stakes World Cup game, with a semi-final place on the line, demanded a team willing to seize the match. India needed to create a storm. Instead, they got swept away in one.

We want Imran to get best treatment: Kapil

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

KAPIL DEV does not blame Pakistani cricketers for not speaking up in favour of an ailing Imran Khan, because "they have to live there". The Indian cricket icon instead chooses to restate his support and seek the best treatment for the fellow former all-rounder.

Dev is one of the 22 ex-international captains who issued a second appeal to Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif on Sunday, expressing concern over Khan's health. An eye condition has reportedly left Khan almost entirely blind in one eye, amid allegations of medical neglect in prison.

"I would like to support my friend, against whom we played and admired his cricketing skill. We don't know the law of the country. But humanity and simple facilities should be given to a prisoner, whoever he may be. And he was a former prime minister of the country and a top cricketer of the world," Dev said on Monday at the launch of PGTT's 'Race to DP World India Championship'.

"We want he (Khan) should get the best treatment. We are not asking for anything else, we are not asking for any replies, we are requesting," Dev added.

Sunil Gavaskar and Dilip Vengsarkar are the other Indians to have signed the latest letter to Sharif. Greg Chappell initiated the communication and Clive Lloyd, Arjuna Ranatunga, Allan Border, David Gower, Steve Waugh and John Wright are also signatories.

The first letter was sent in February 2026 when 14 former captains, including Gavaskar, had put on record their apprehensions over Imran's medical treatment. This followed allegations of negligence at Adiala prison, where Khan is being held by the current regime. The signatories described themselves as "former colleagues and rivals who share a bond



Kapil Dev at a PGTT event. PTI

forged on the cricket field", adding that the bond "transcends the borders and disputes that too often divide countries".

Khan served as Pakistan's prime minister from 2018 to 2022 but has been in jail since his removal from office after being convicted in corruption and other cases. The 1992 World Cup-winning Pakistan skipper was recently taken to a government hospital for a medical examination. The examination was conducted in the presence of one of his sisters, and Khan was then returned to Adiala prison. Doctors declared him medically fit, but the 22 cricket greats have questioned the procedure of Khan's medical checkup.

PGTI calendar revised

Dev, the Professional Golf Tour of India (PGTI) president, also unveiled the new Order of Merit trophy for the DP World India Championship. Under the fresh format, the 2026 champion will be decided after the competition on October 18. This schedule aligns the PGTI calendar closely with the World Tour, so that players don't miss out on key tournaments.

The 'race' to the Championship features nine tournaments. It will end with the Kapil Dev Invitational Tour Championship — in Greater Noida from September 30 — and determine the season's top 24 performers who make the Championship cut.



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार

स्वच्छ भारत मिशन
तबसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

माननीय प्रधानमंत्री श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी का 'स्वच्छ भारत मिशन' - दिल्ली का जन-अभियान

आइए, स्वच्छ दिल्ली के लिए सब साथ मिलकर कदम बढ़ाएं

स्वच्छता अभियान

17 अगस्त - 2 अक्टूबर, 2026

दिल्ली को कूड़े से आज़ादी

स्वच्छ दिल्ली के लिए

क्या करें?



कूड़ा हमेशा डस्टबिन में डालें



गीला और सूखा कूड़ा अलग रखें



घर, दुकान और अपने आसपास सफाई रखें



RWA, वार्ड, बाजार व स्कूलों के स्वच्छता अभियान से जुड़ें

क्या न करें?



सार्वजनिक स्थानों पर गंदगी न फैलाएं



नालियों में कचरा न डालें



प्लास्टिक व कचरा पार्कों में न छोड़ें



सड़क, पार्क या खाली प्लॉट में कूड़ा न फेंकें

कहीं कूड़ा दिखे तो MCD (311 ऐप) पर शिकायत दर्ज करें

शिकायत के लिए swachhdelhi2026@gmail.com पर ईमेल करें या 011 - 23392270 पर सूचना दें।

स्वच्छ दिल्ली हम सबकी जिम्मेदारी